

CHESS99 BOOK 9 | ELO 1800-2100 | GOLD

Advanced Strategy

Imbalances, pawn structures, prophylaxis, and long-term decisions.

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Imbalances

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Imbalances converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

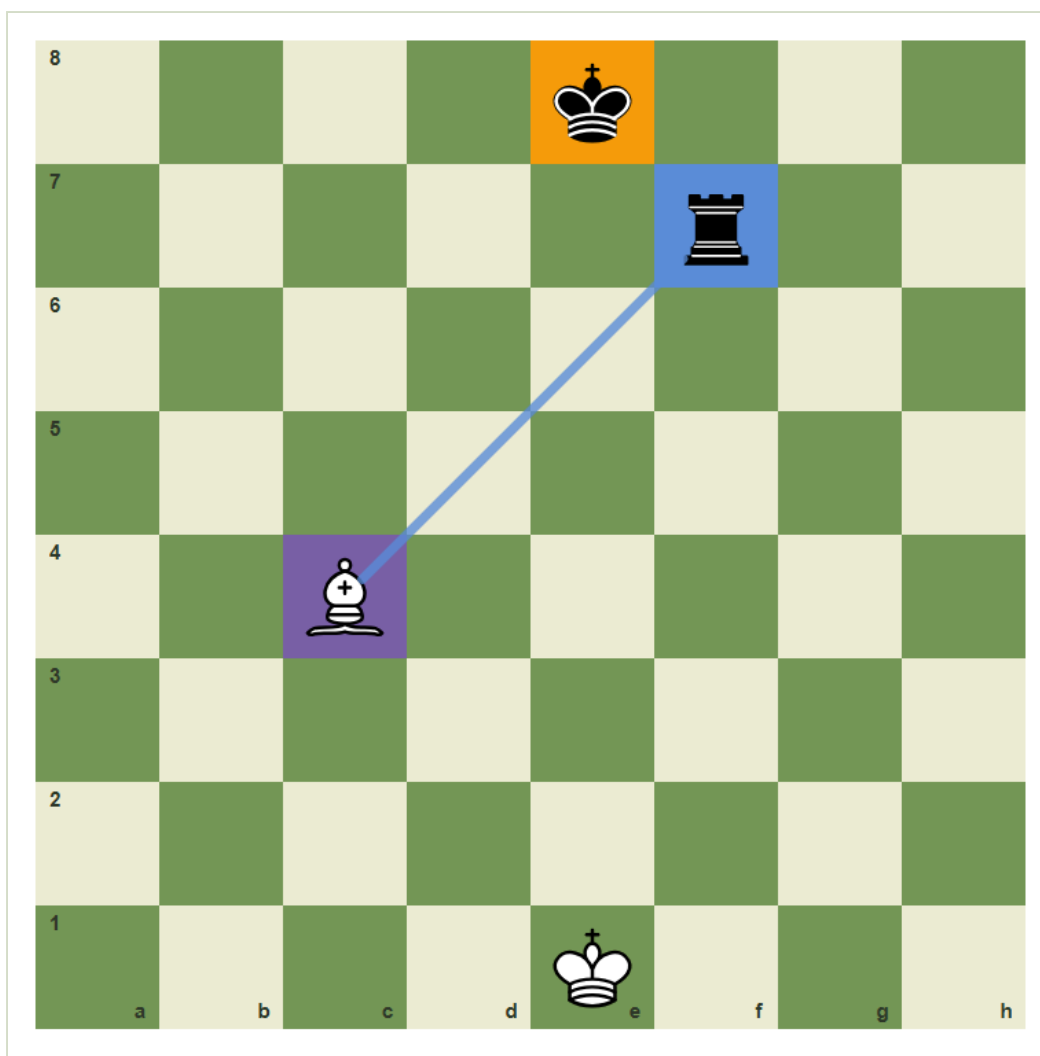
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for imbalances.
- Choose a move or plan that fits imbalances.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with imbalances.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

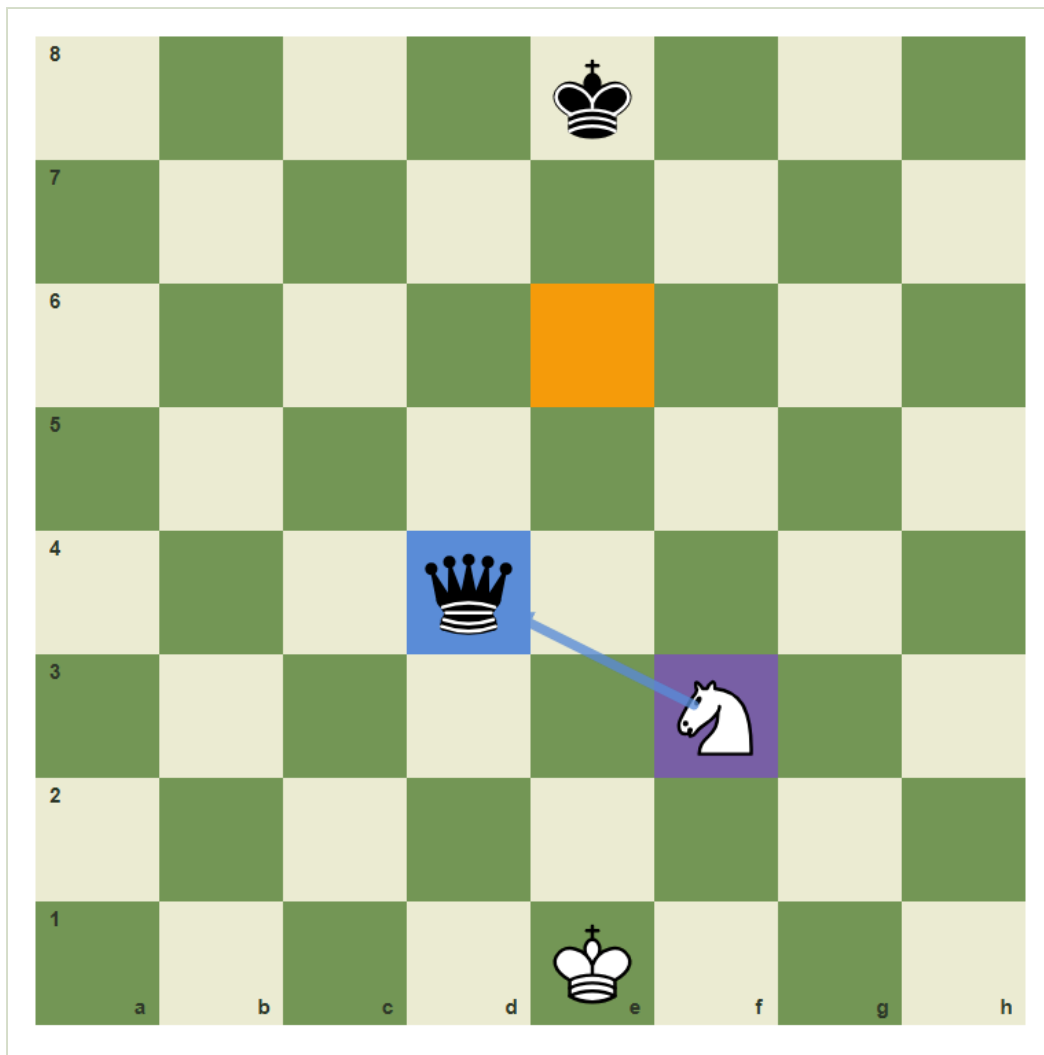
Imbalances is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

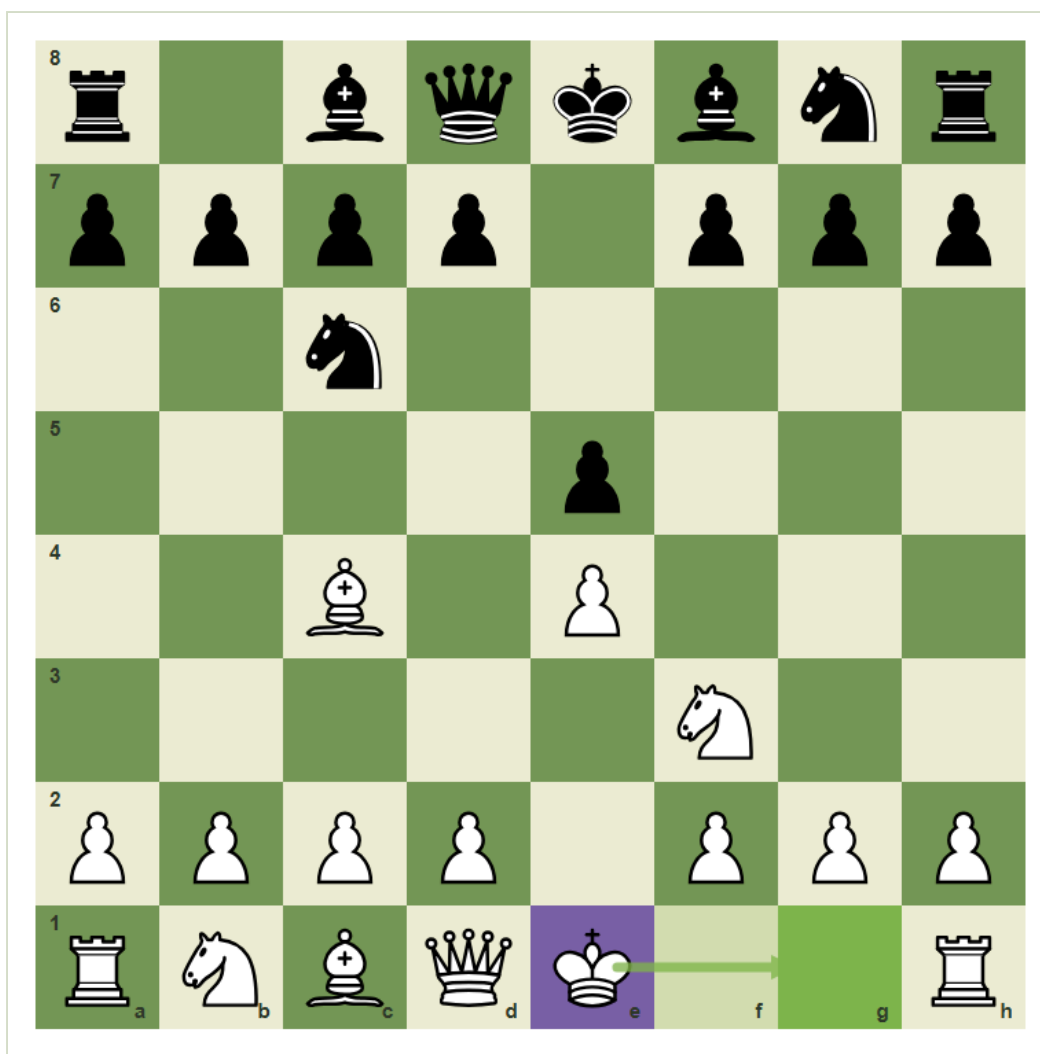


A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

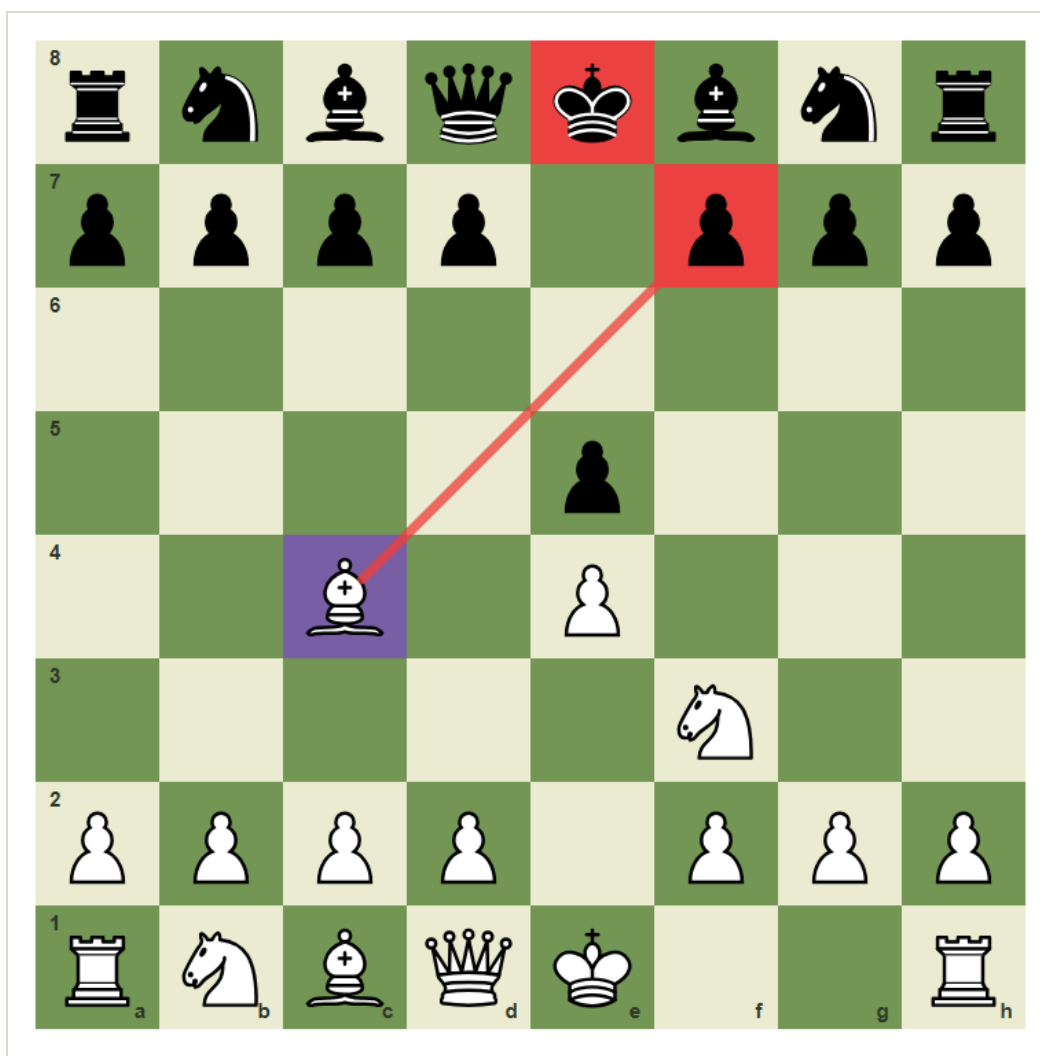
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



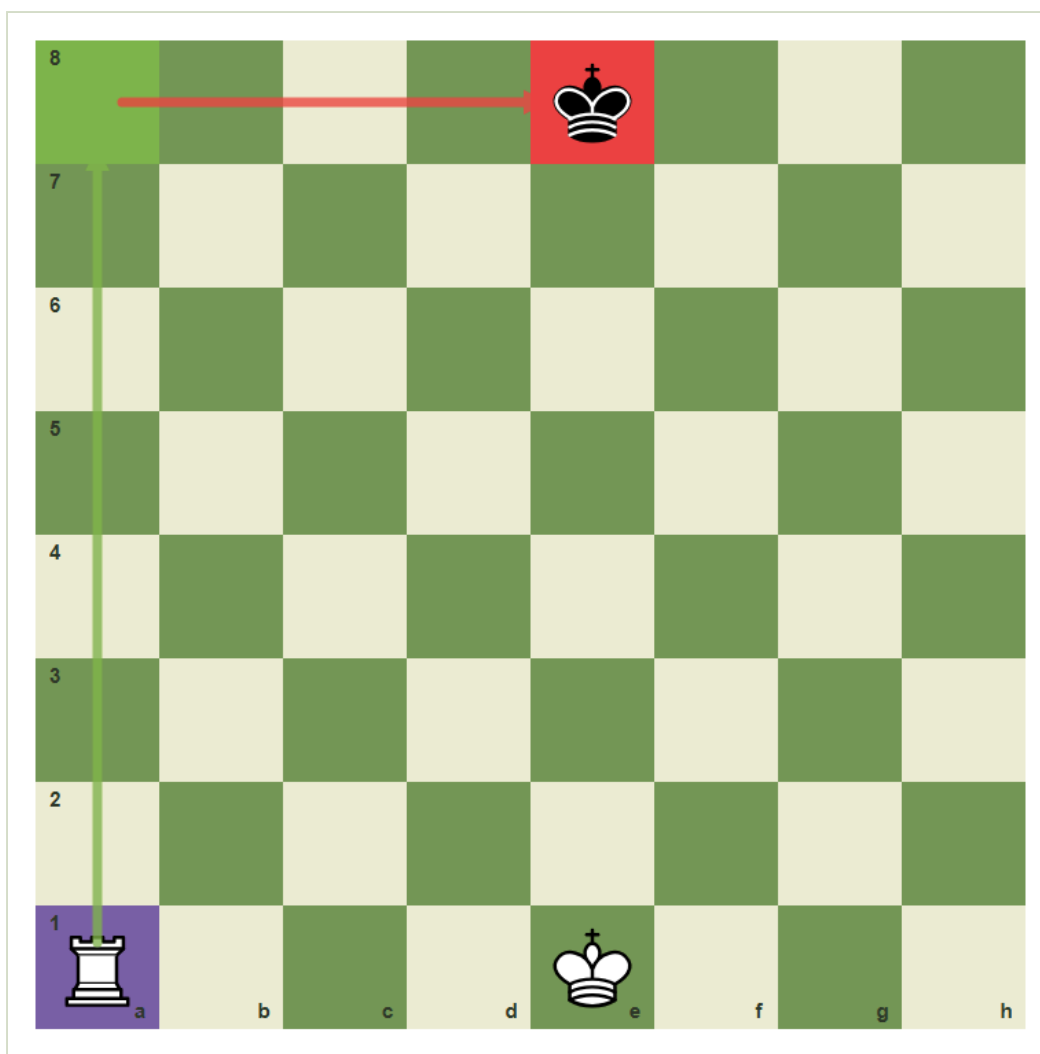
King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

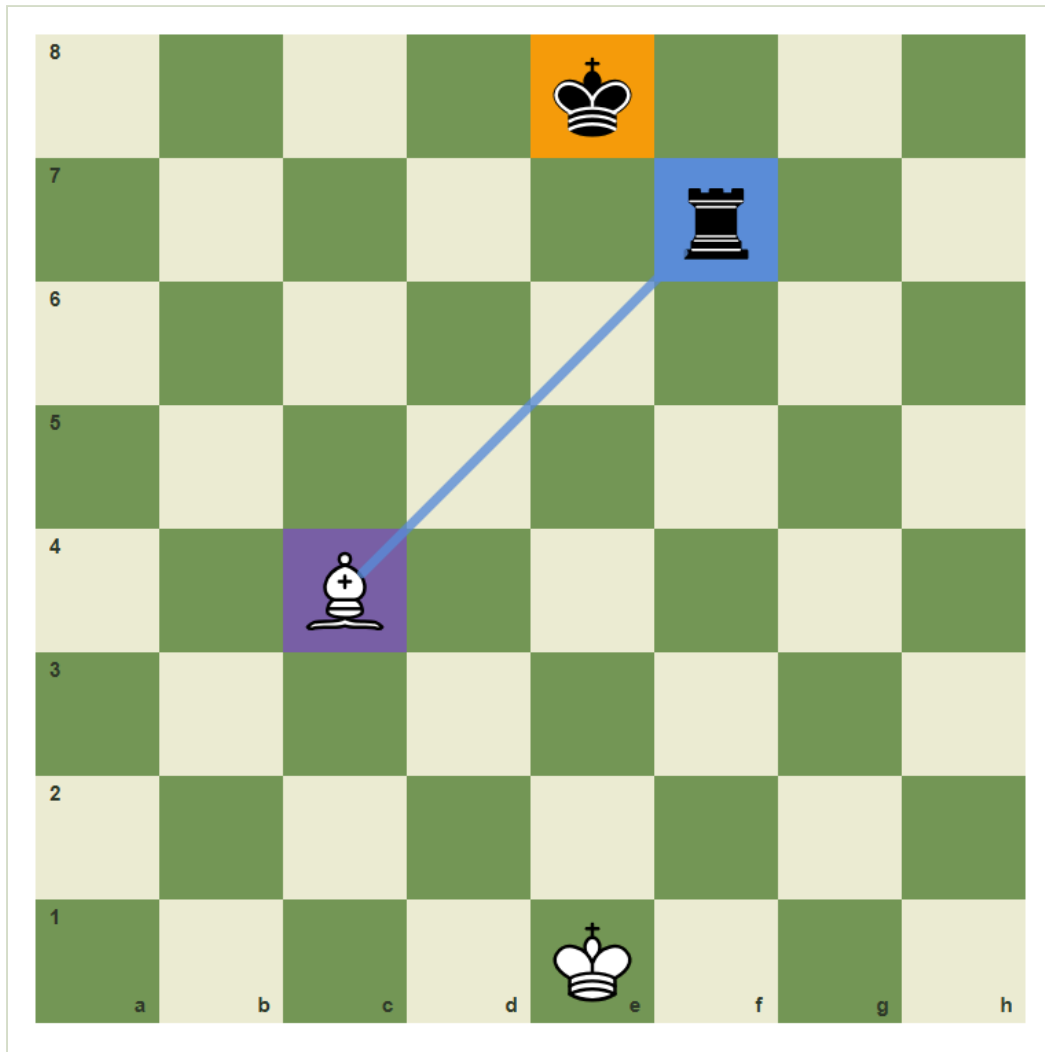
Training Diagram: review position



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

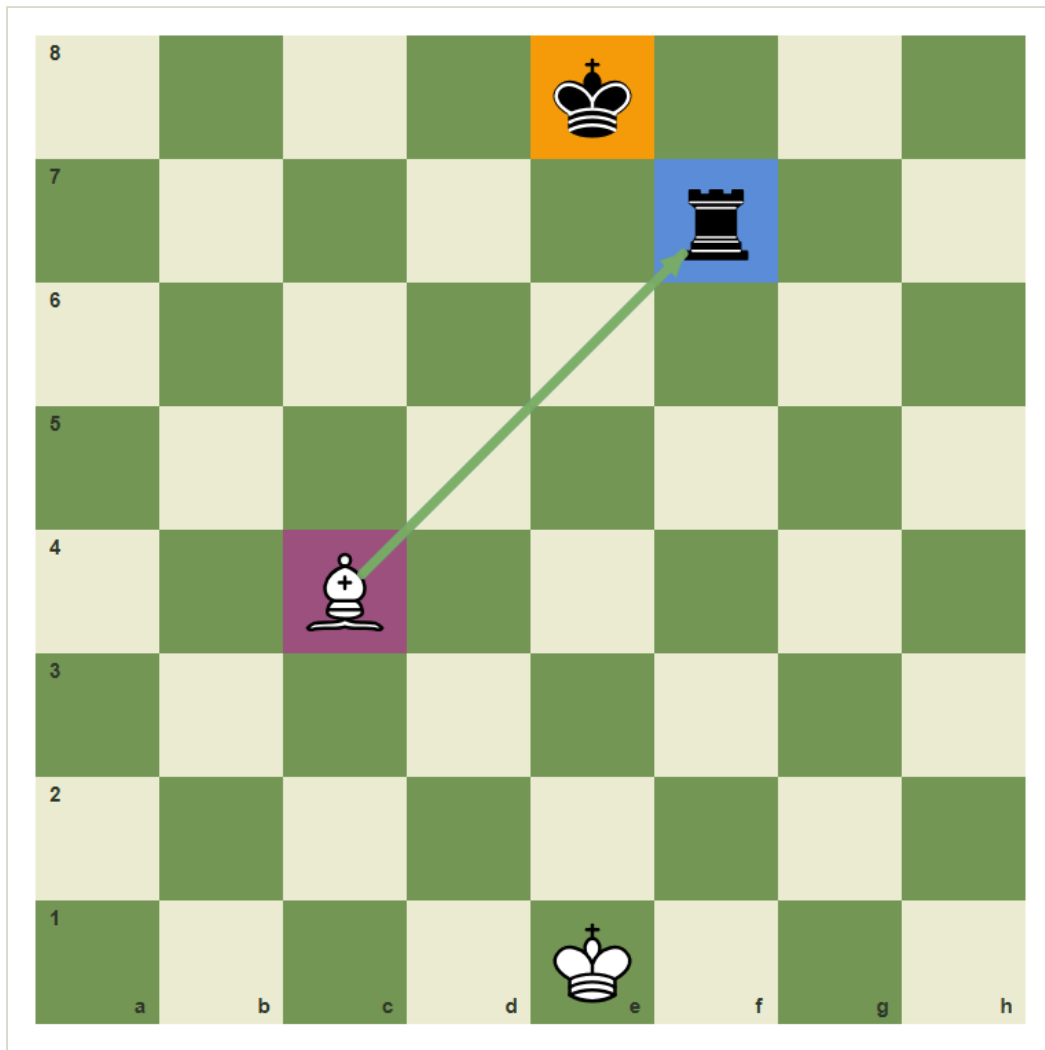
Play the highlighted move from **c4** to **f7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Imbalances Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **imbalances**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Imbalances Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **imbalances**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Imbalances Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **imbalances**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Static Vs Dynamic Advantages

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Static Vs Dynamic Advantages converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

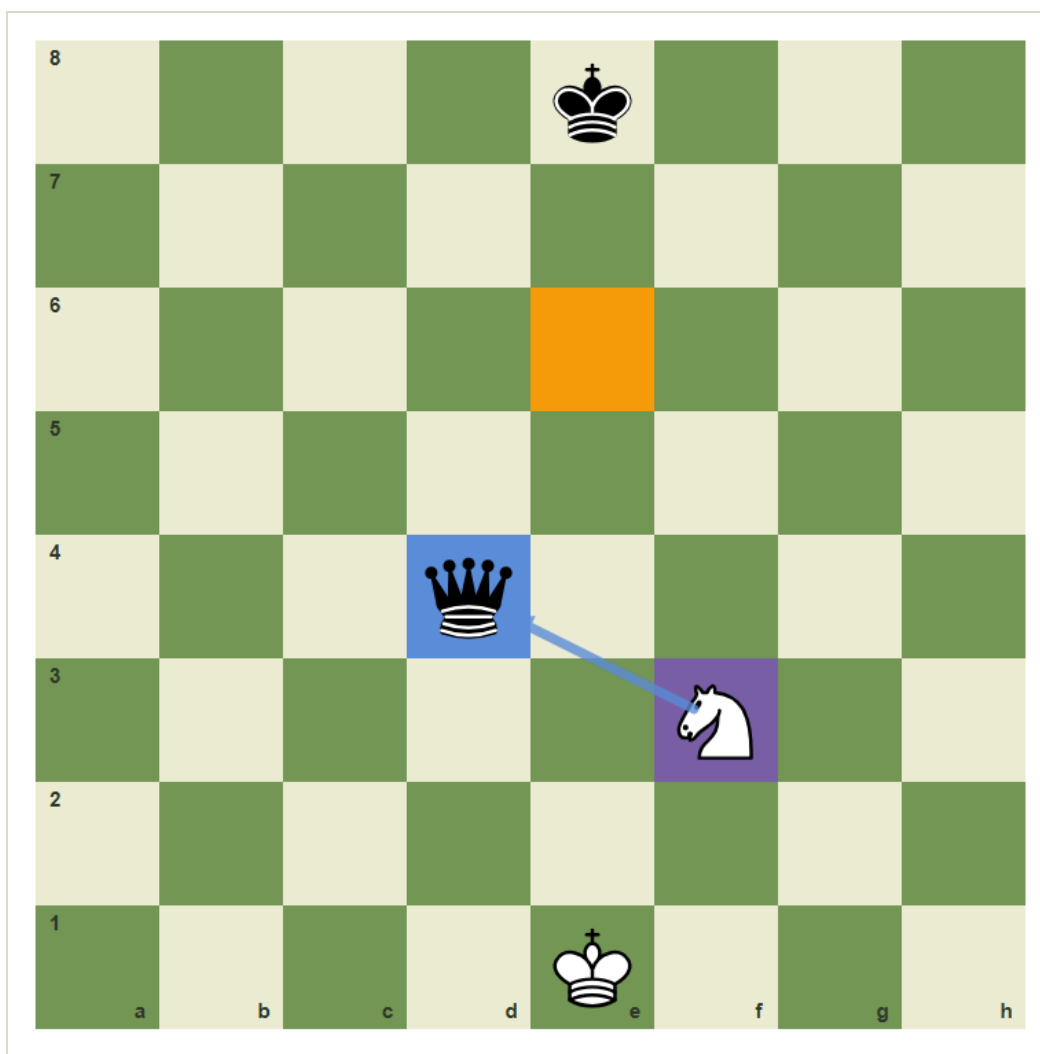
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for static vs dynamic advantages.
- Choose a move or plan that fits static vs dynamic advantages.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with static vs dynamic advantages.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

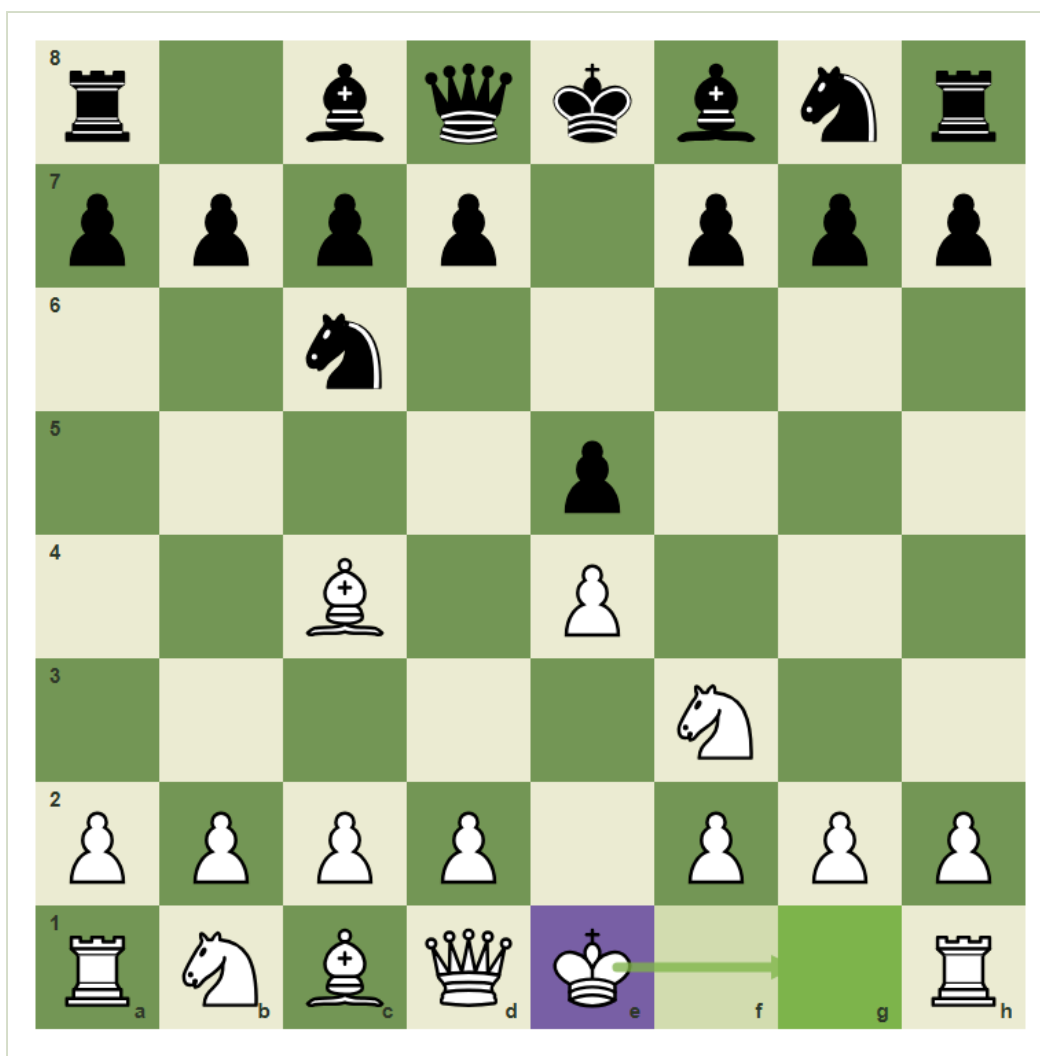
Static Vs Dynamic Advantages is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

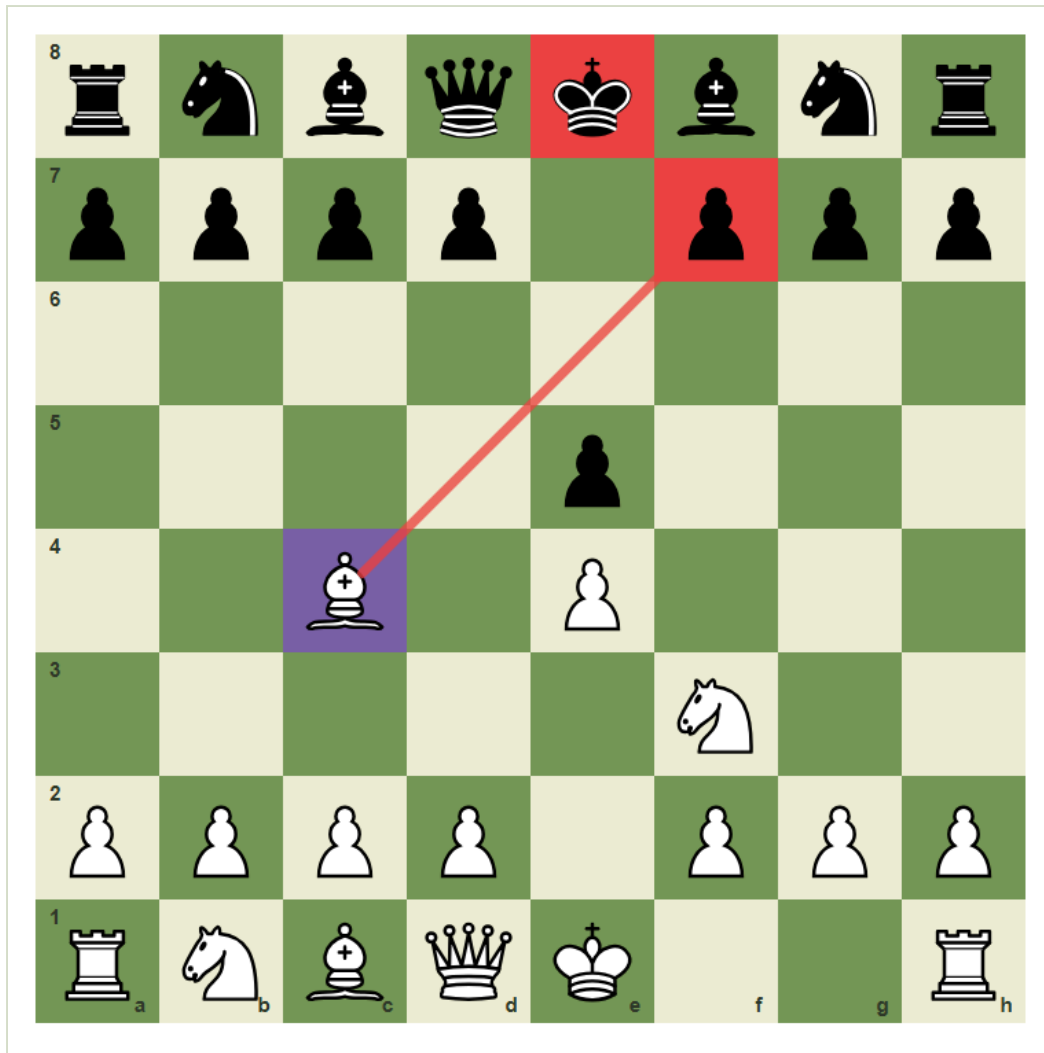


King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

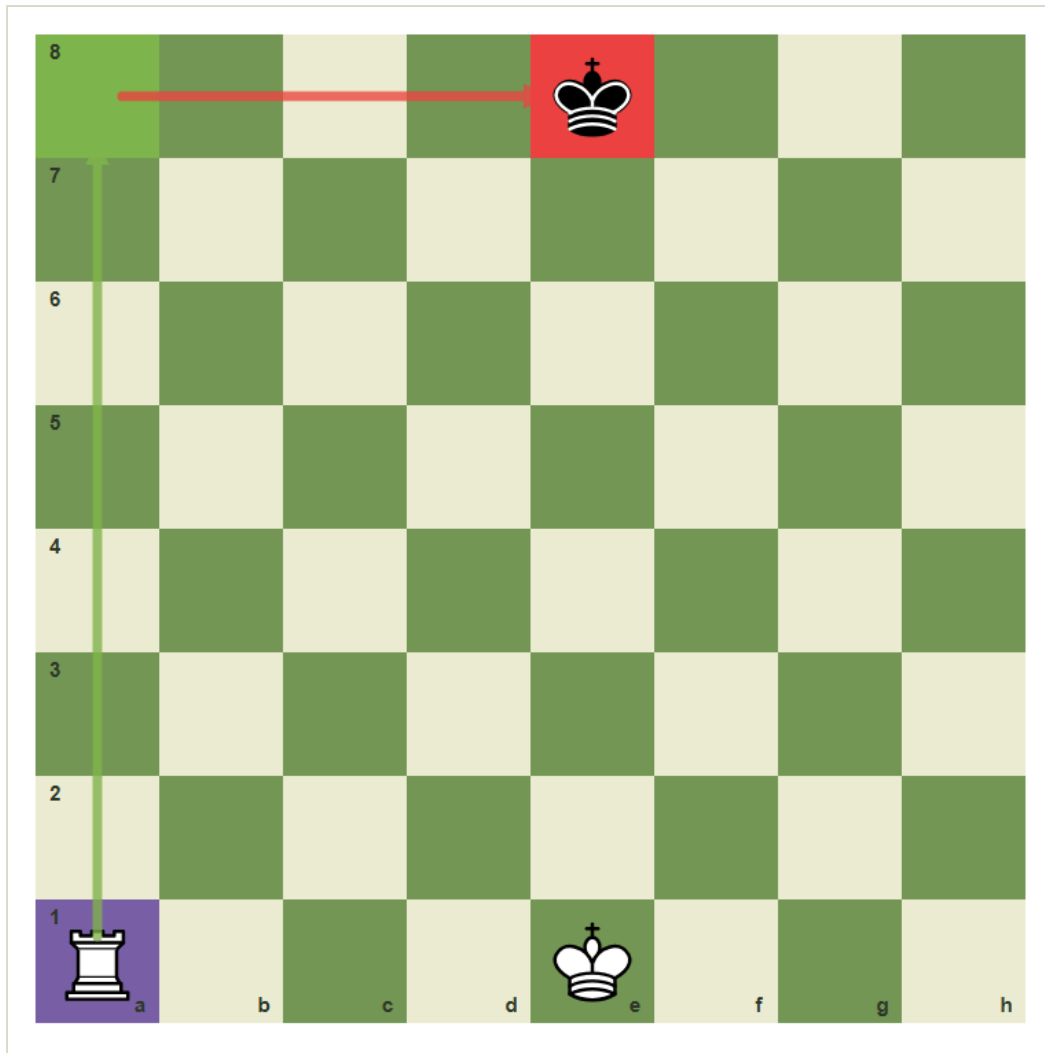
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



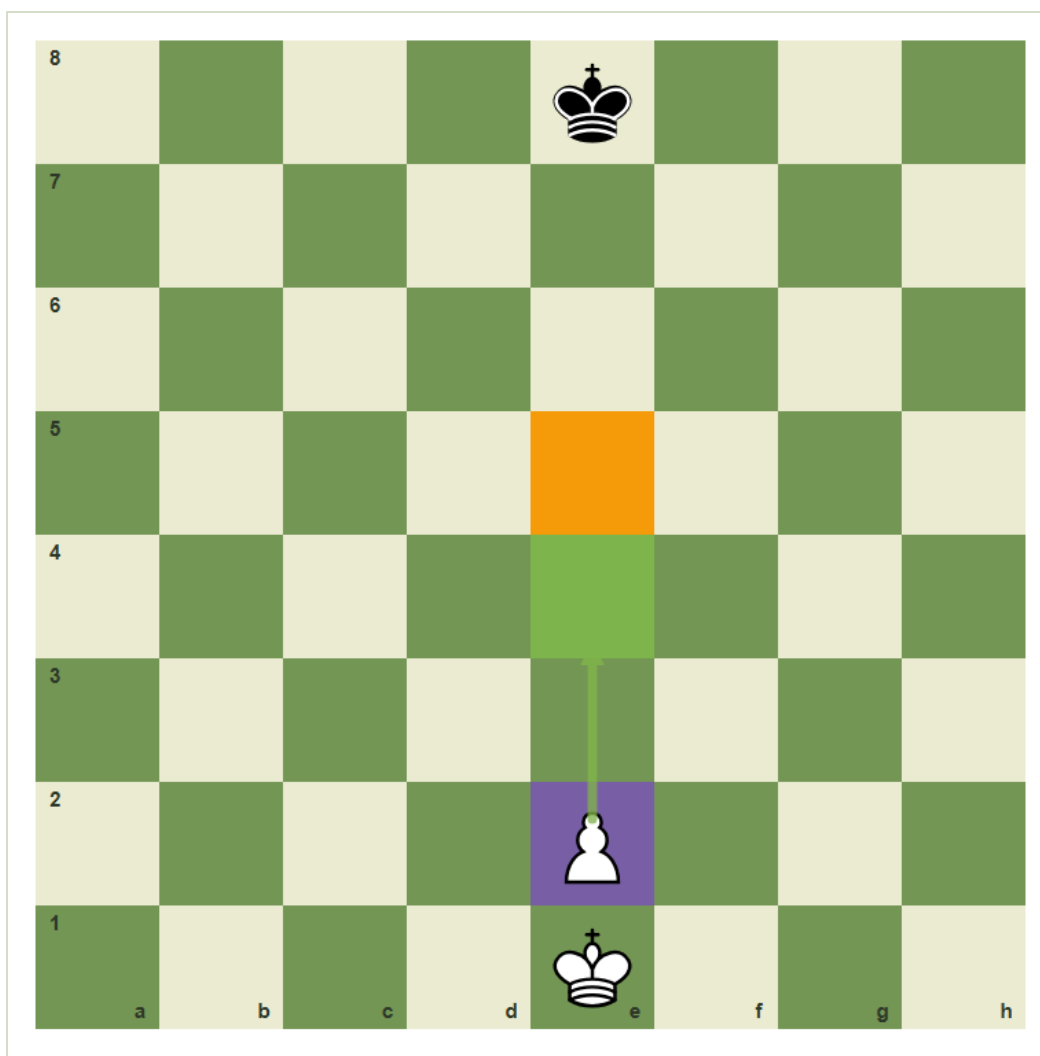
Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

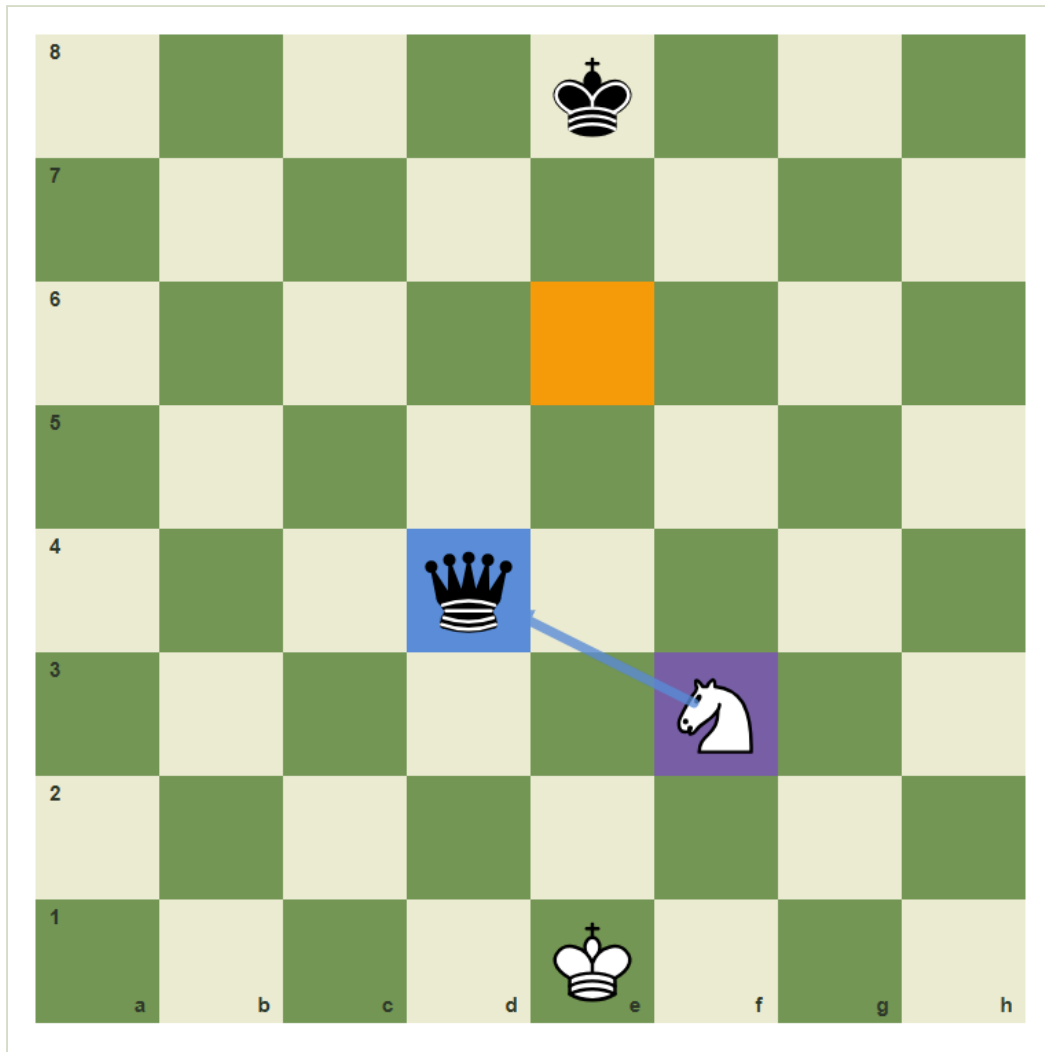
Training Diagram: review position



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

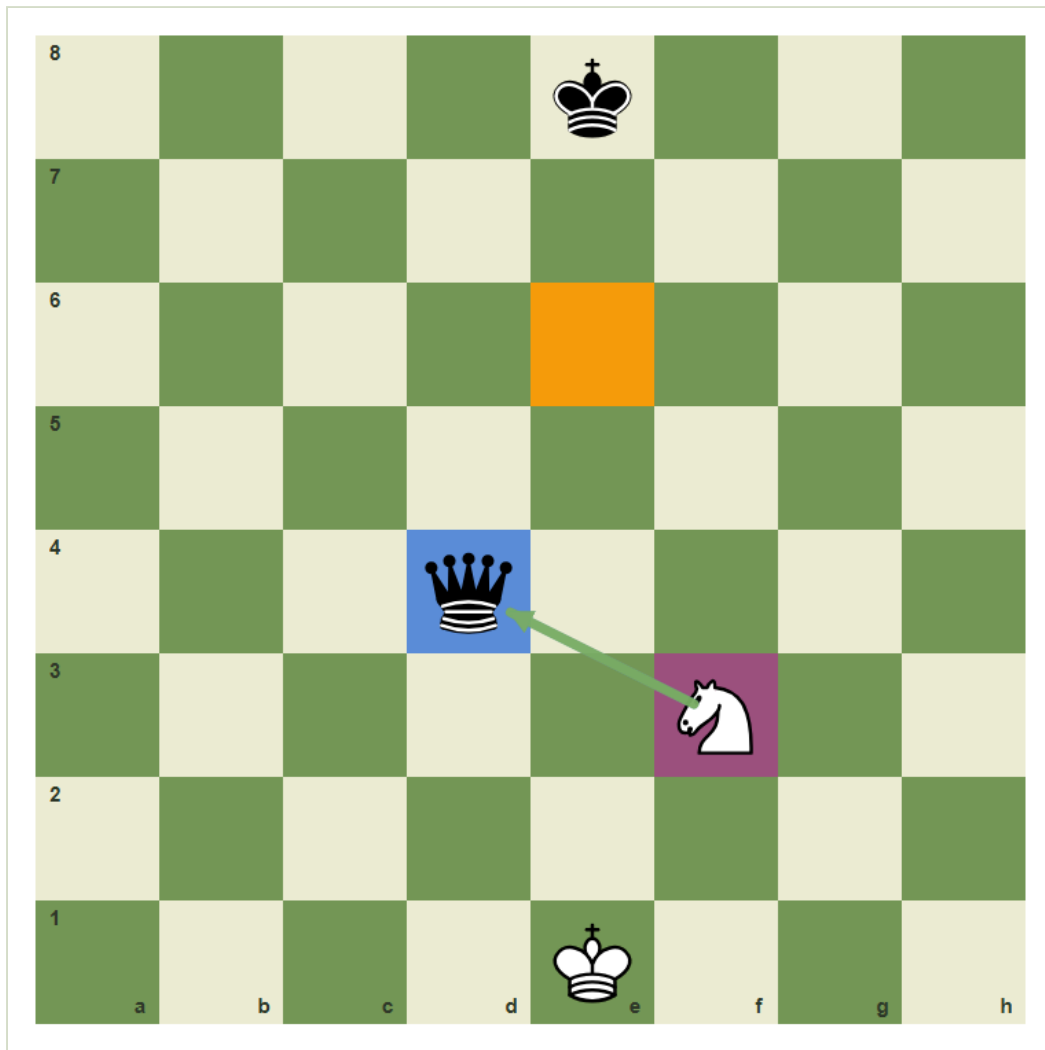
Play the highlighted move from **f3** to **d4**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Static Vs Dynamic Advantages Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **static vs dynamic advantages**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Static Vs Dynamic Advantages Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **static vs dynamic advantages**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Static Vs Dynamic Advantages Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **static vs dynamic advantages**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Prophylaxis

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Prophylaxis converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

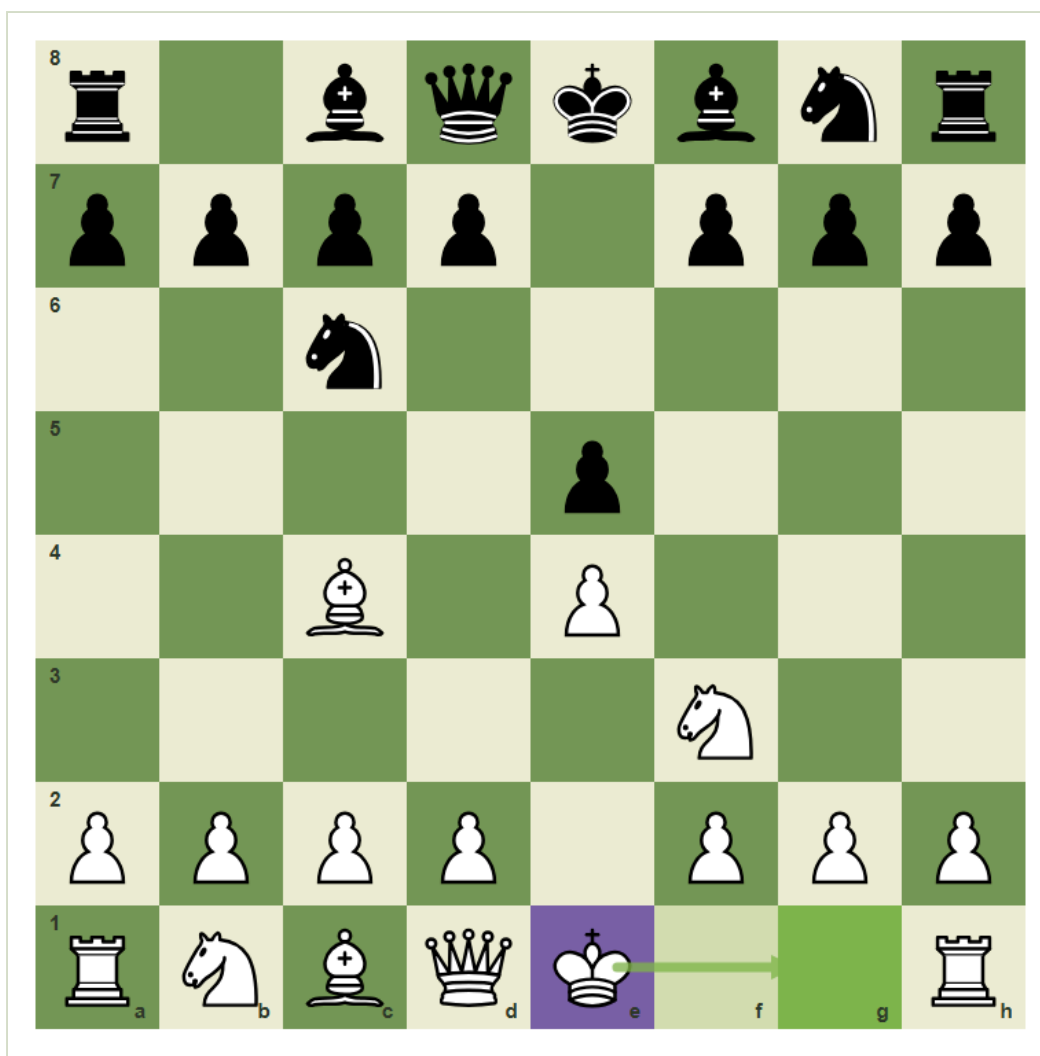
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for prophylaxis.
- Choose a move or plan that fits prophylaxis.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with prophylaxis.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

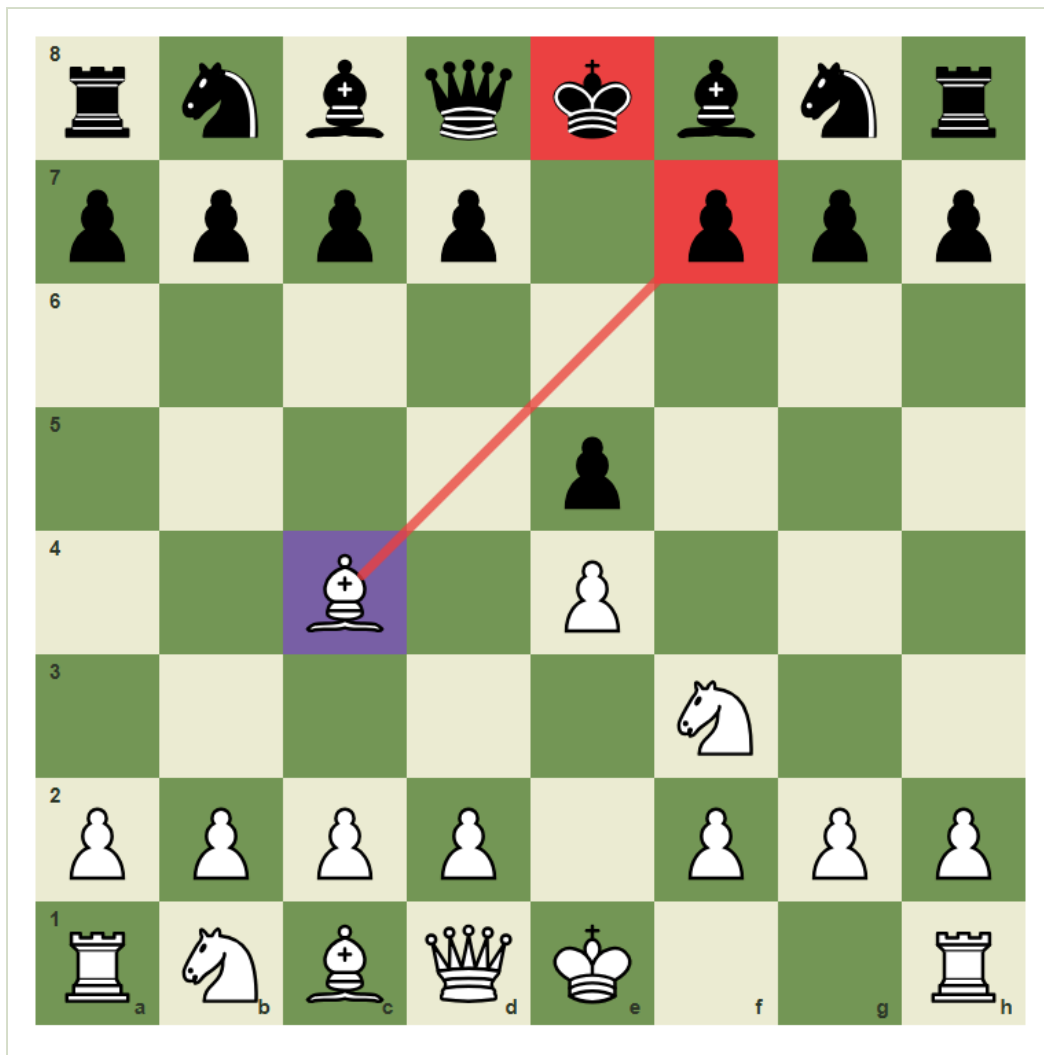
Prophylaxis is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

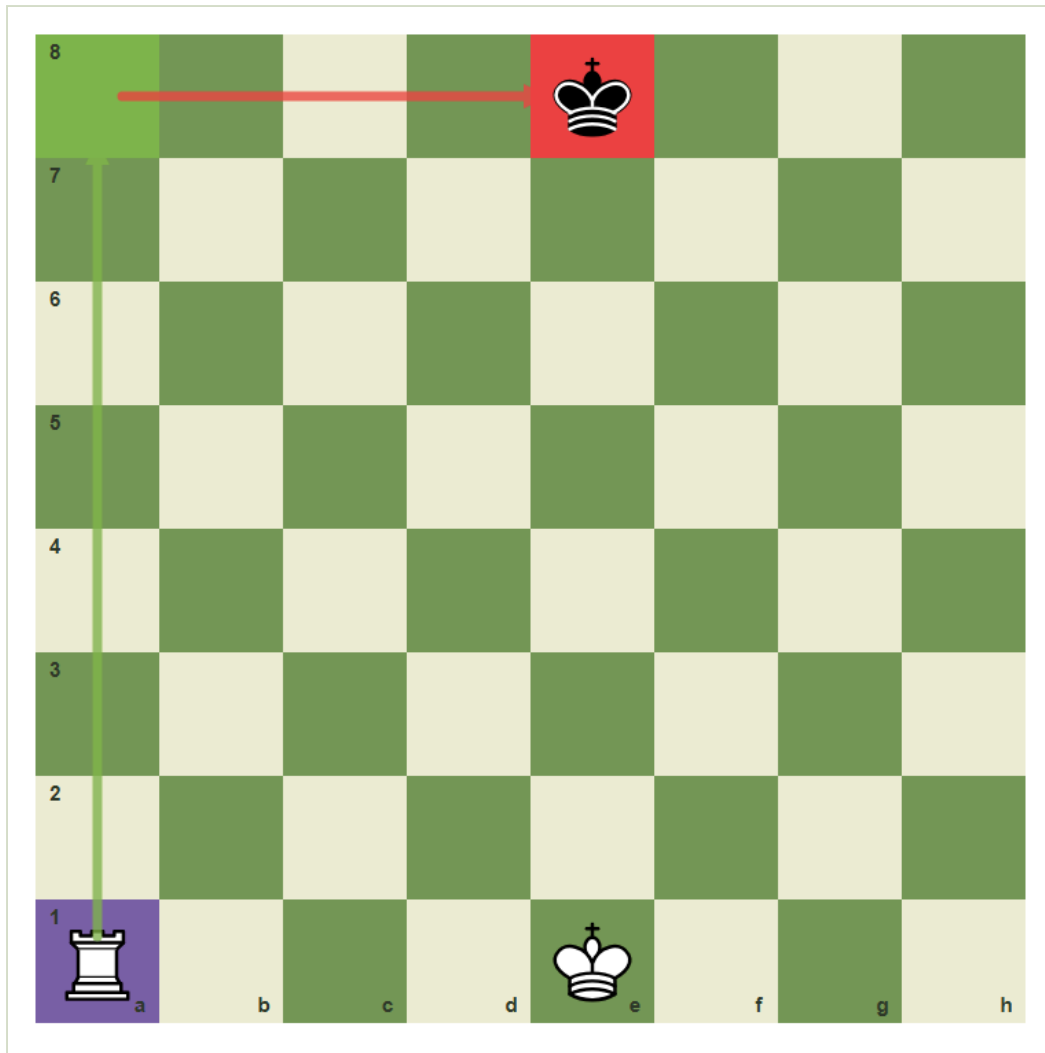


Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

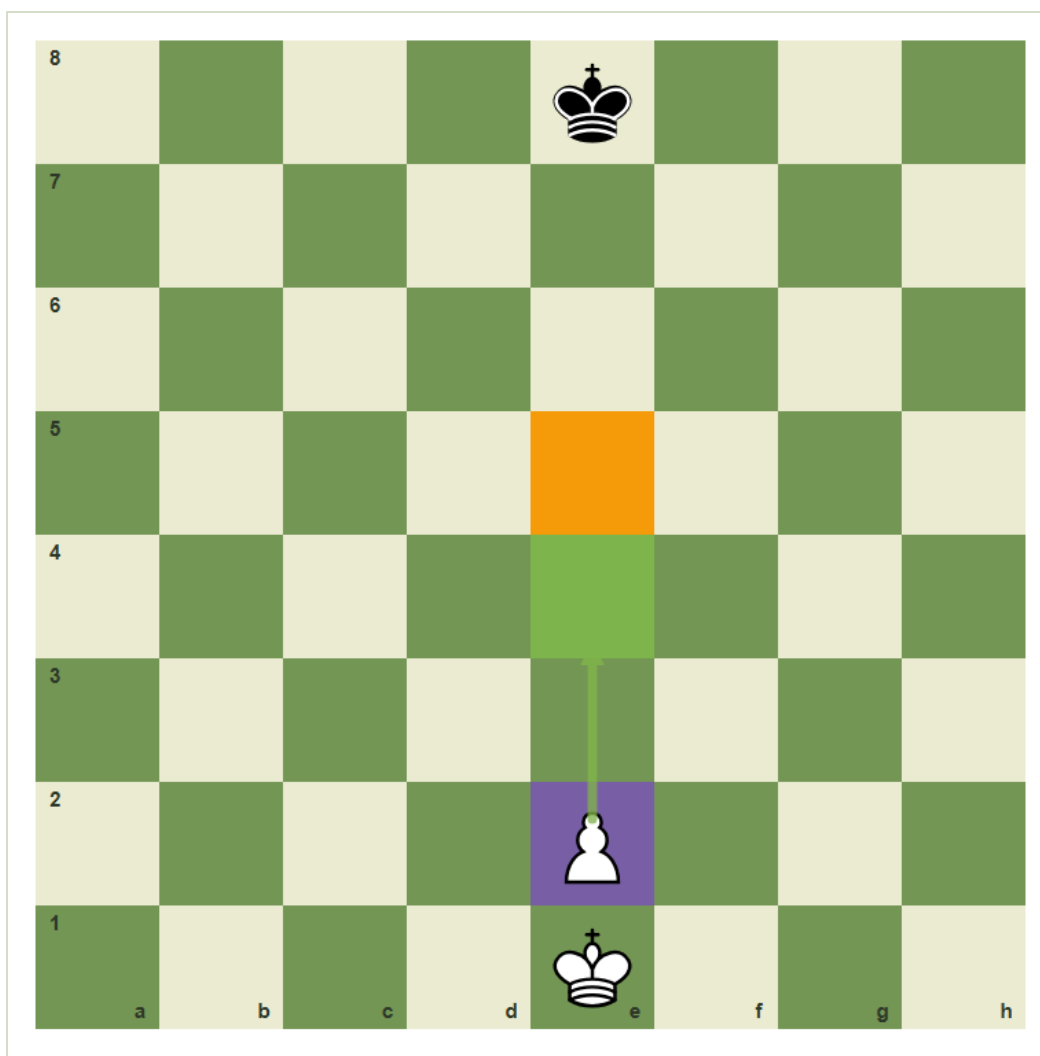
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



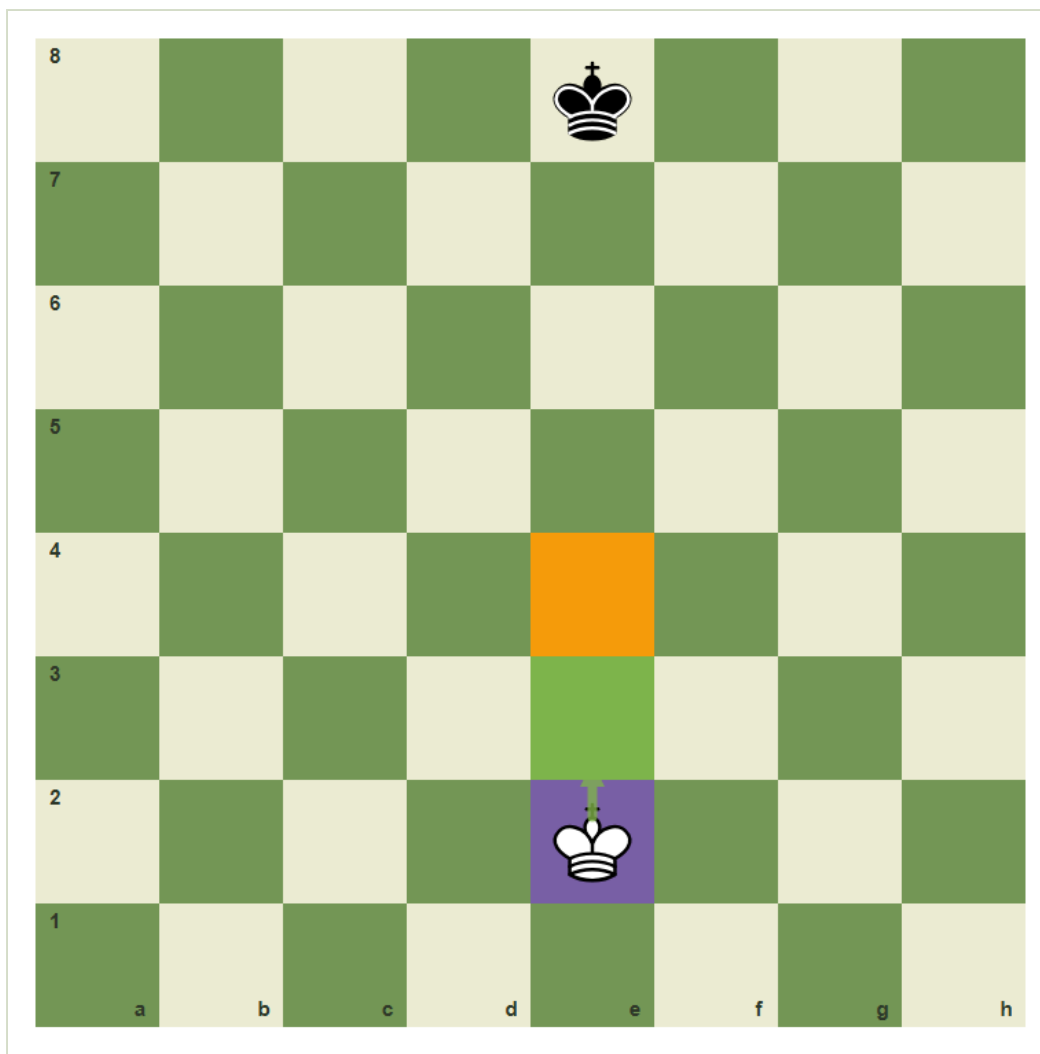
Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

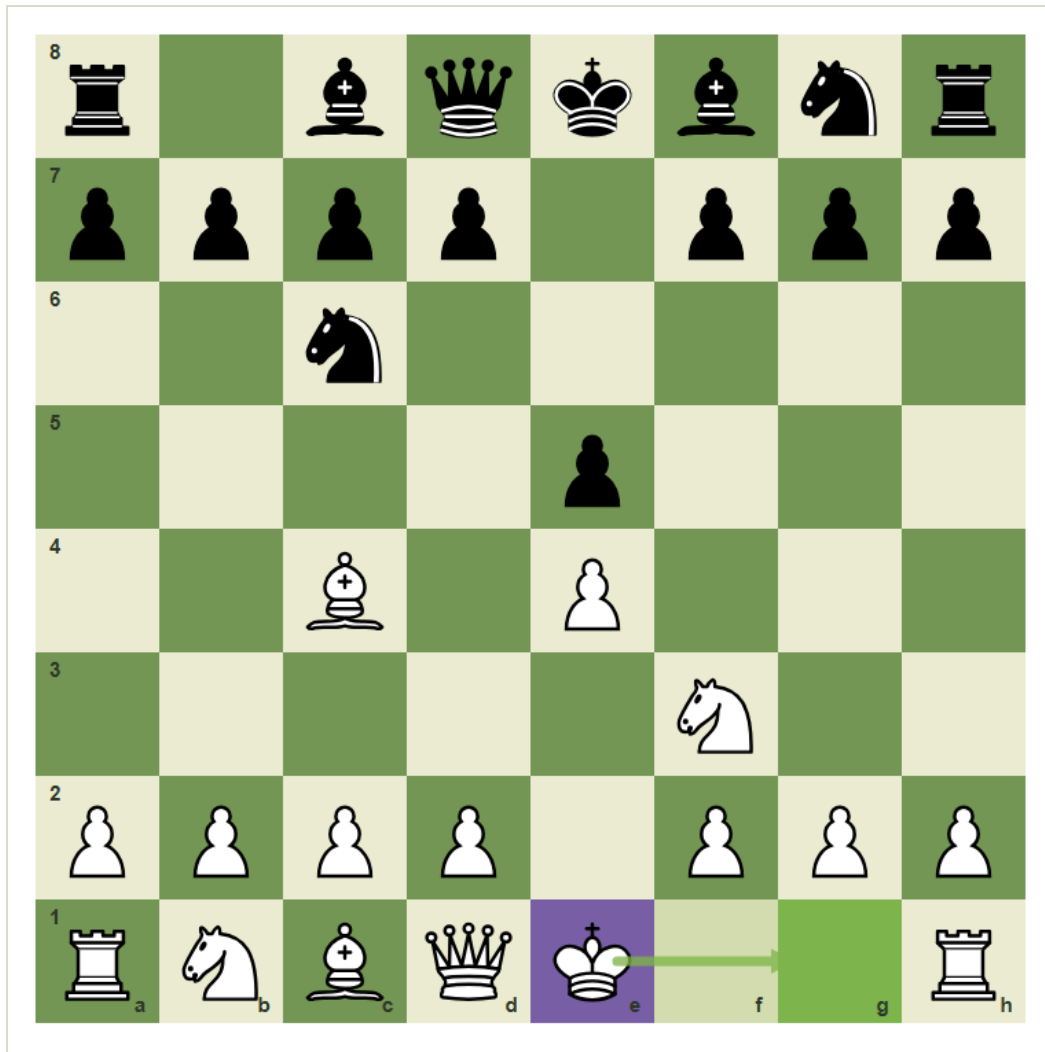
Training Diagram: review position



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

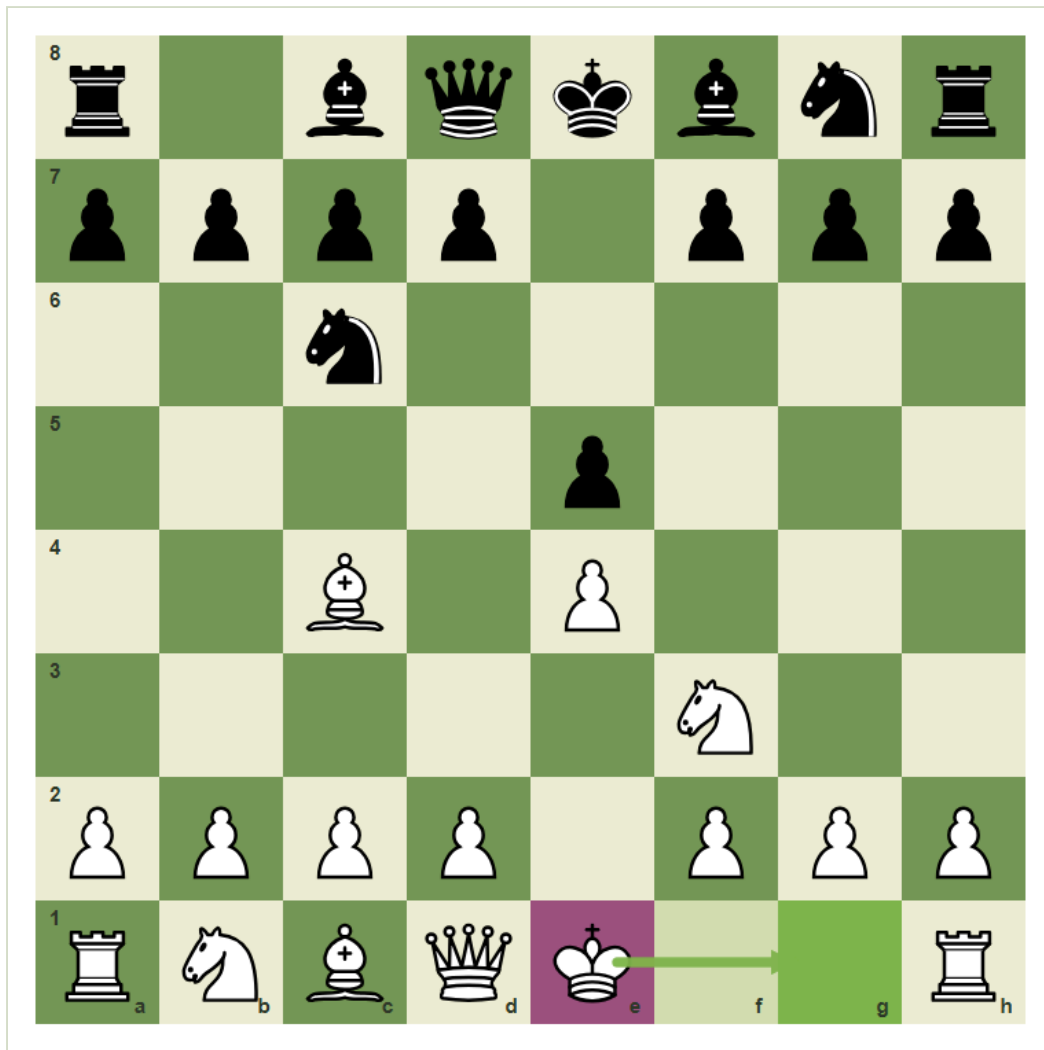
Play the highlighted move from **e1** to **g1**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Prophylaxis Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **prophylaxis**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Prophylaxis Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **prophylaxis**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Prophylaxis Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **prophylaxis**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Pawn Majorities

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Pawn Majorities converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

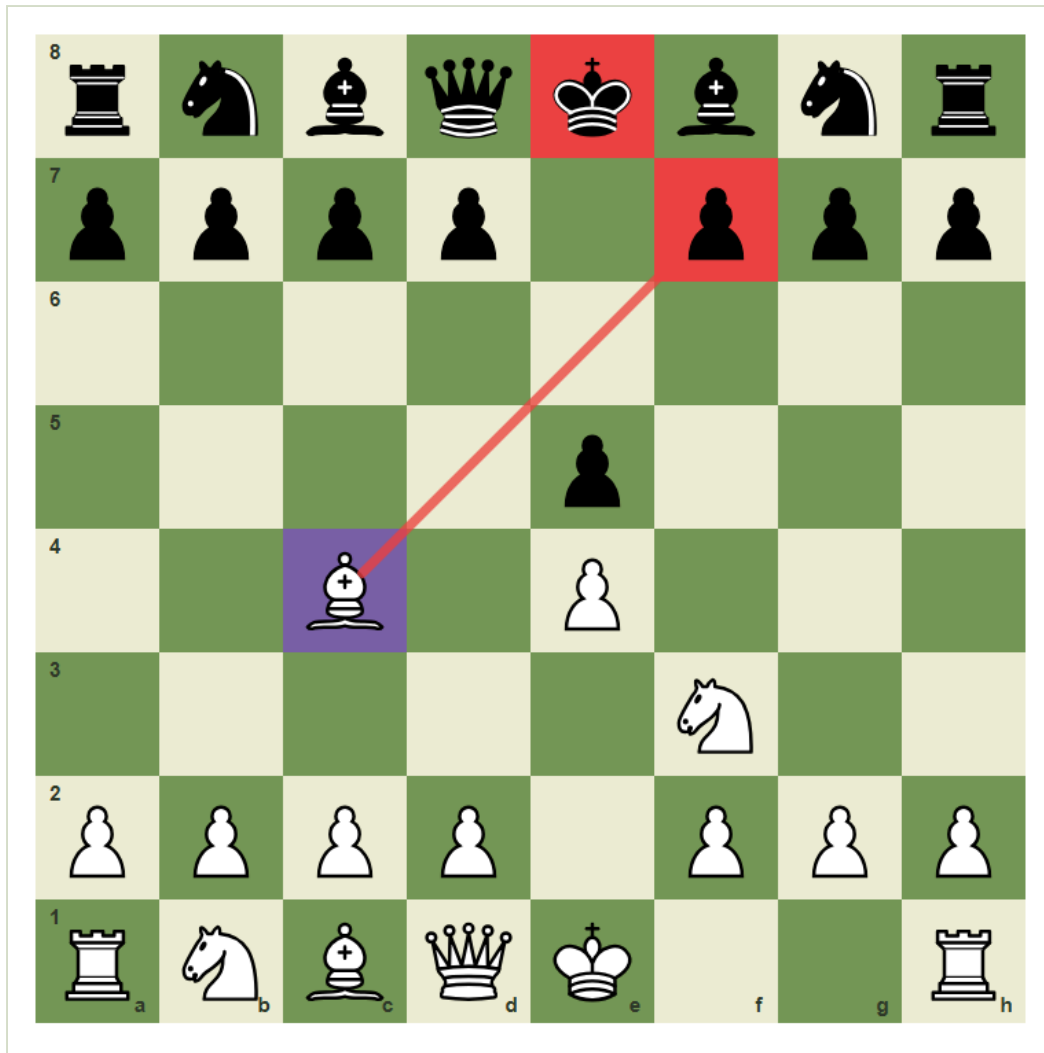
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for pawn majorities.
- Choose a move or plan that fits pawn majorities.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with pawn majorities.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

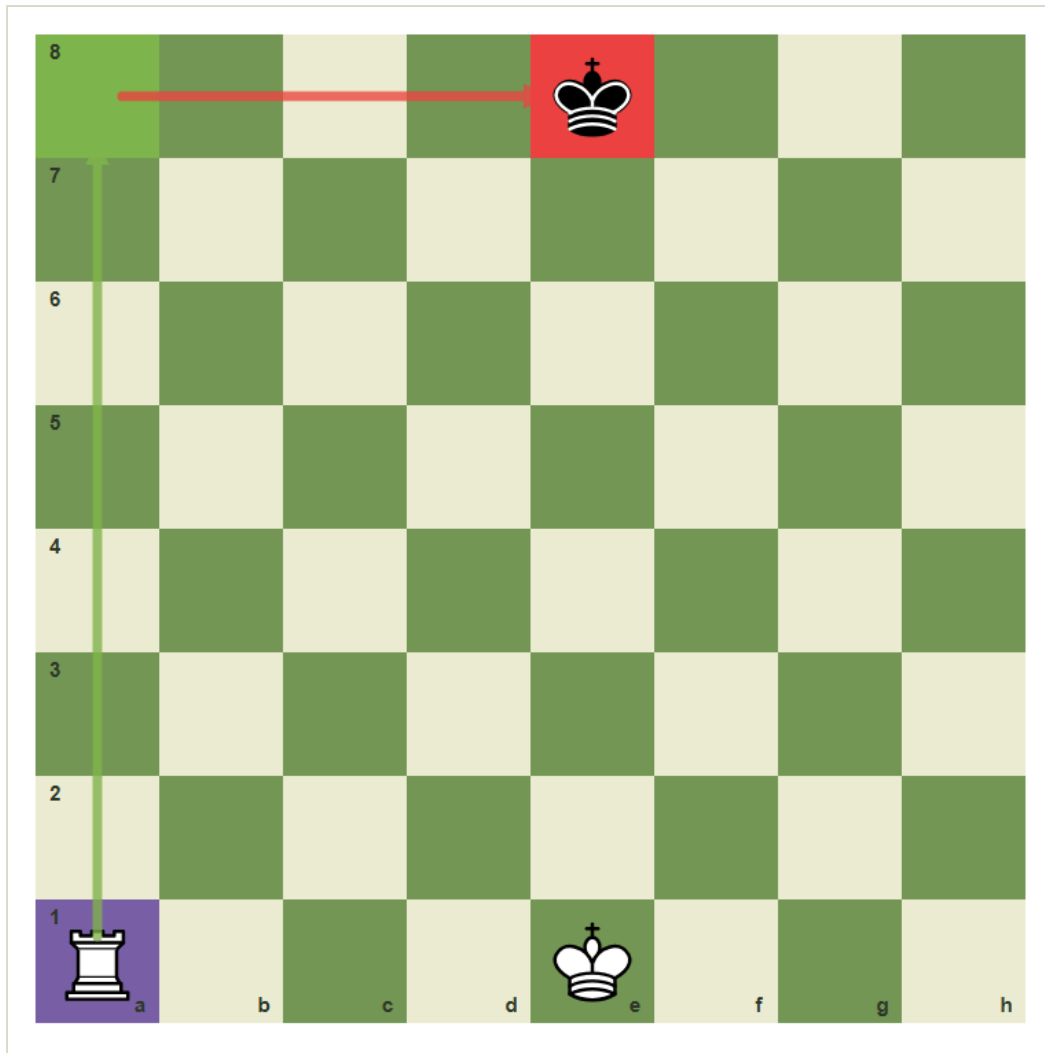
Pawn Majorities is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

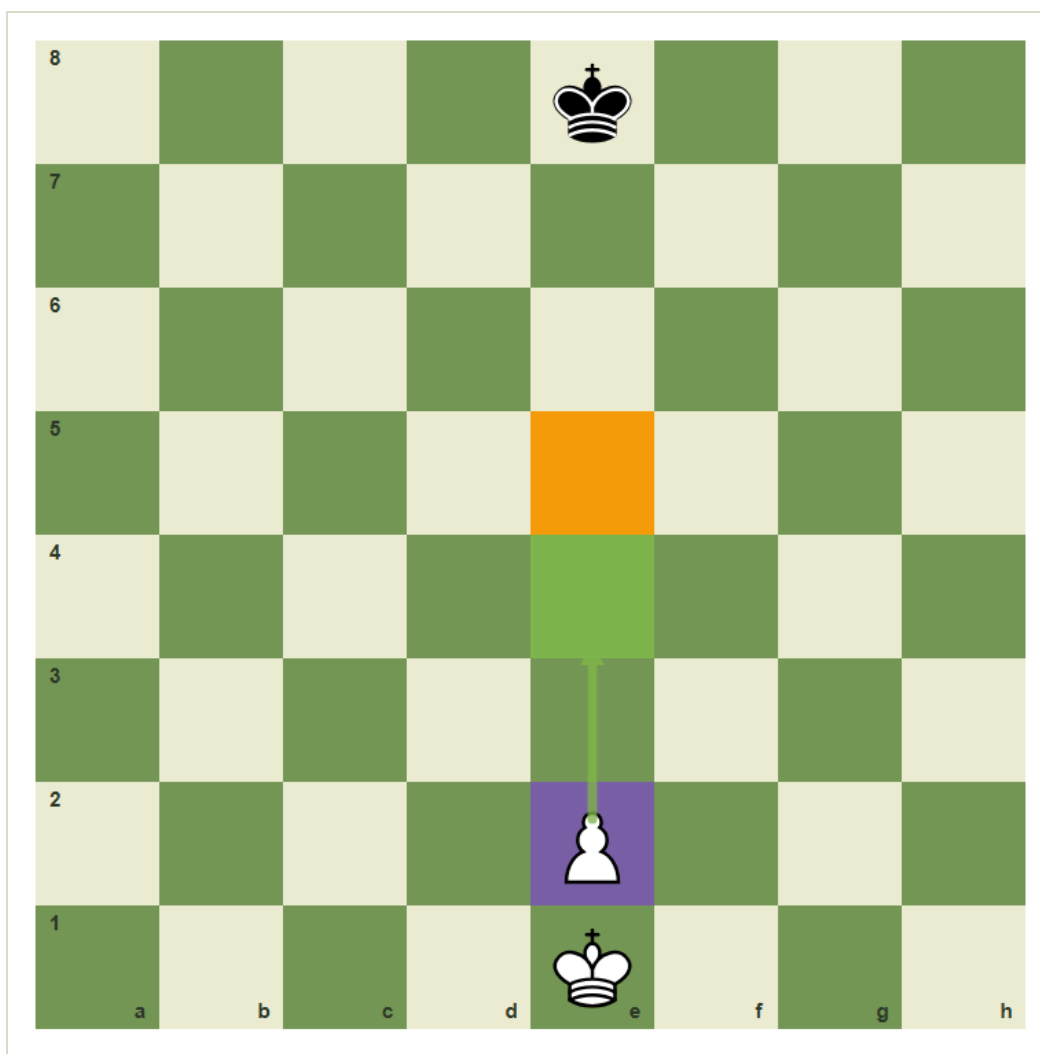


Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

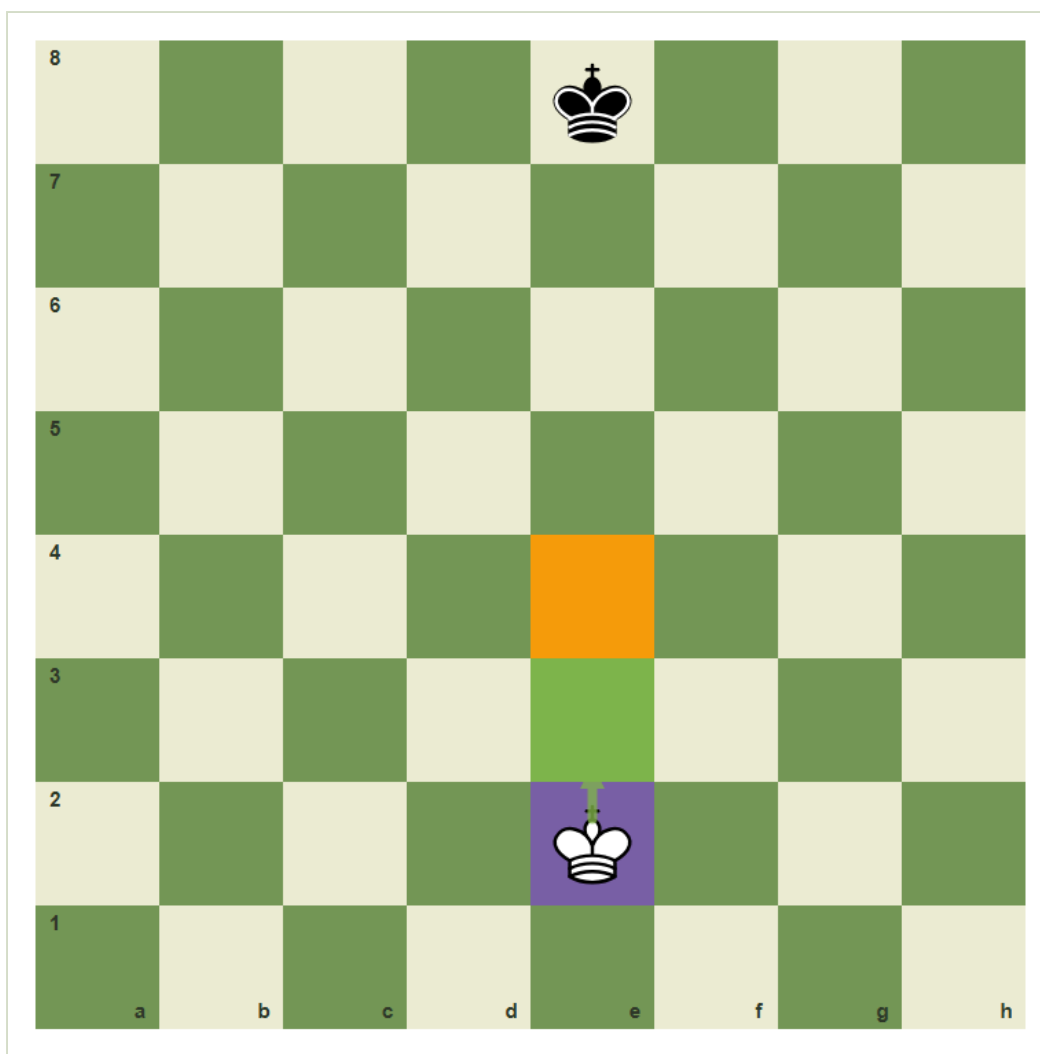
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



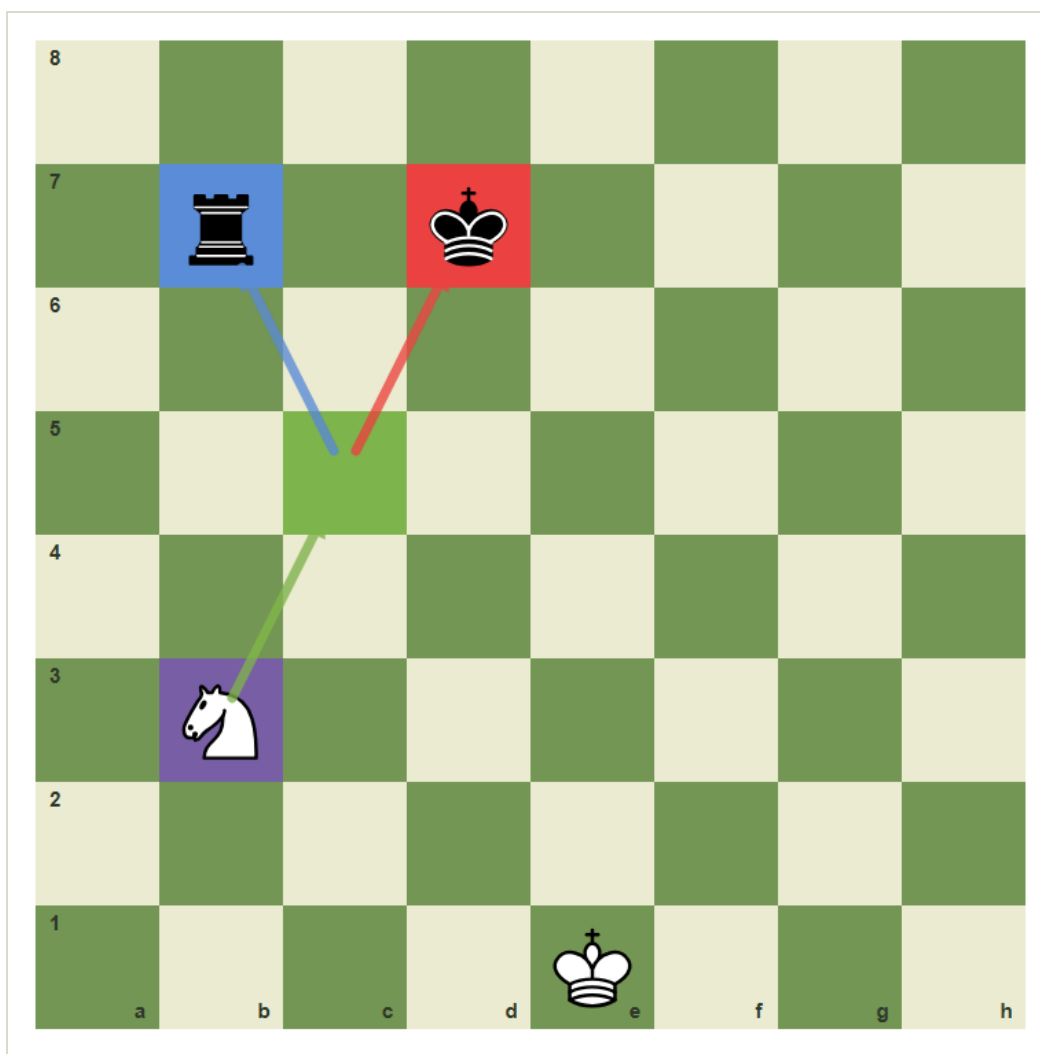
In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

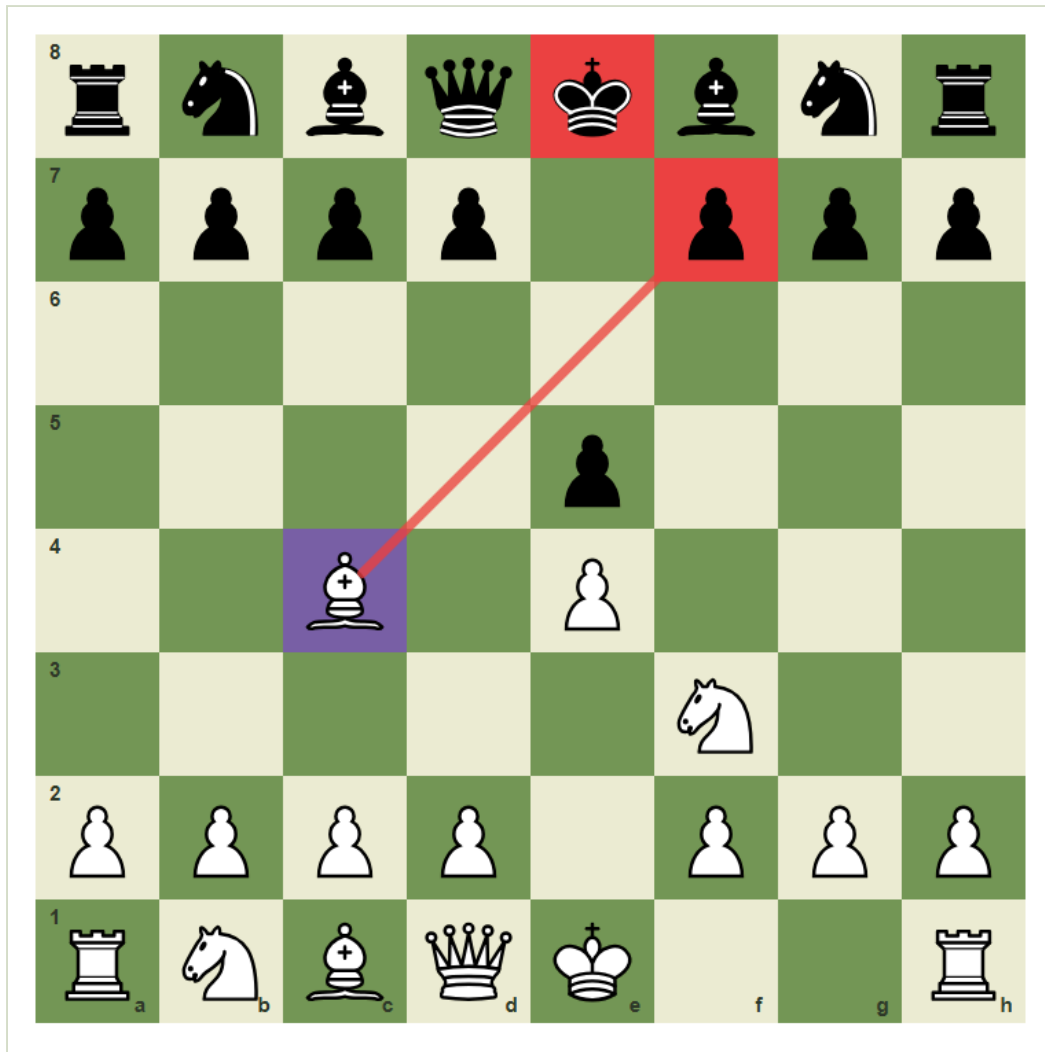
Training Diagram: review position



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

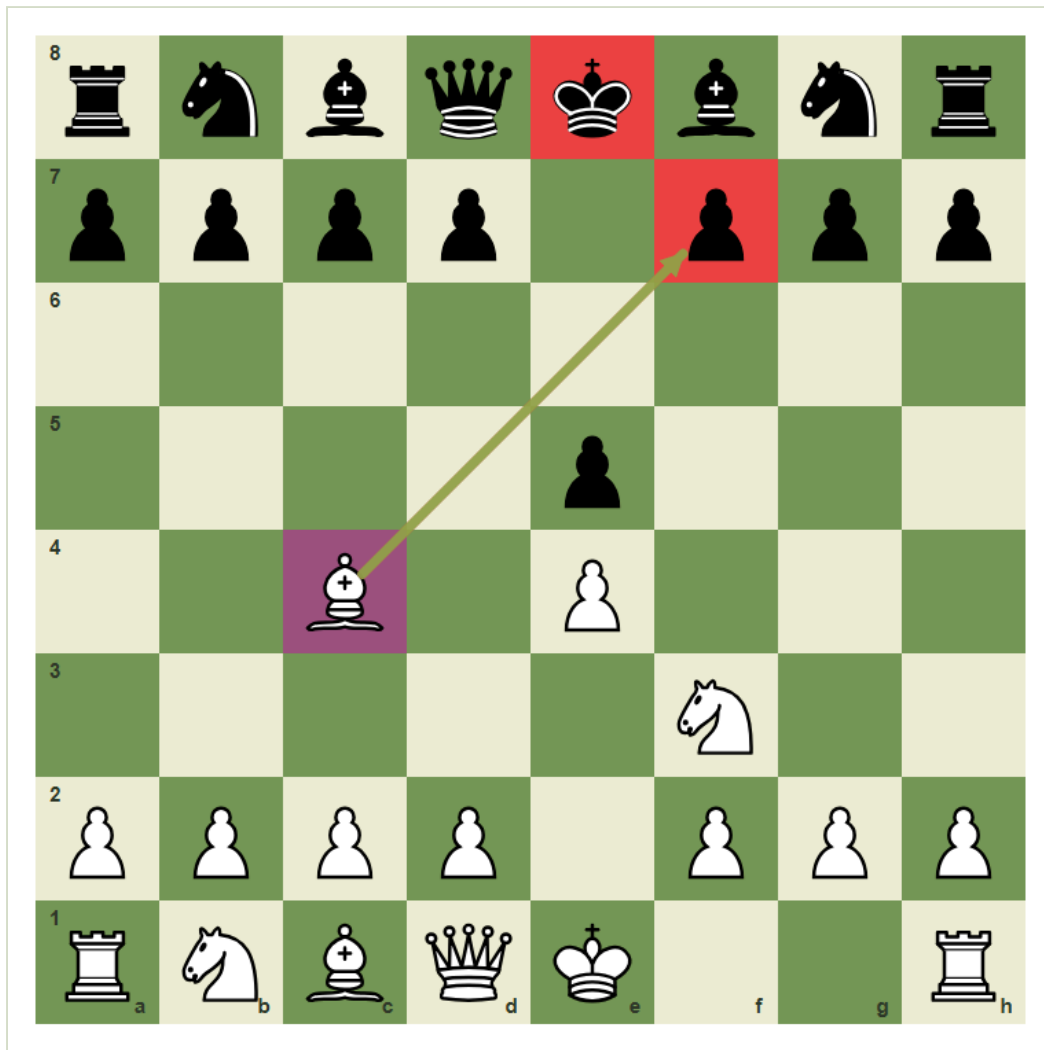
Play the highlighted move from **c4** to **f7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Pawn Majorities Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **pawn majorities**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Pawn Majorities Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **pawn majorities**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Pawn Majorities Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **pawn majorities**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Minority Attack

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Minority Attack converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

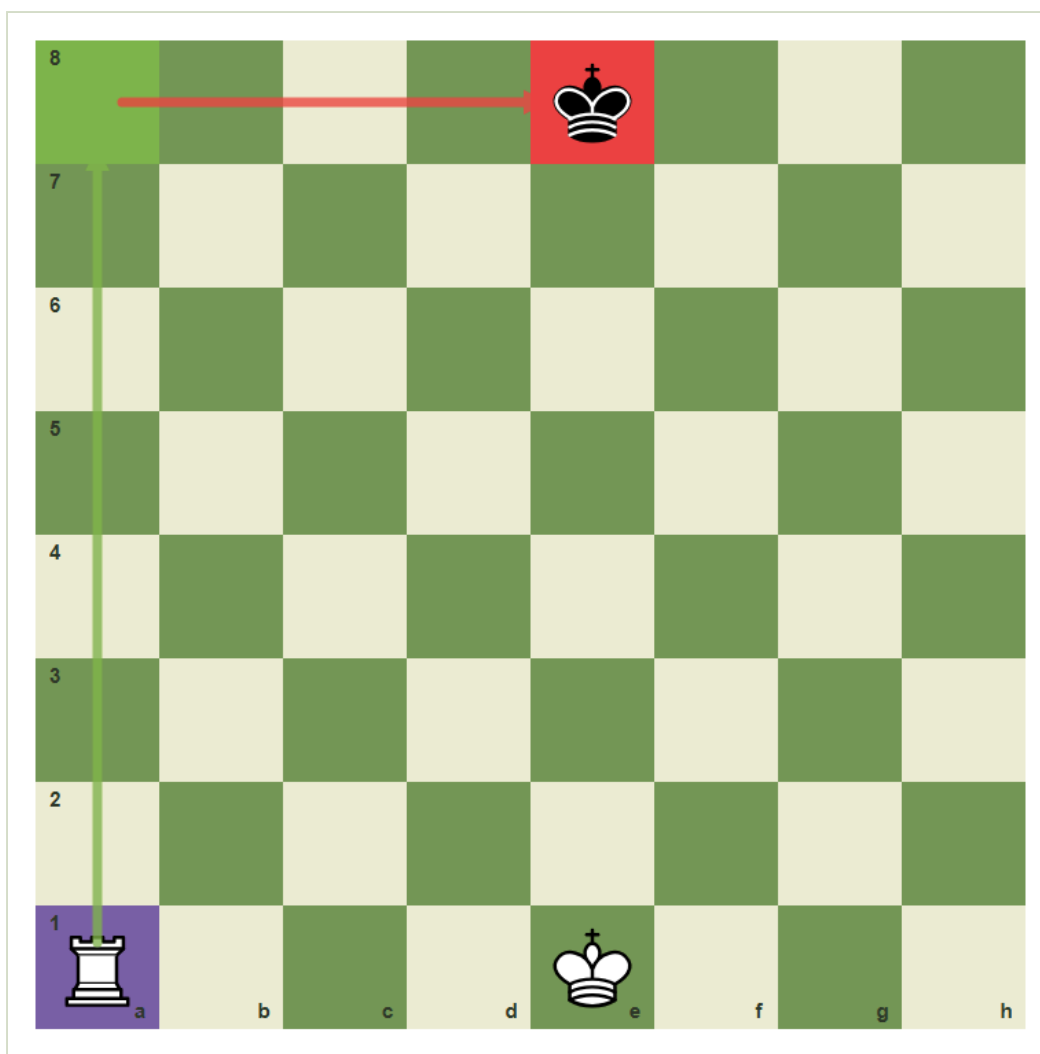
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for minority attack.
- Choose a move or plan that fits minority attack.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with minority attack.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

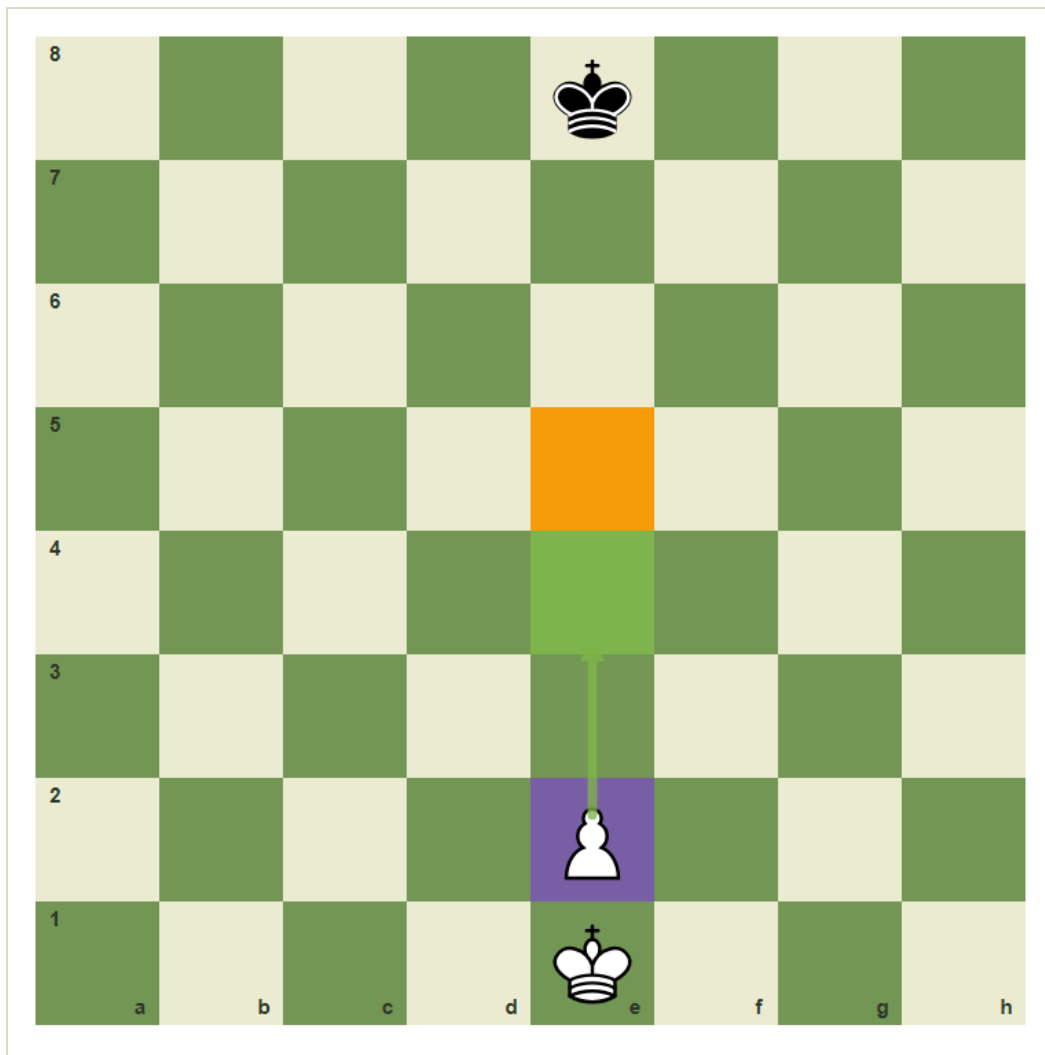
Minority Attack is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Open files are highways for rooks, especially when a king or target is exposed. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

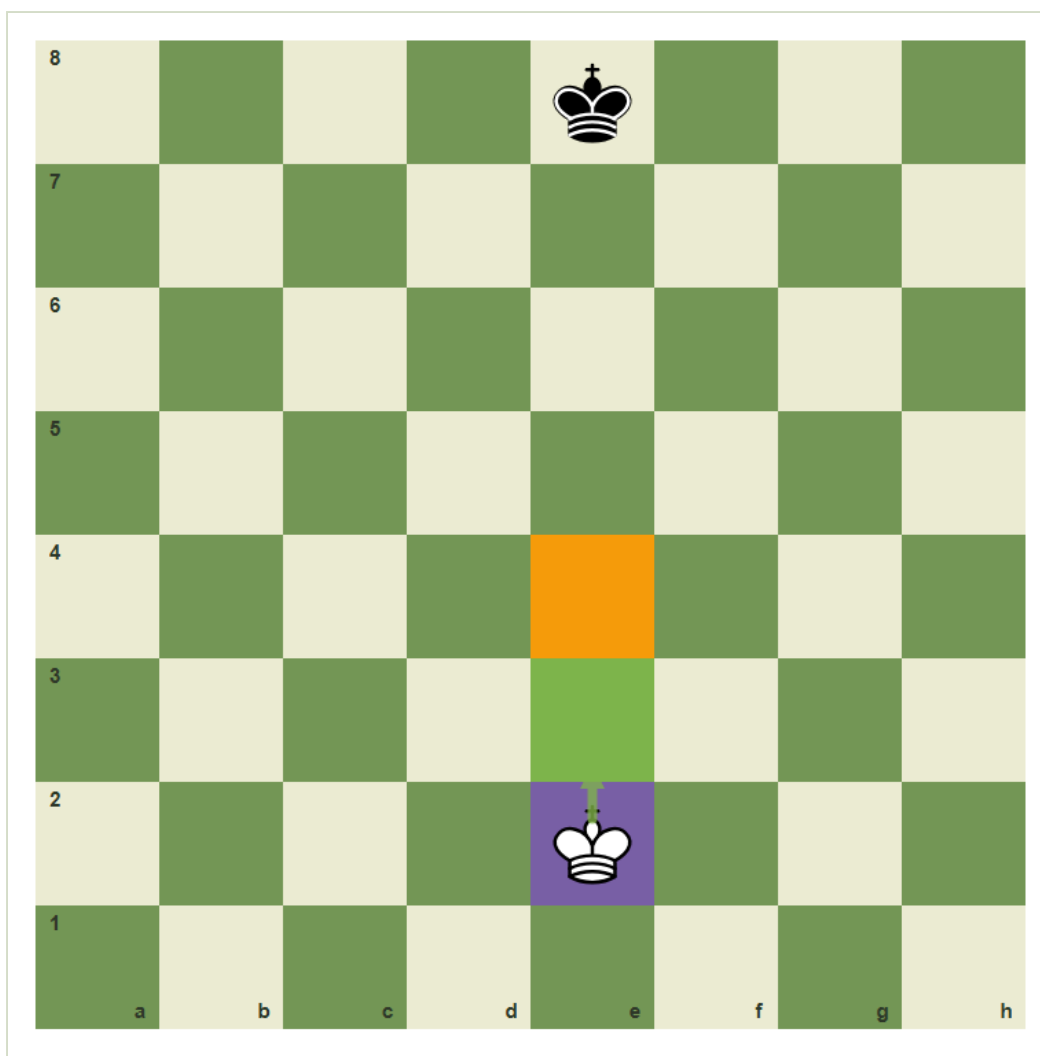


In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

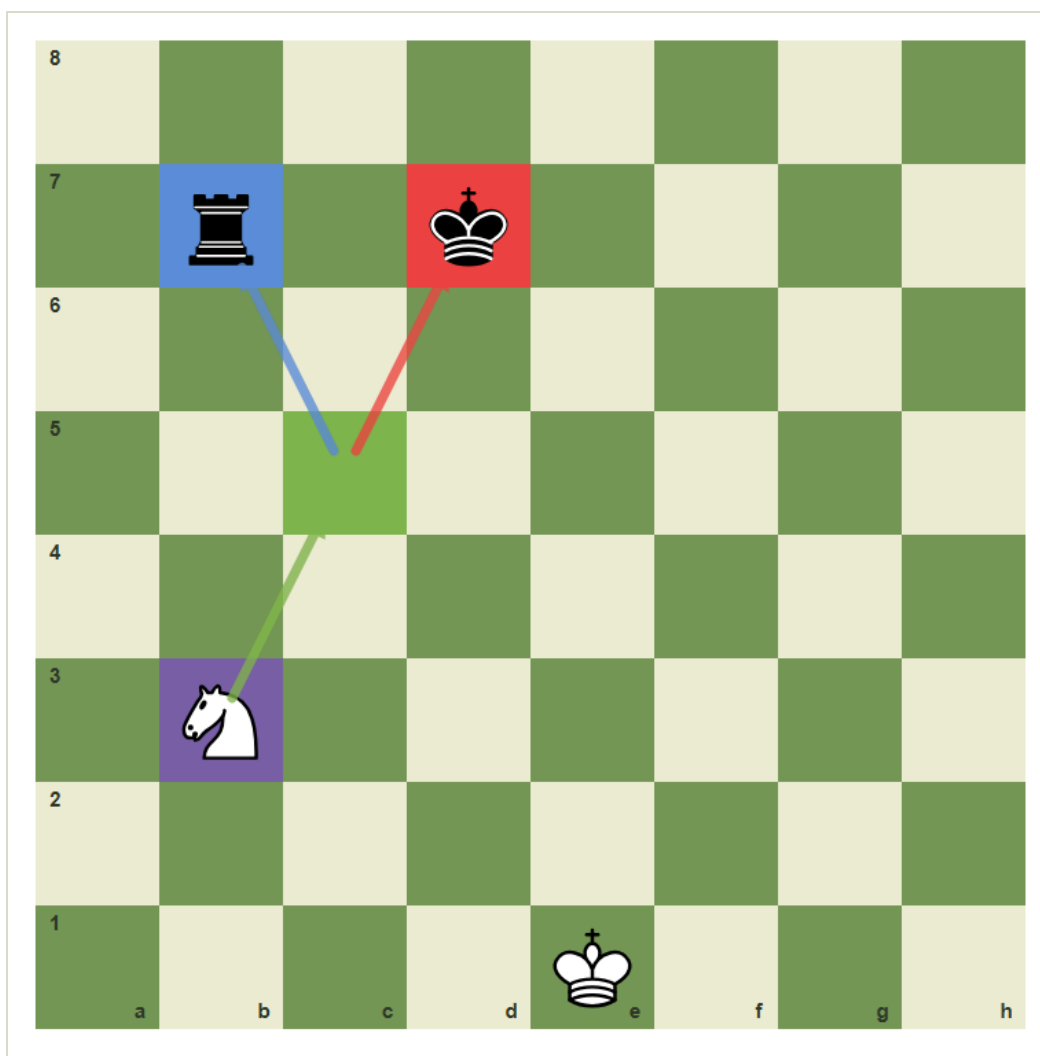
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



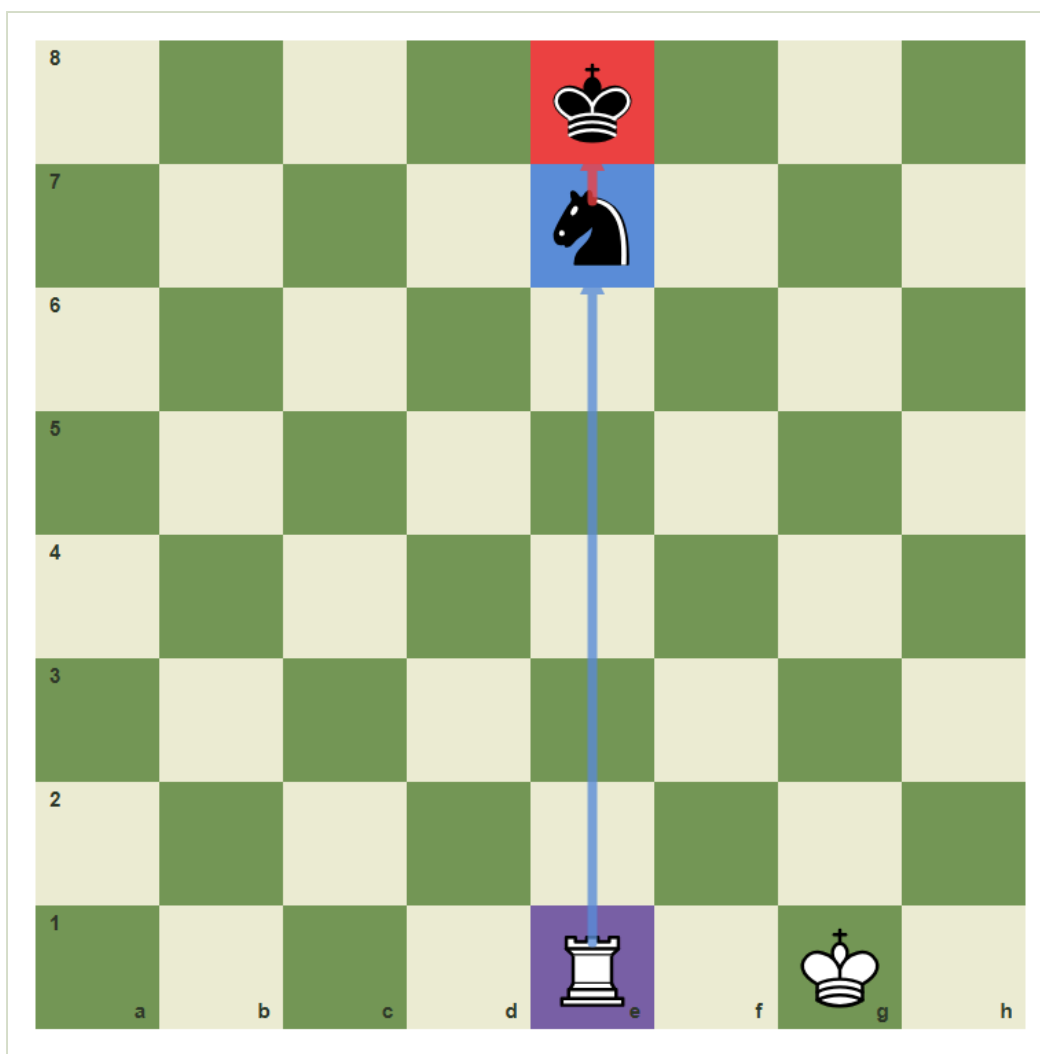
Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

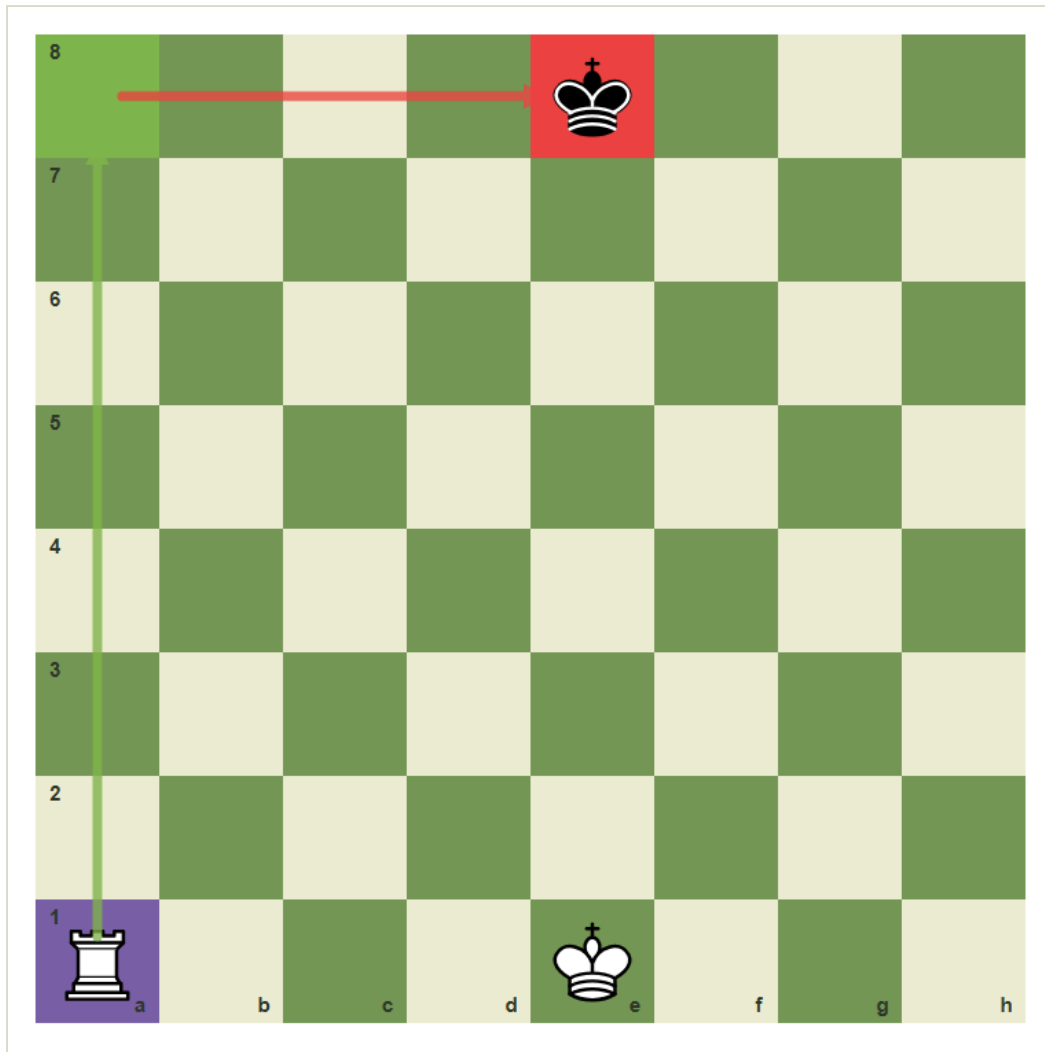
Training Diagram: review position



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

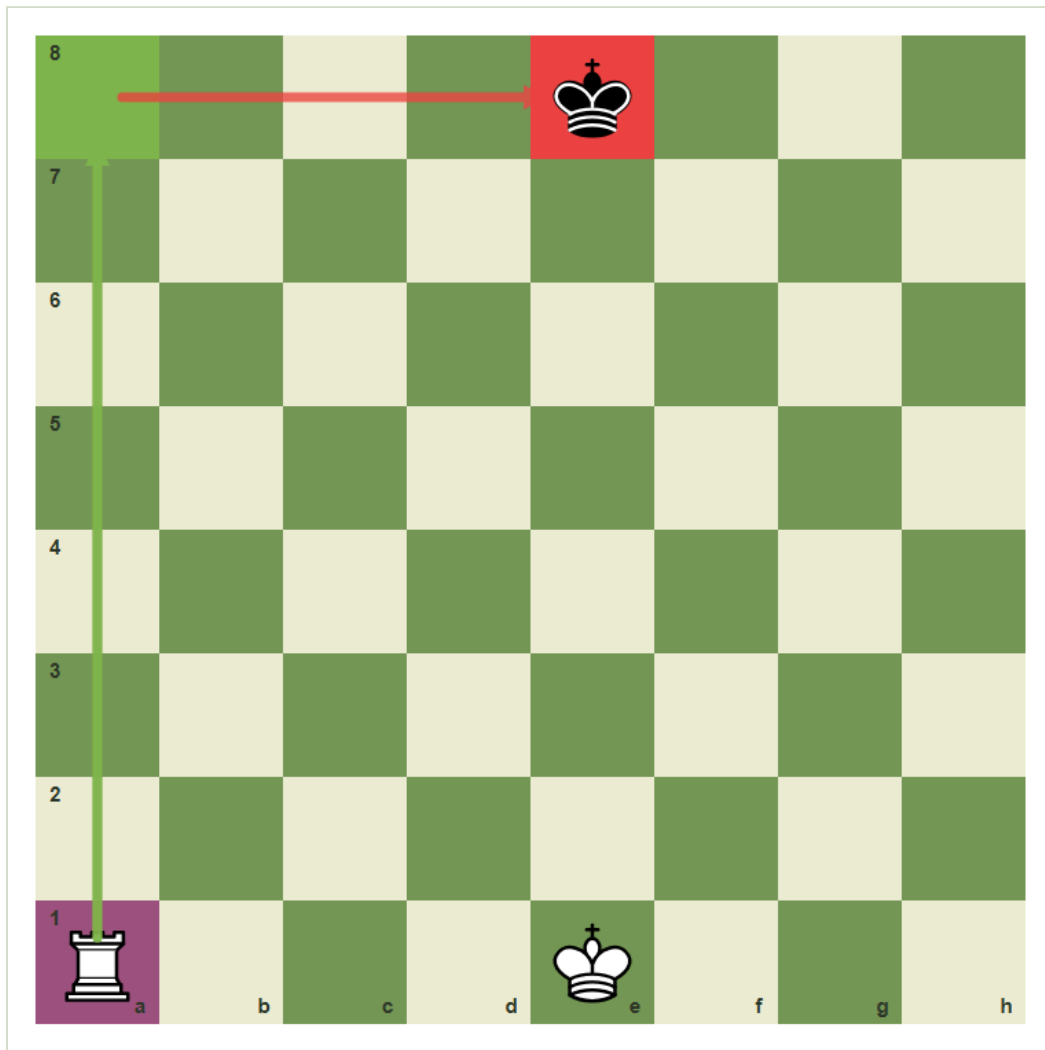
Play the highlighted move from **a1** to **a8**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Minority Attack Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **minority attack**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Minority Attack Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **minority attack**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Minority Attack Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **minority attack**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Isolated Queen Pawn Positions

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Isolated Queen Pawn Positions converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

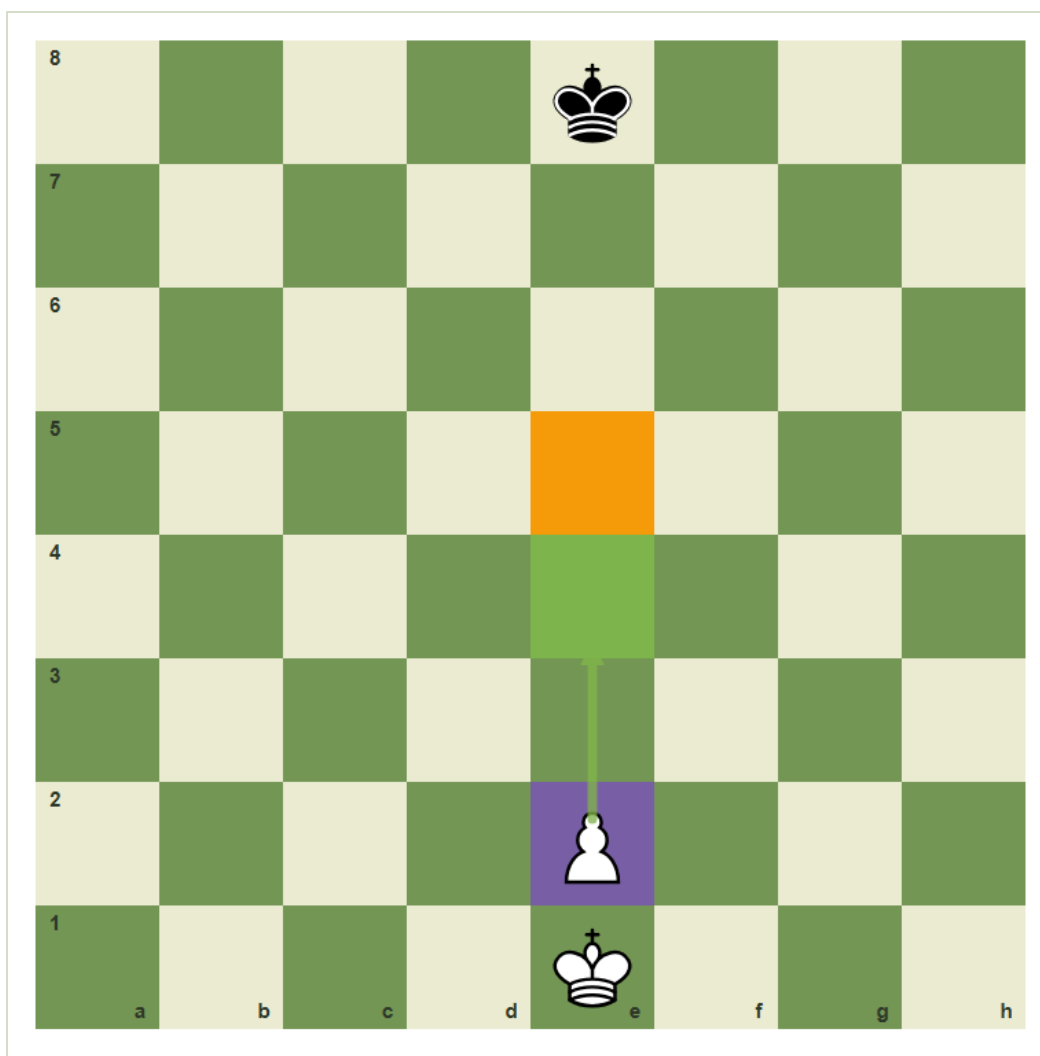
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for isolated queen pawn positions.
- Choose a move or plan that fits isolated queen pawn positions.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with isolated queen pawn positions.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

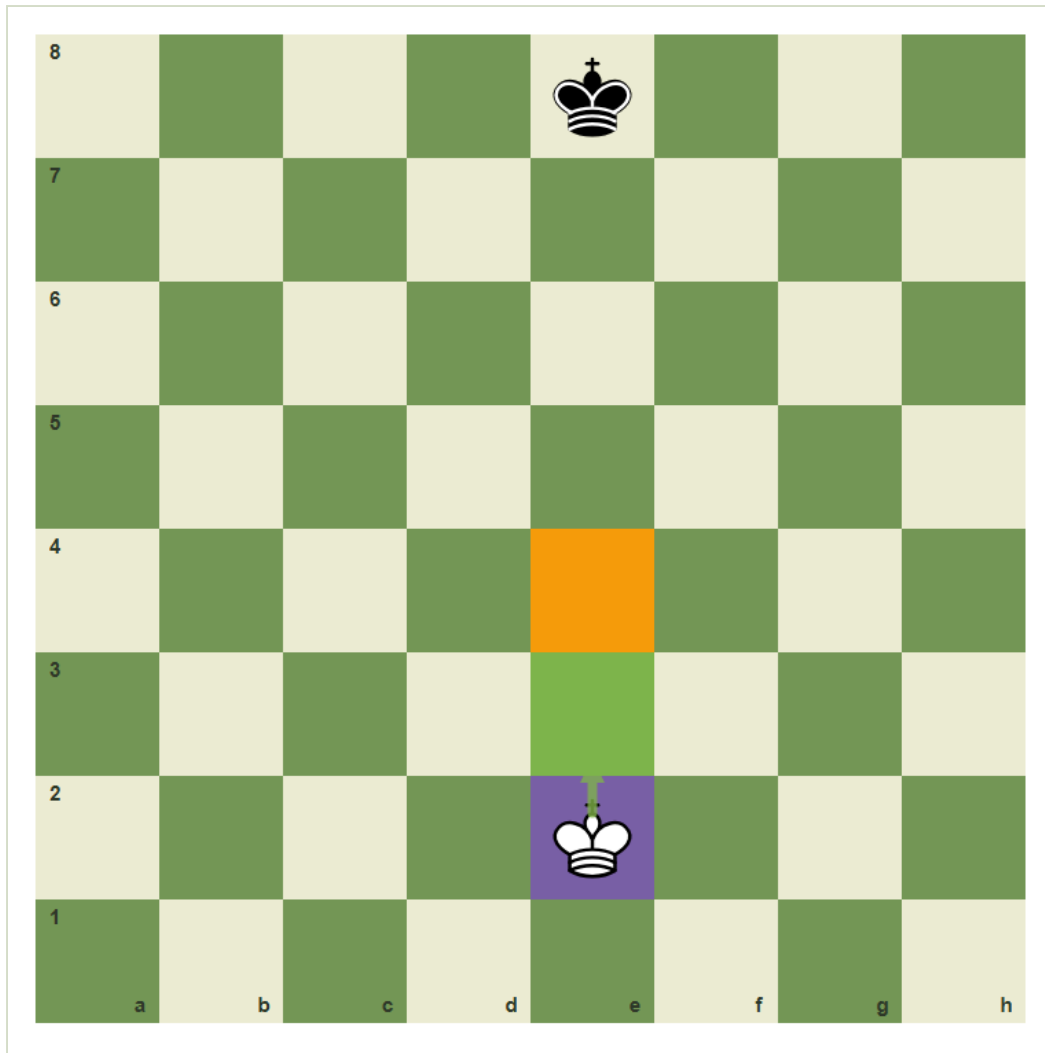
Isolated Queen Pawn Positions is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



In pawn endings, one tempo can decide whether the pawn advances or stalls. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

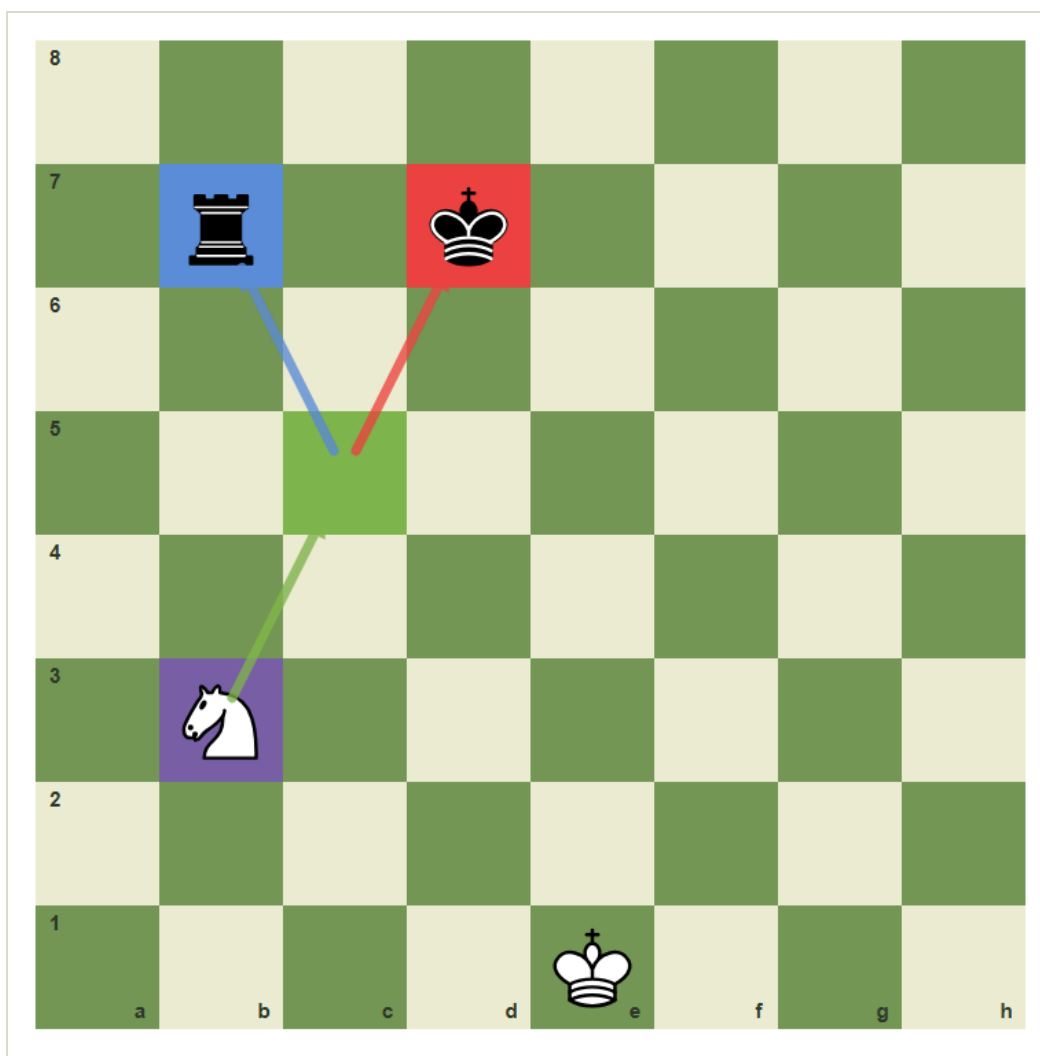


Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

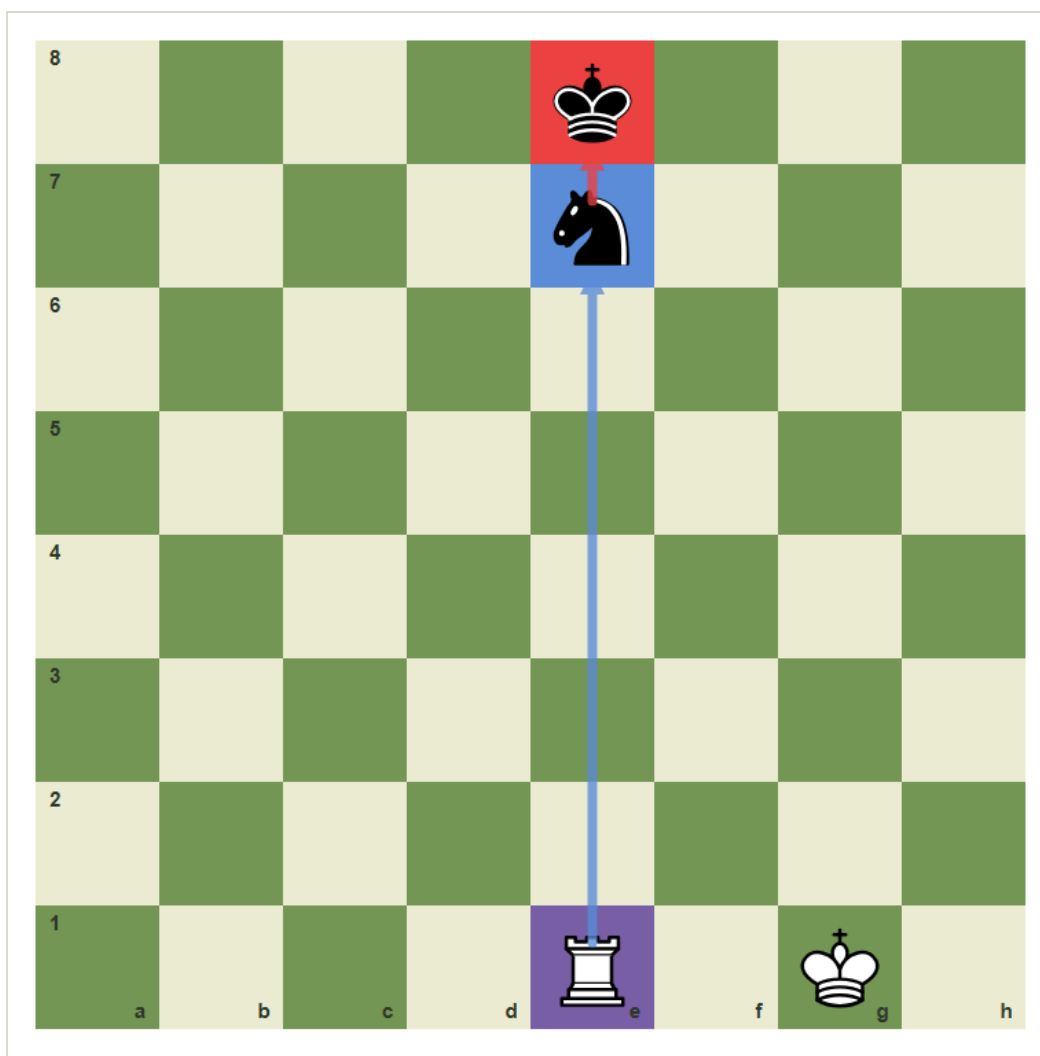
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



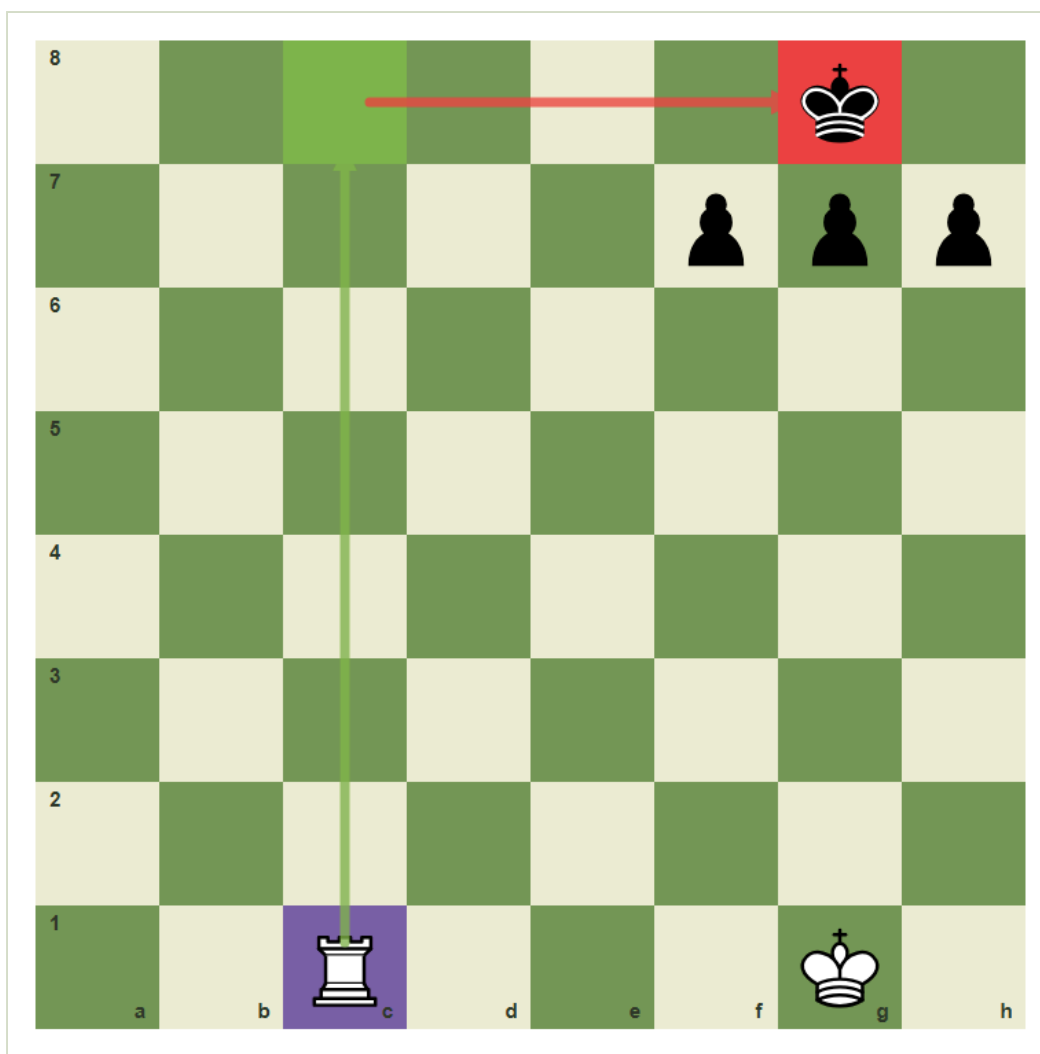
The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

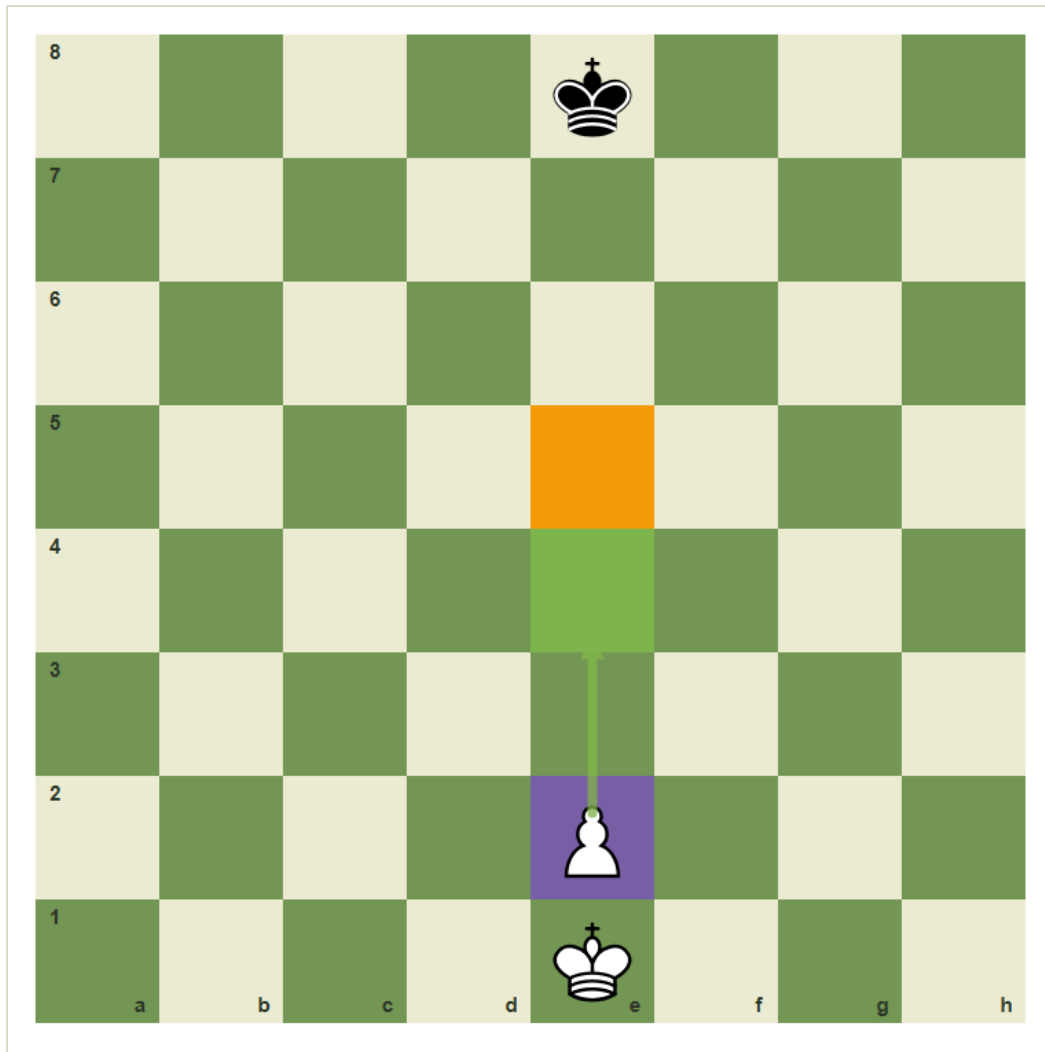
Training Diagram: review position



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

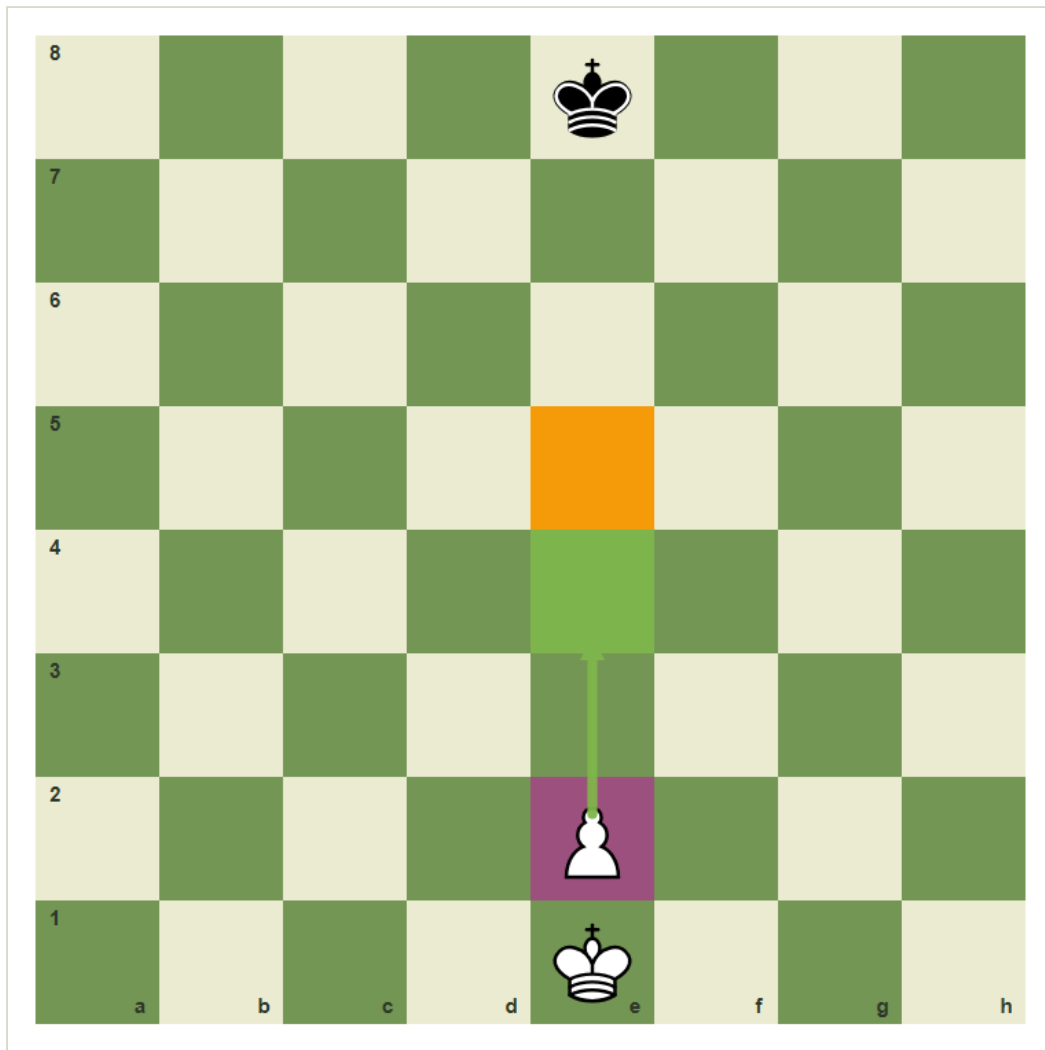
Play the highlighted move from **e2** to **e4**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Isolated Queen Pawn Positions Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **isolated queen pawn positions**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Isolated Queen Pawn Positions Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **isolated queen pawn positions**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Isolated Queen Pawn Positions Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **isolated queen pawn positions**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Hanging Pawns

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Hanging Pawns converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

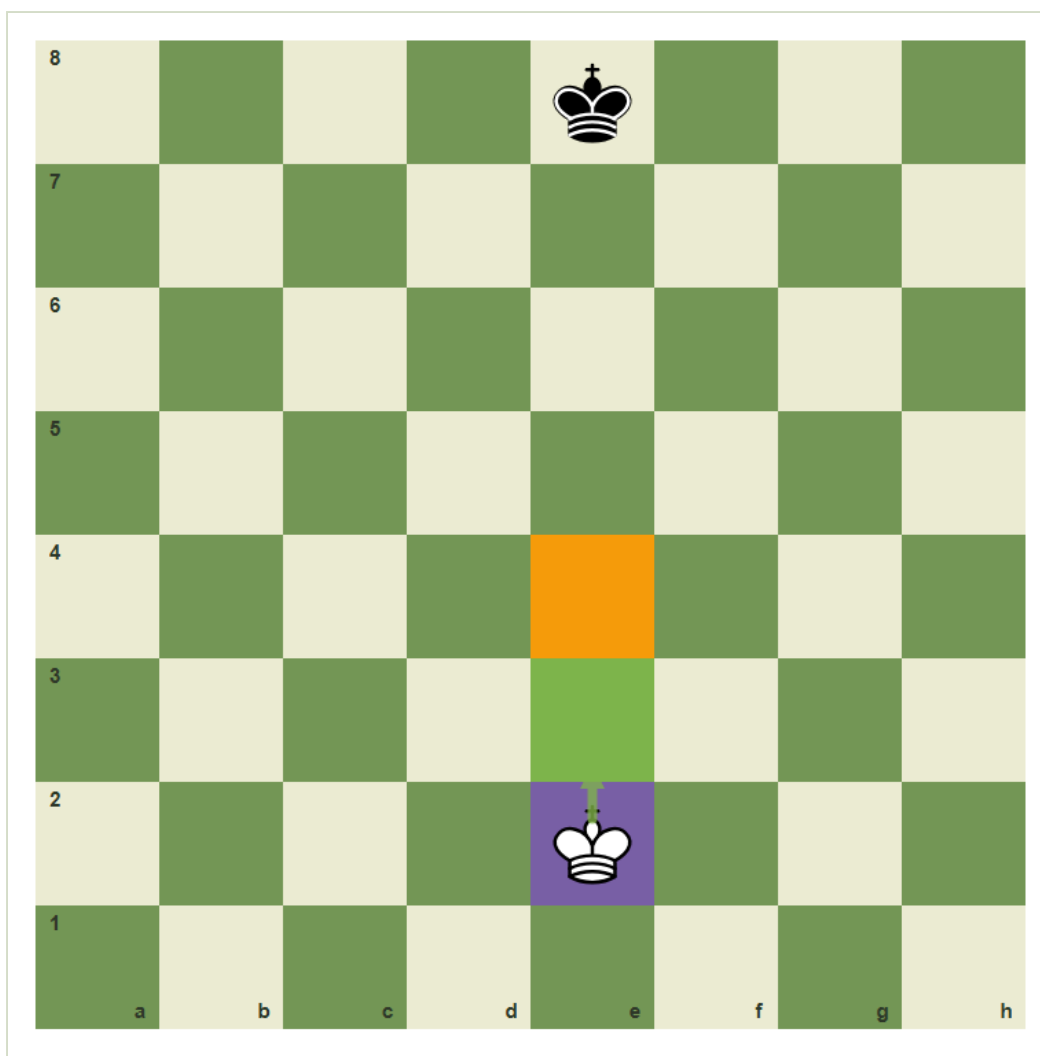
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for hanging pawns.
- Choose a move or plan that fits hanging pawns.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with hanging pawns.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

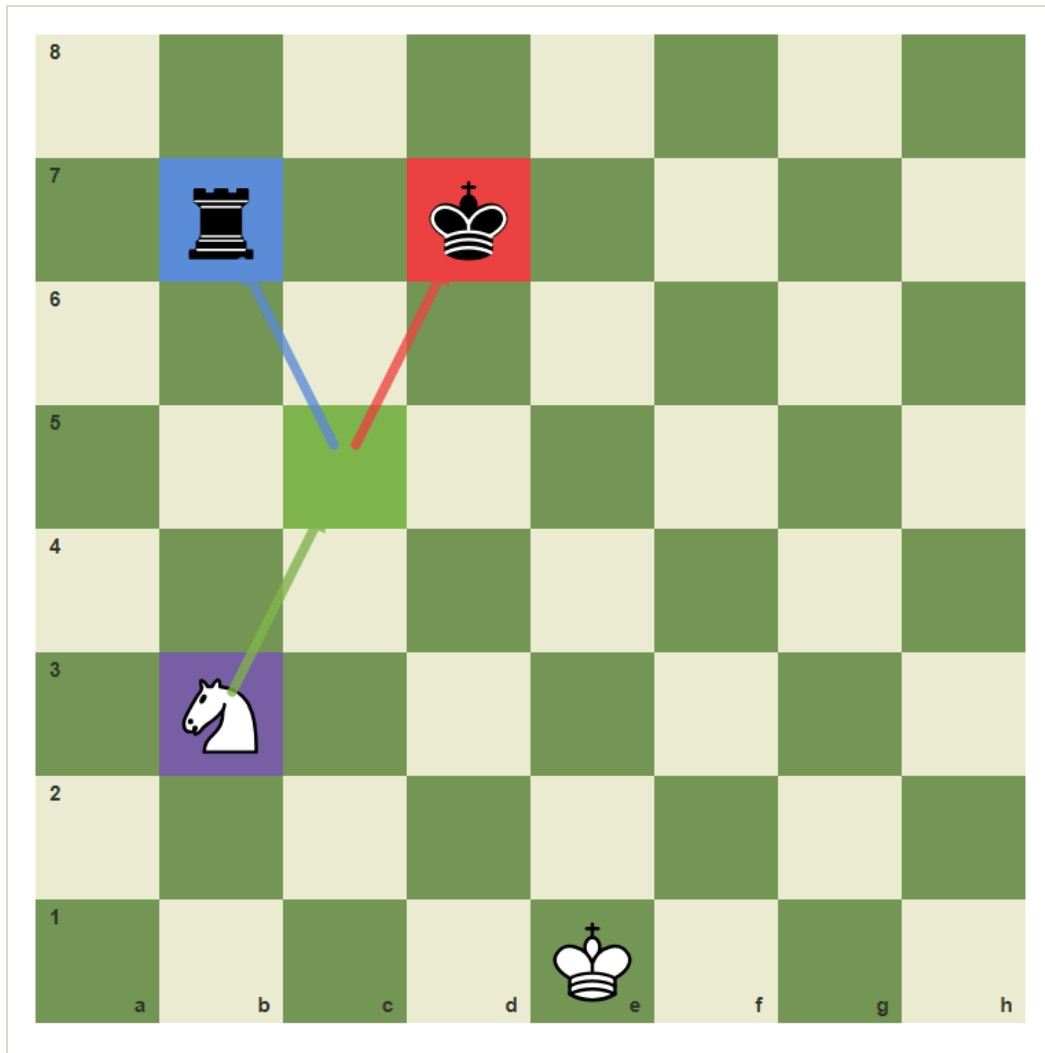
Hanging Pawns is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



Not every best move is a capture; sometimes the quiet improving move is the point. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

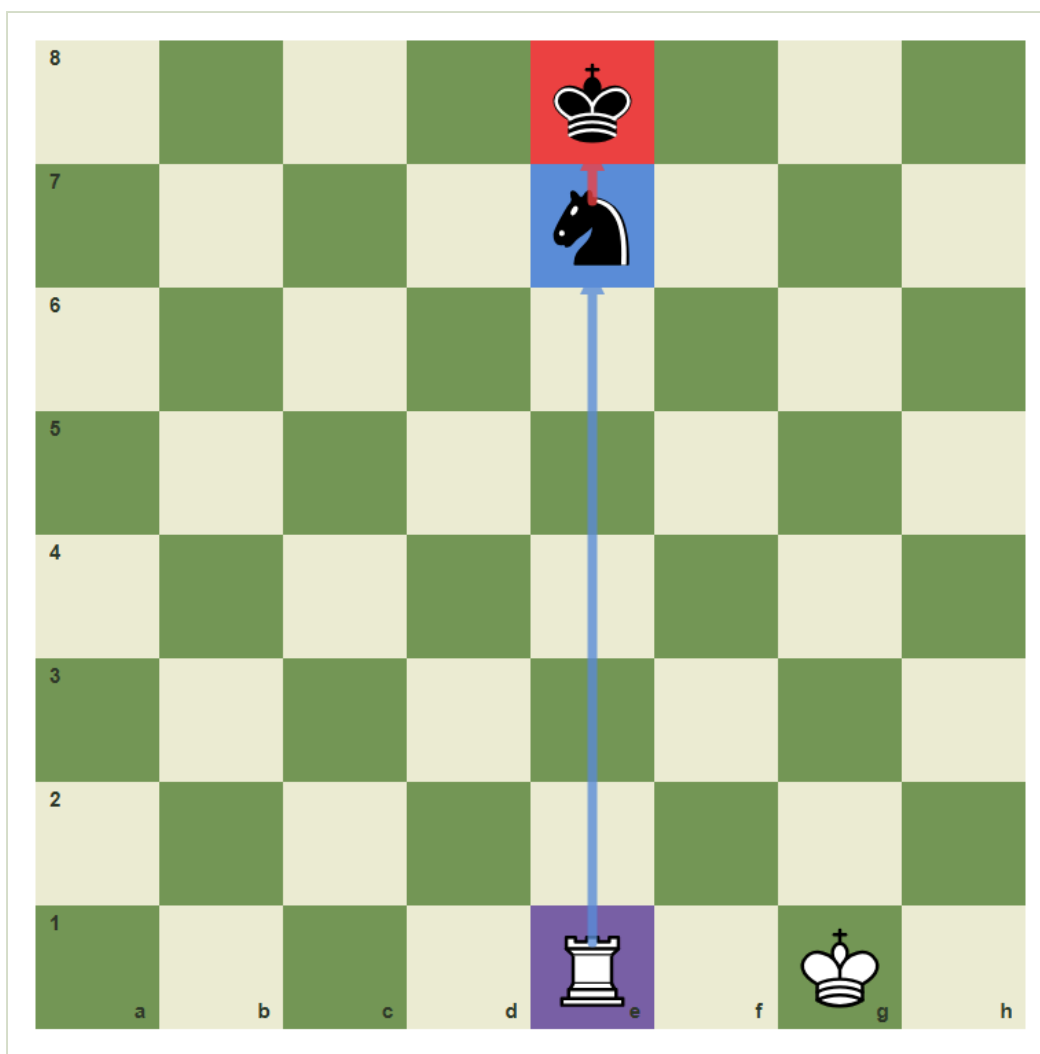


The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

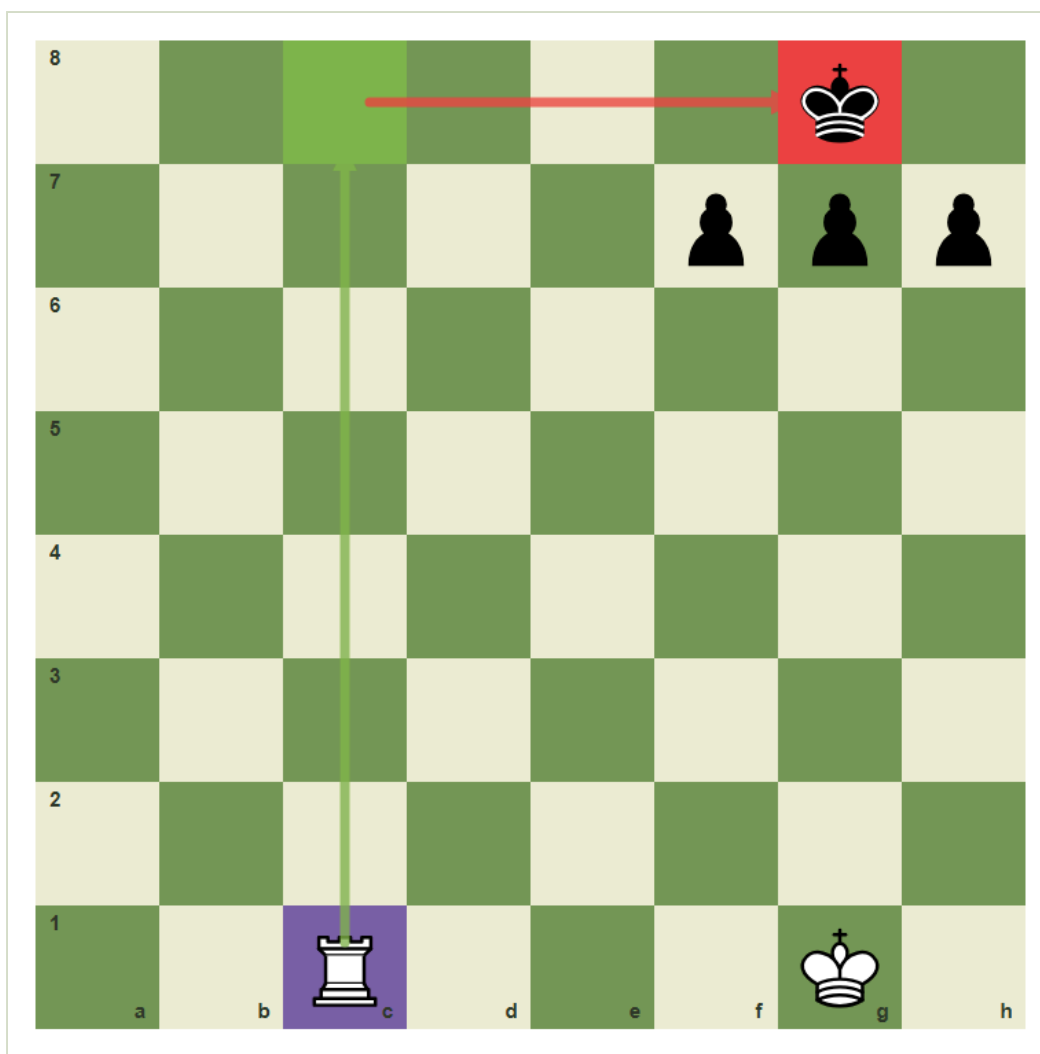
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



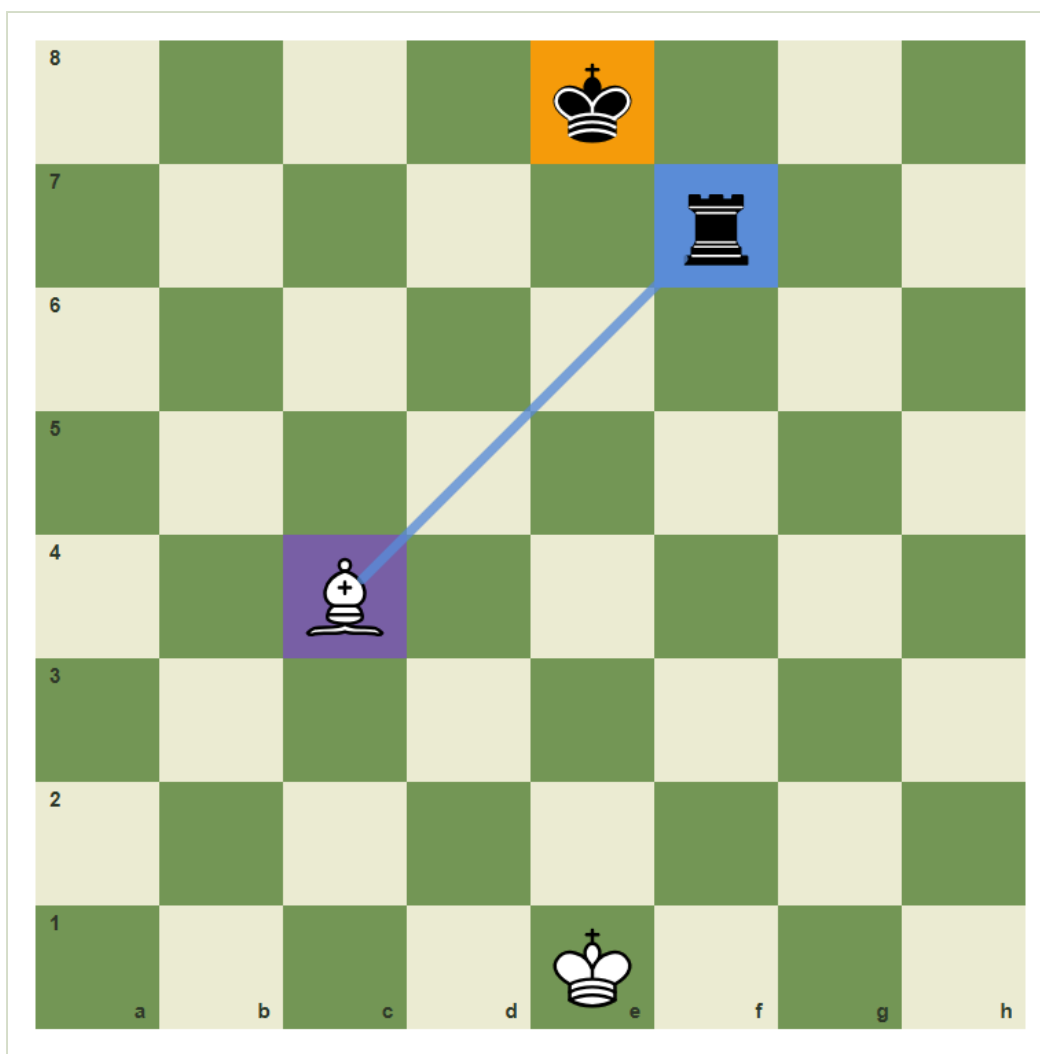
The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

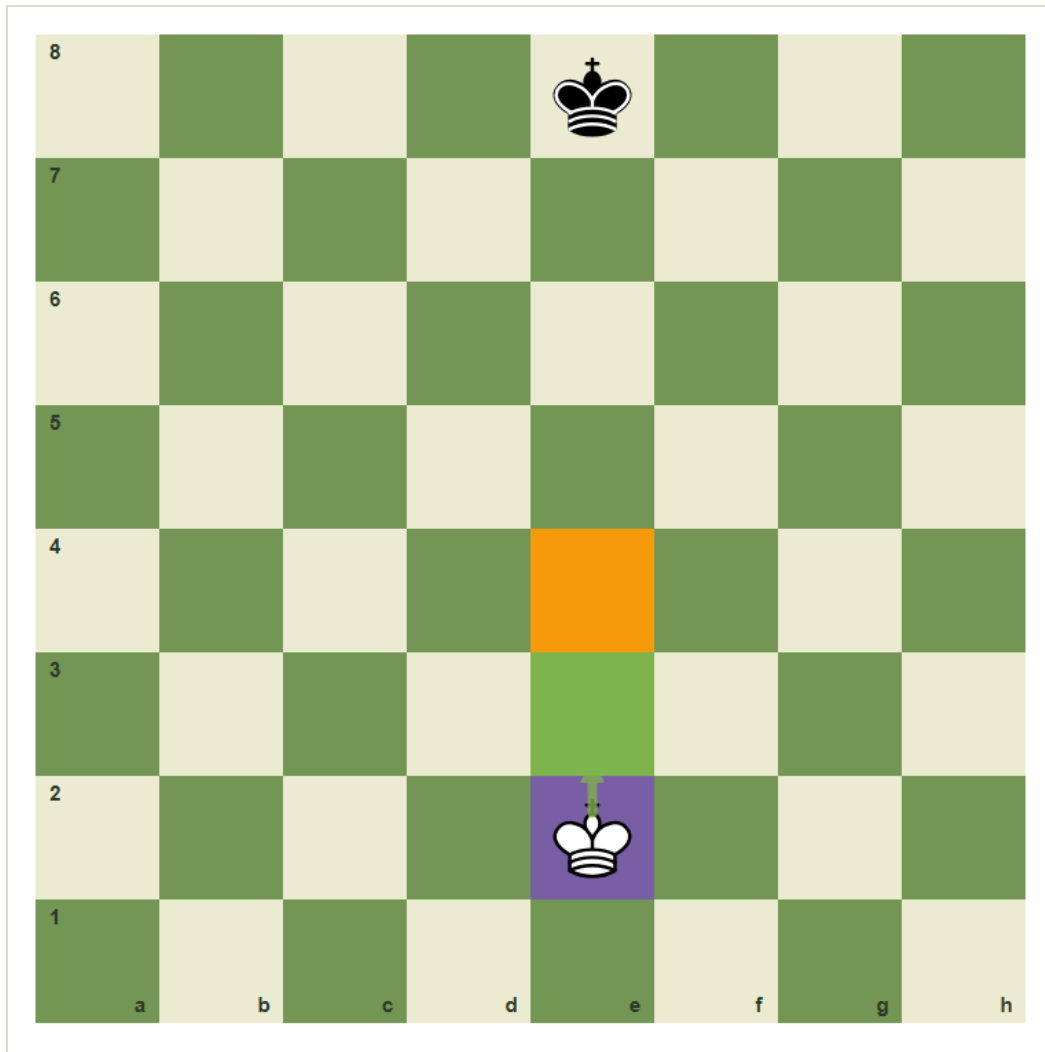
Training Diagram: review position



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

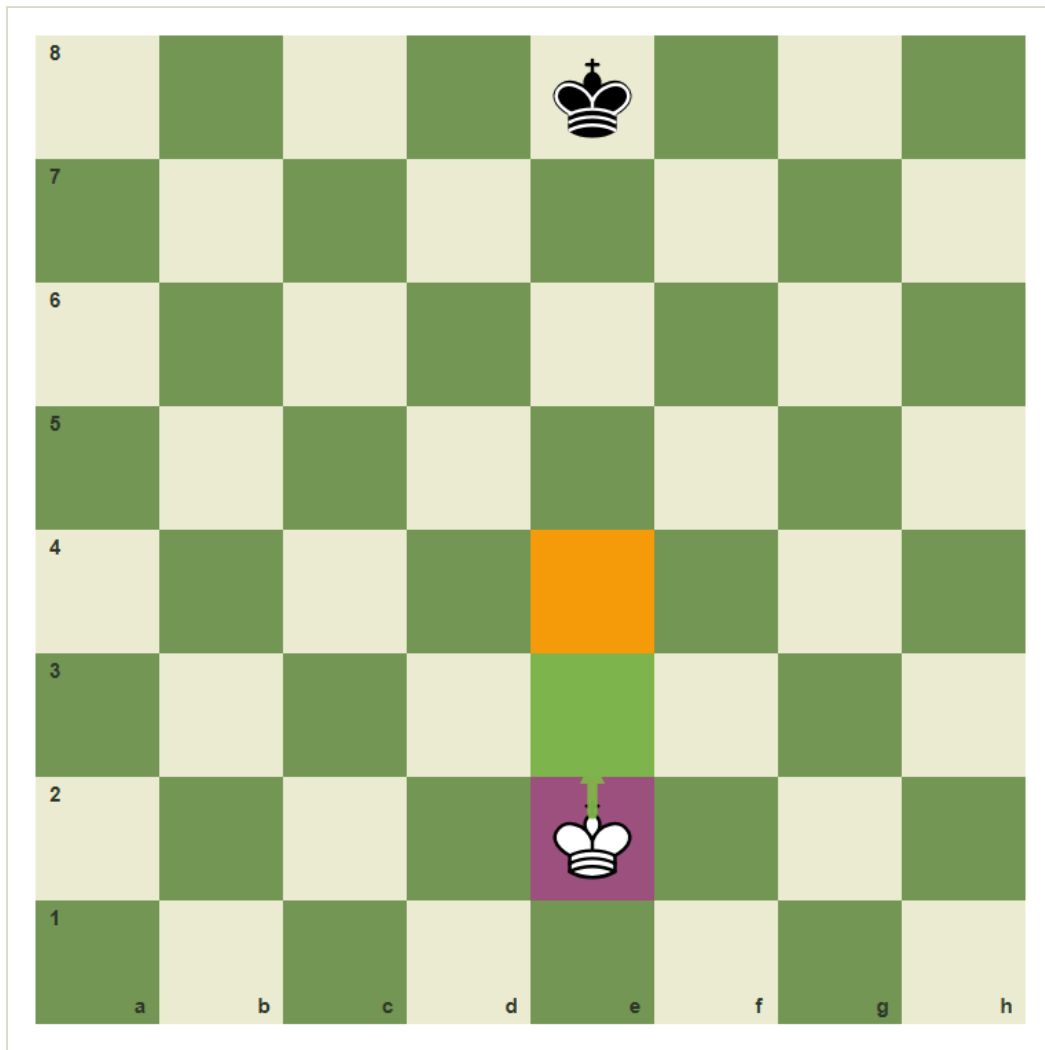
Play the highlighted move from **e2** to **e3**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Hanging Pawns Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **hanging pawns**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Hanging Pawns Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **hanging pawns**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Hanging Pawns Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **hanging pawns**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Exchange Sacrifices

Advanced Strategy | 1800-2100 | gold

Exchange Sacrifices converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

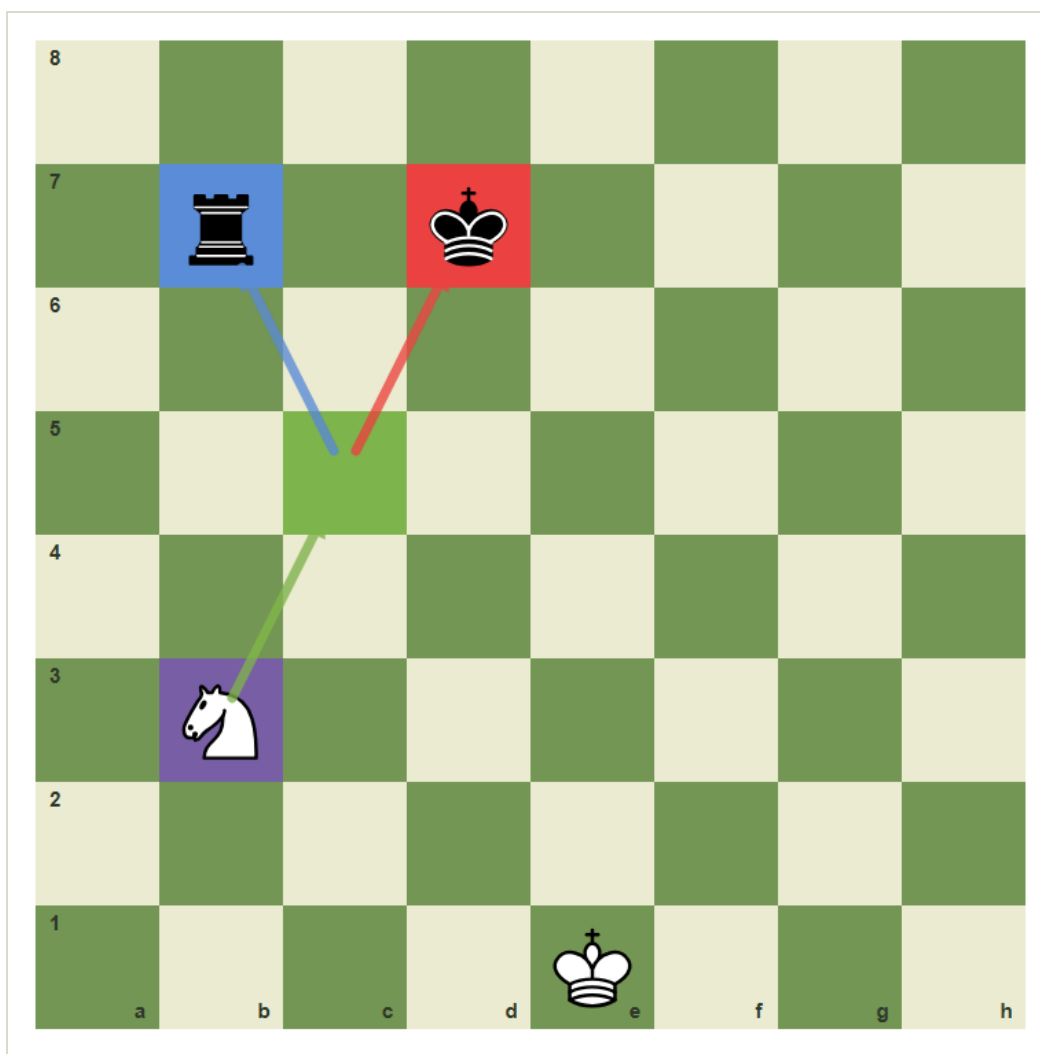
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for exchange sacrifices.
- Choose a move or plan that fits exchange sacrifices.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with exchange sacrifices.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

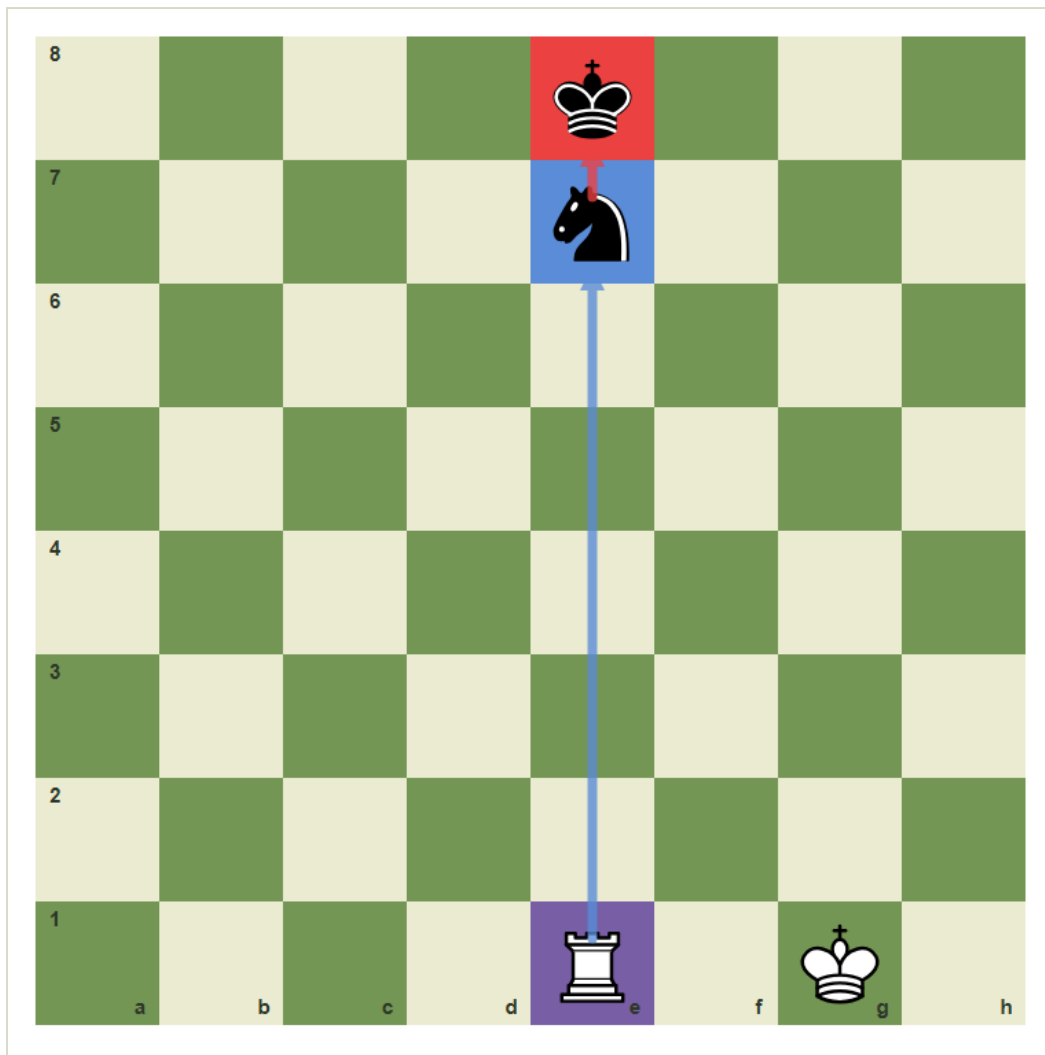
Exchange Sacrifices is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The best square creates two problems at once: king danger and material pressure. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

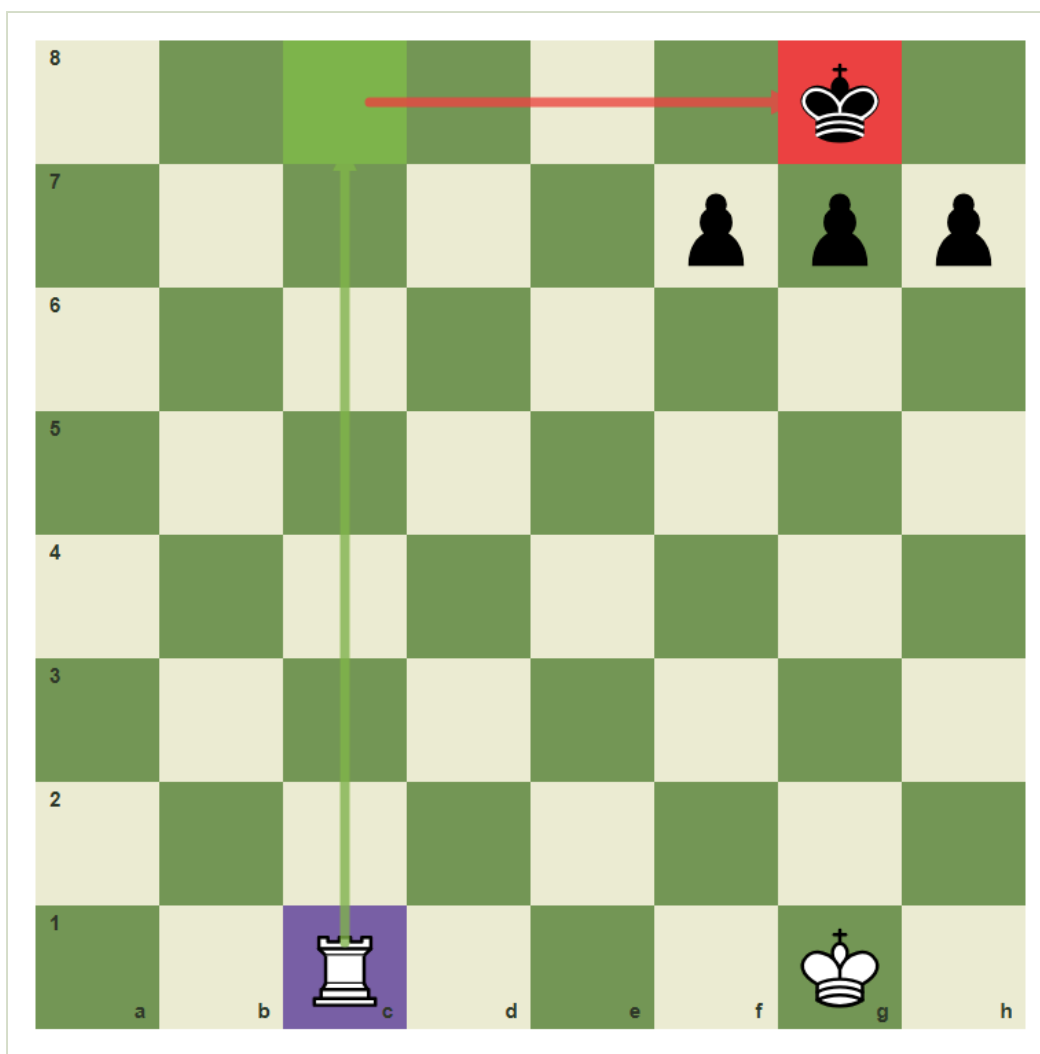


The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

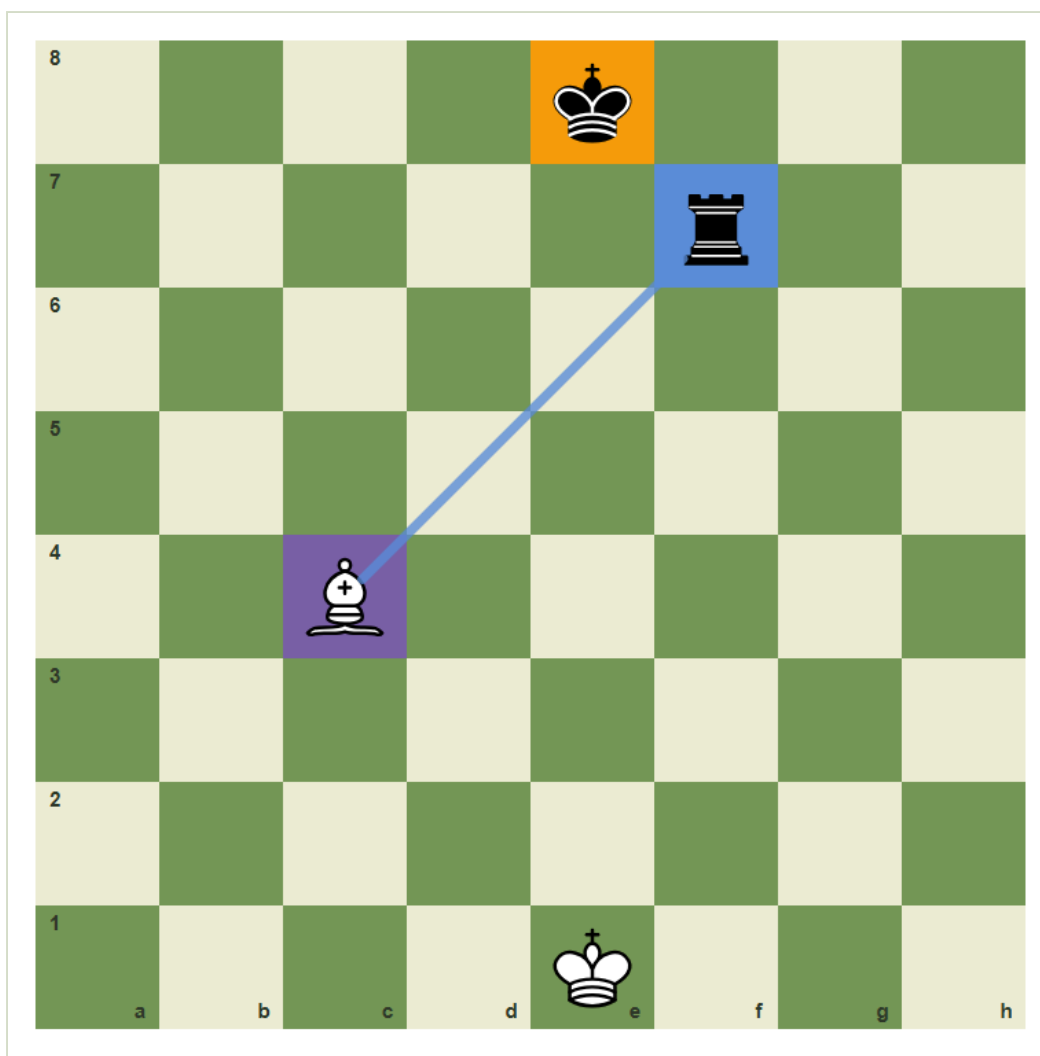
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



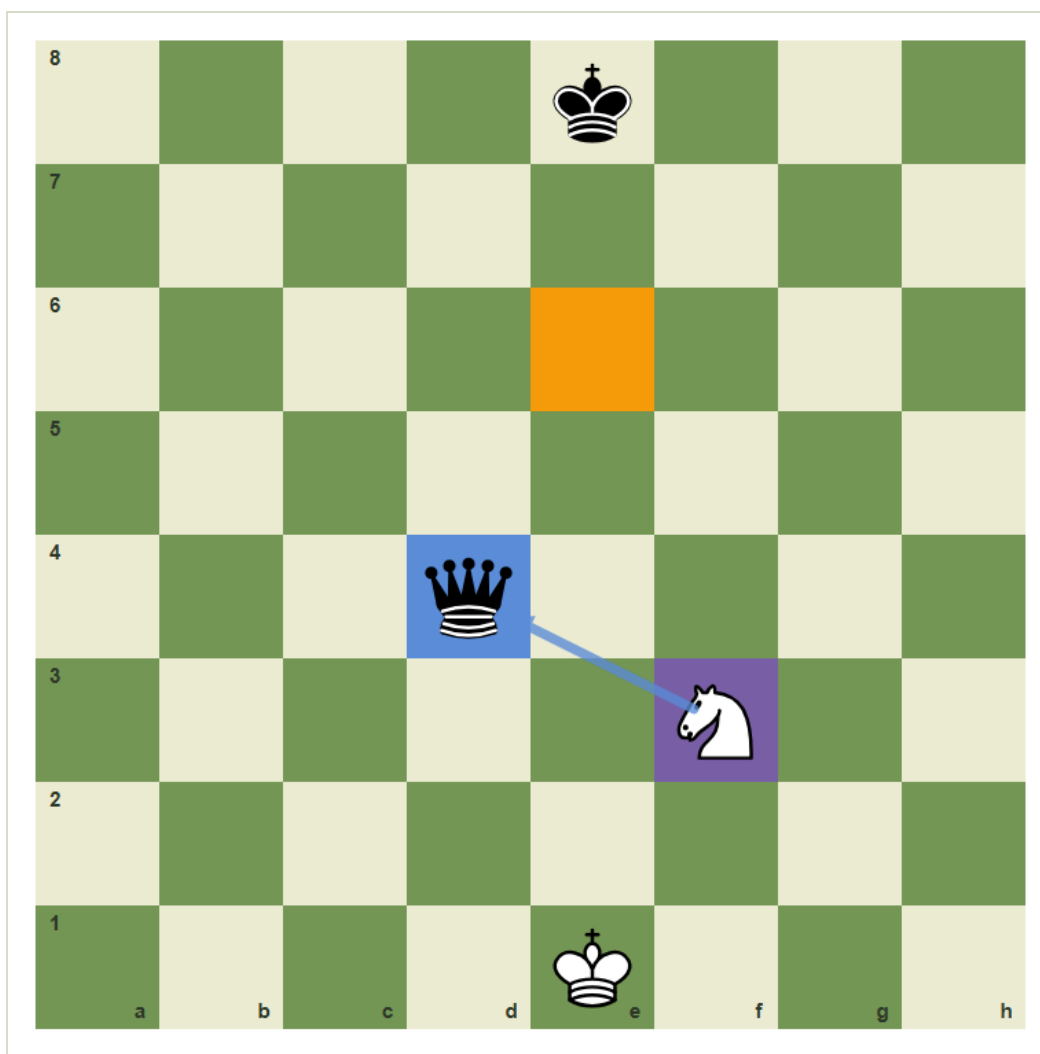
A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

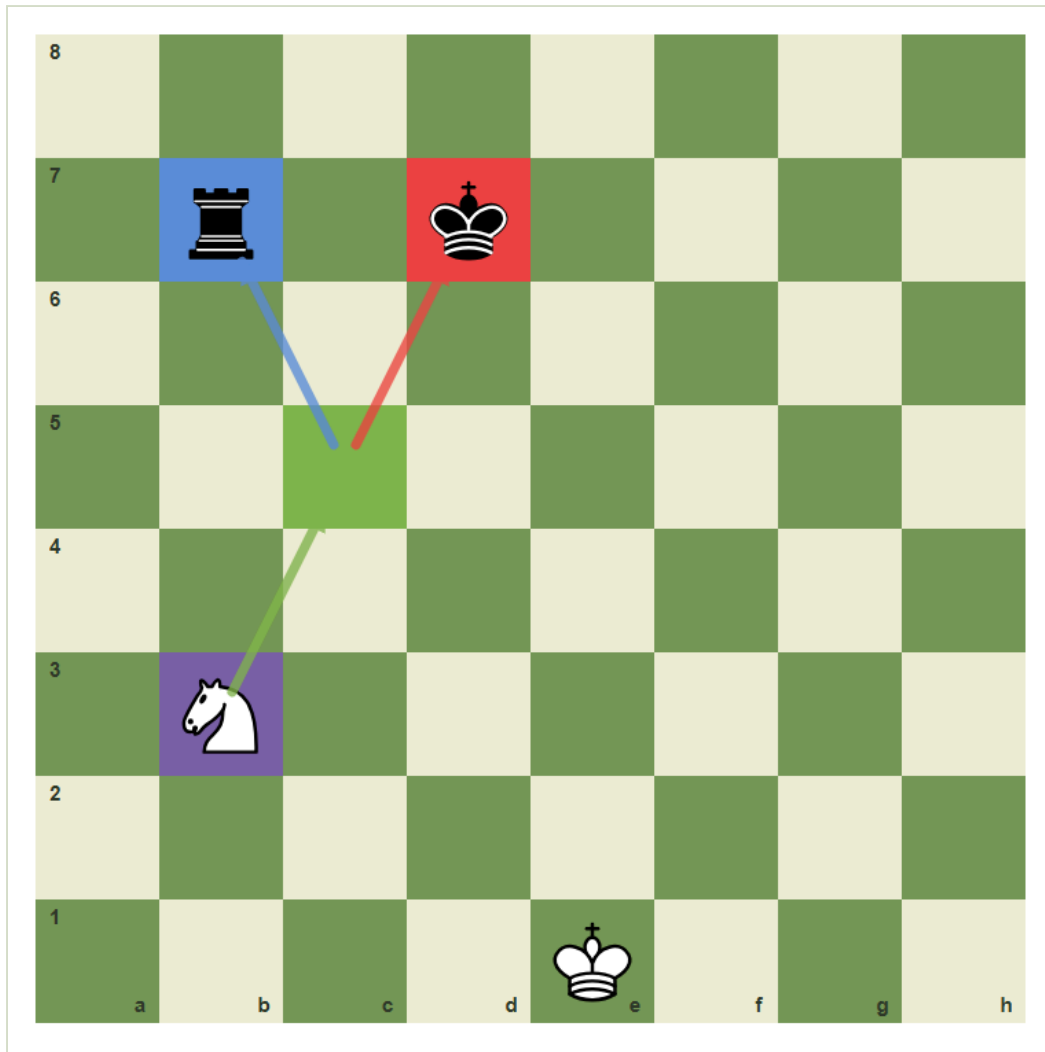
Training Diagram: review position



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

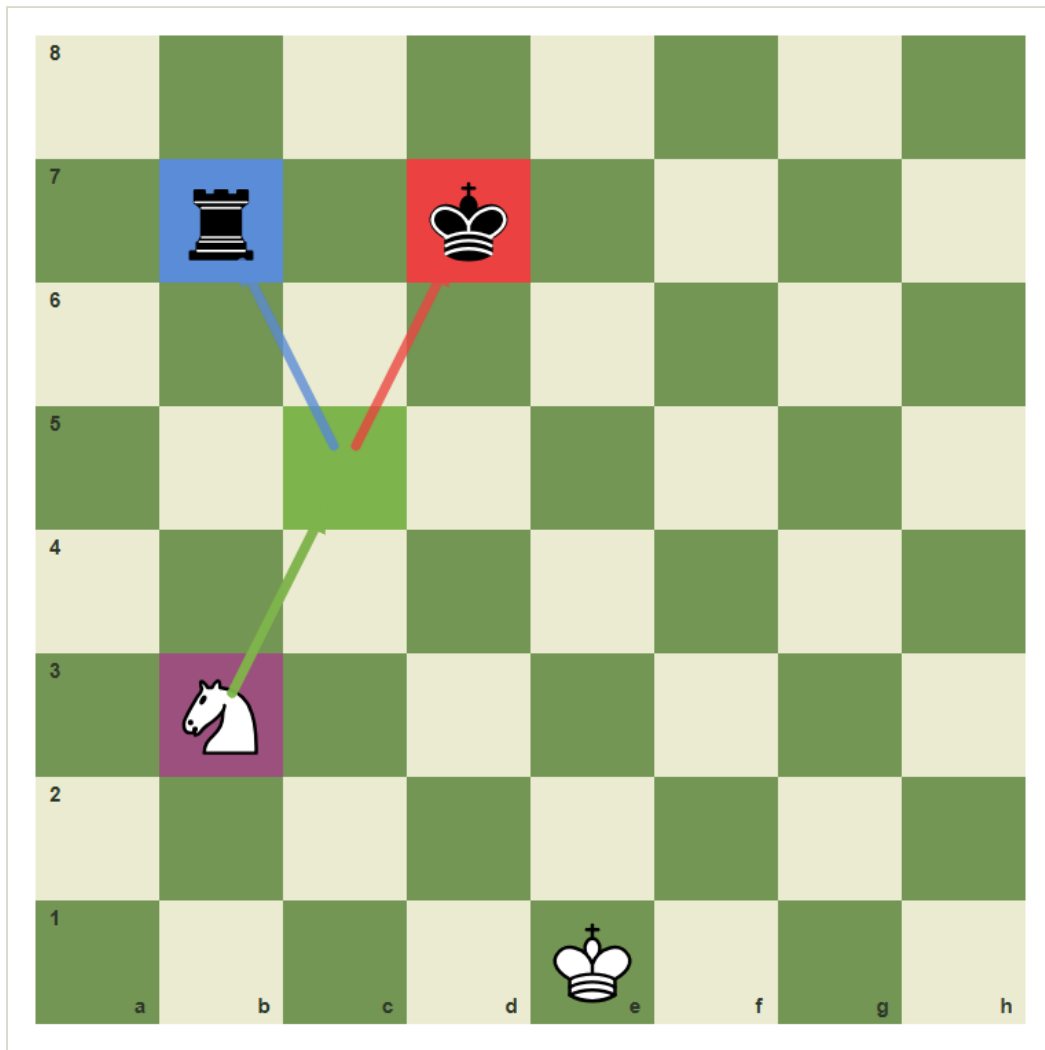
Play the highlighted move from **b3** to **c5**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Exchange Sacrifices Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **exchange sacrifices**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Exchange Sacrifices Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **exchange sacrifices**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Exchange Sacrifices Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **exchange sacrifices**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Strategic Defense

Advanced Strategy | 1800-2100 | gold

Strategic Defense converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

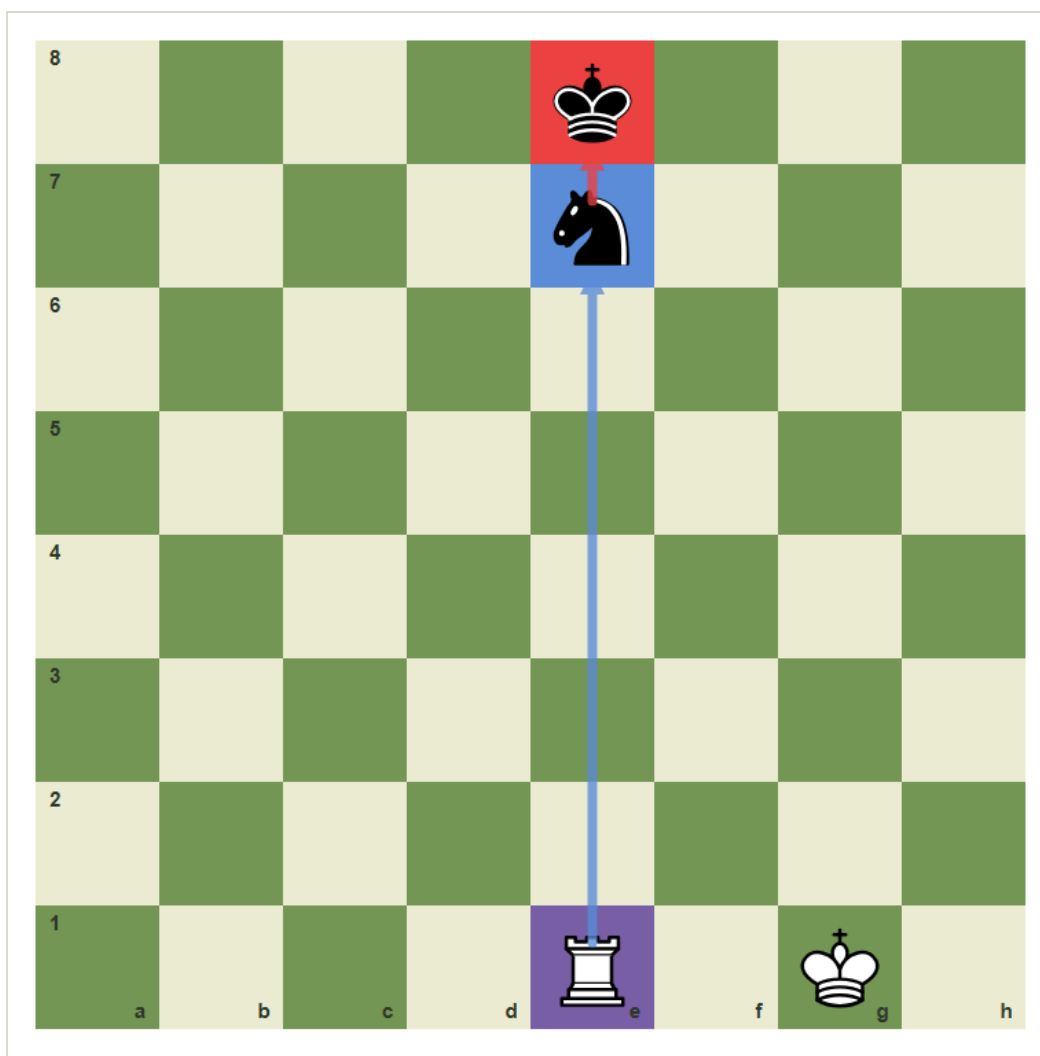
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for strategic defense.
- Choose a move or plan that fits strategic defense.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with strategic defense.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

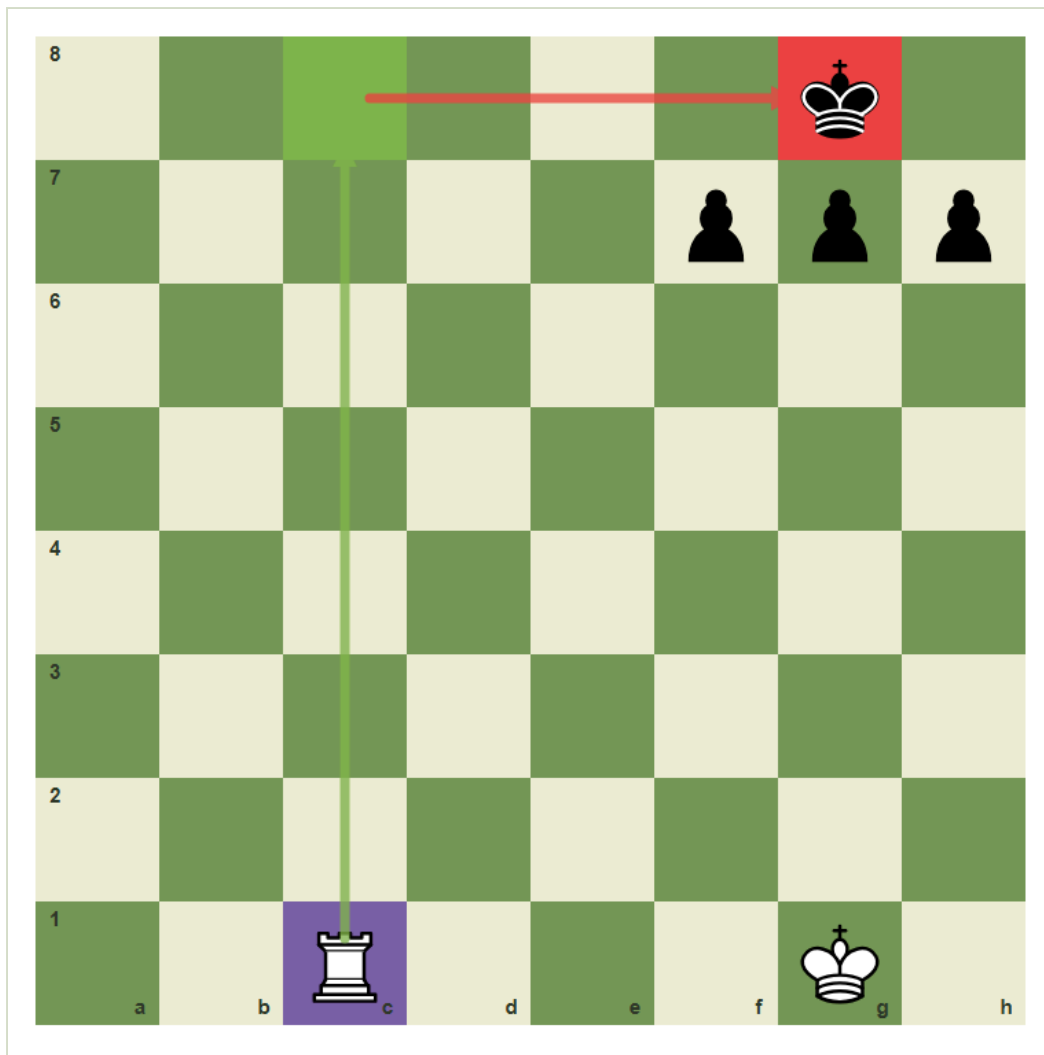
Strategic Defense is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



The target cannot move freely because the king behind it matters. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

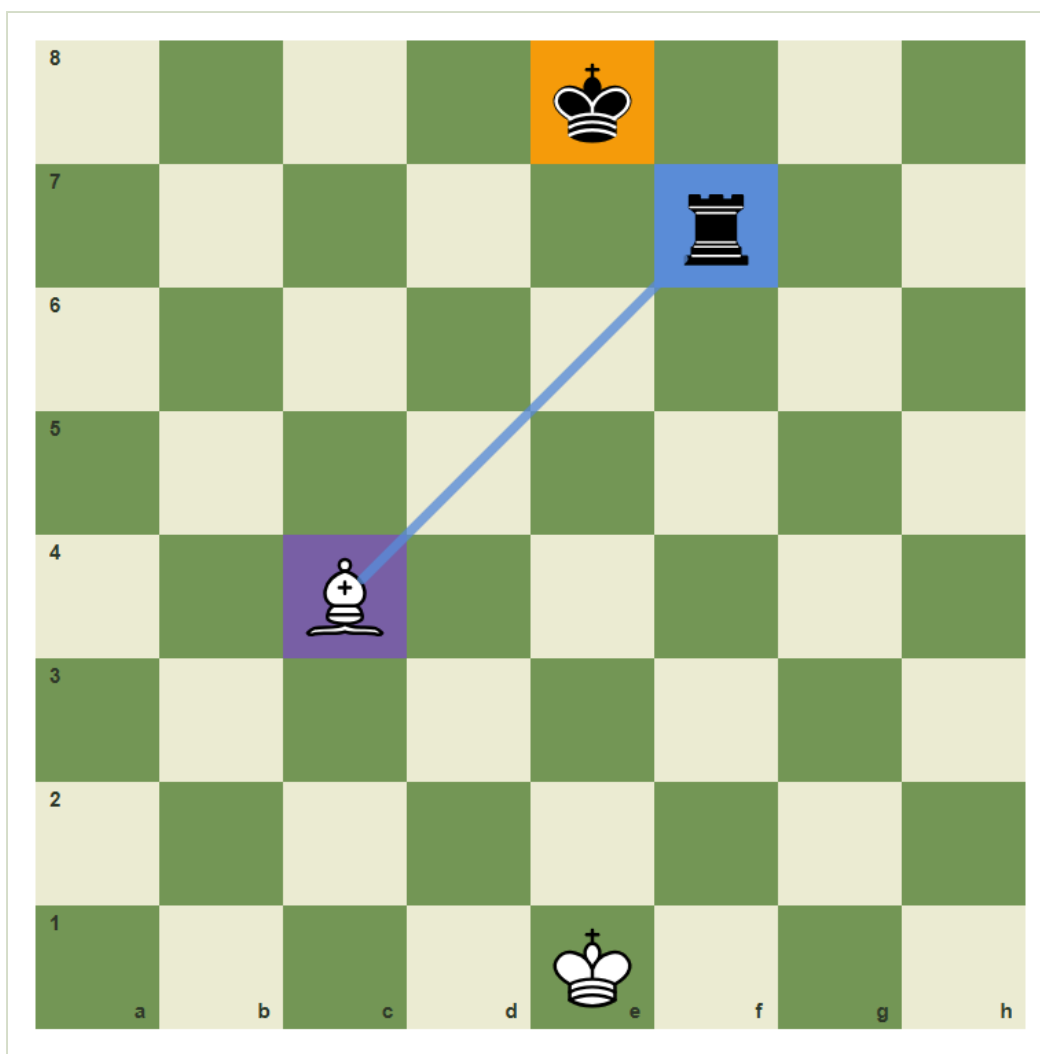


A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

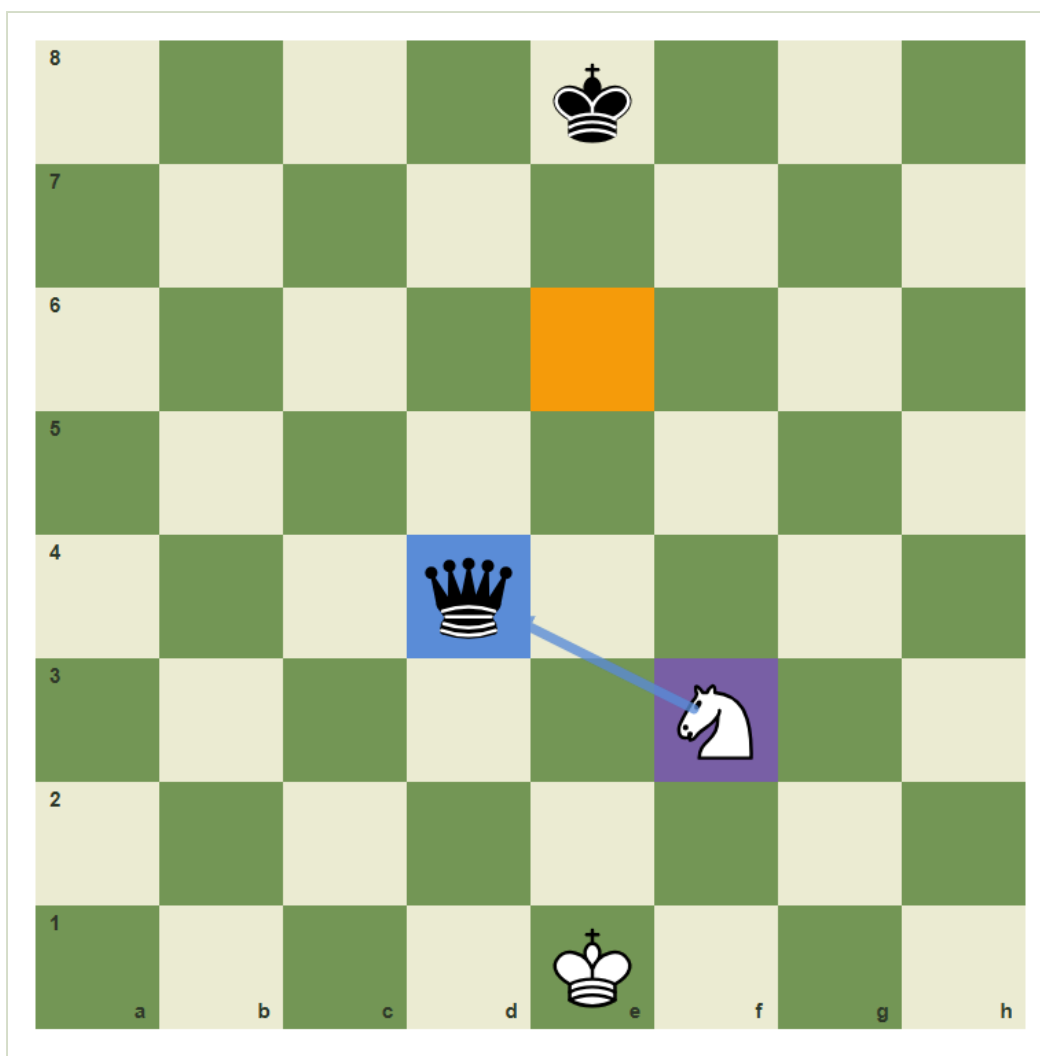
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



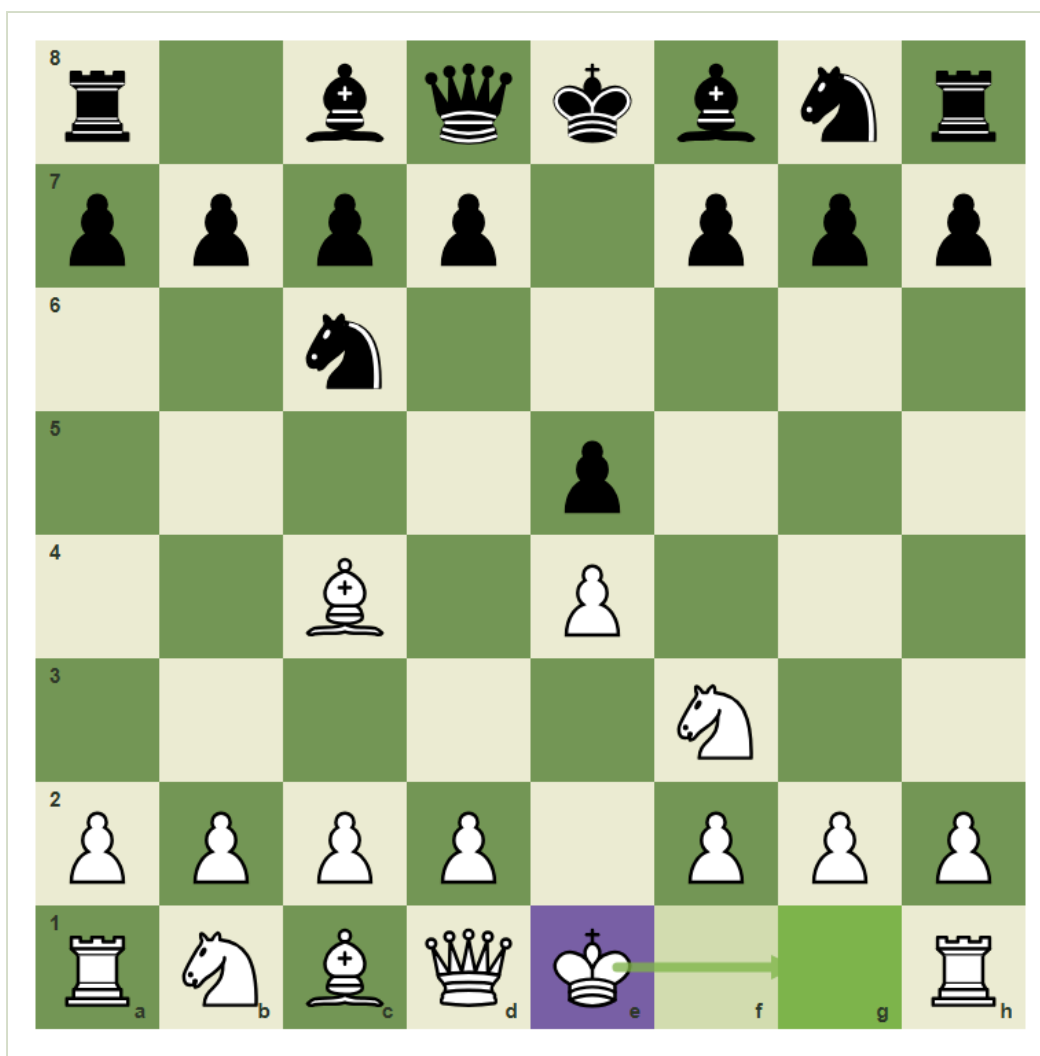
The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

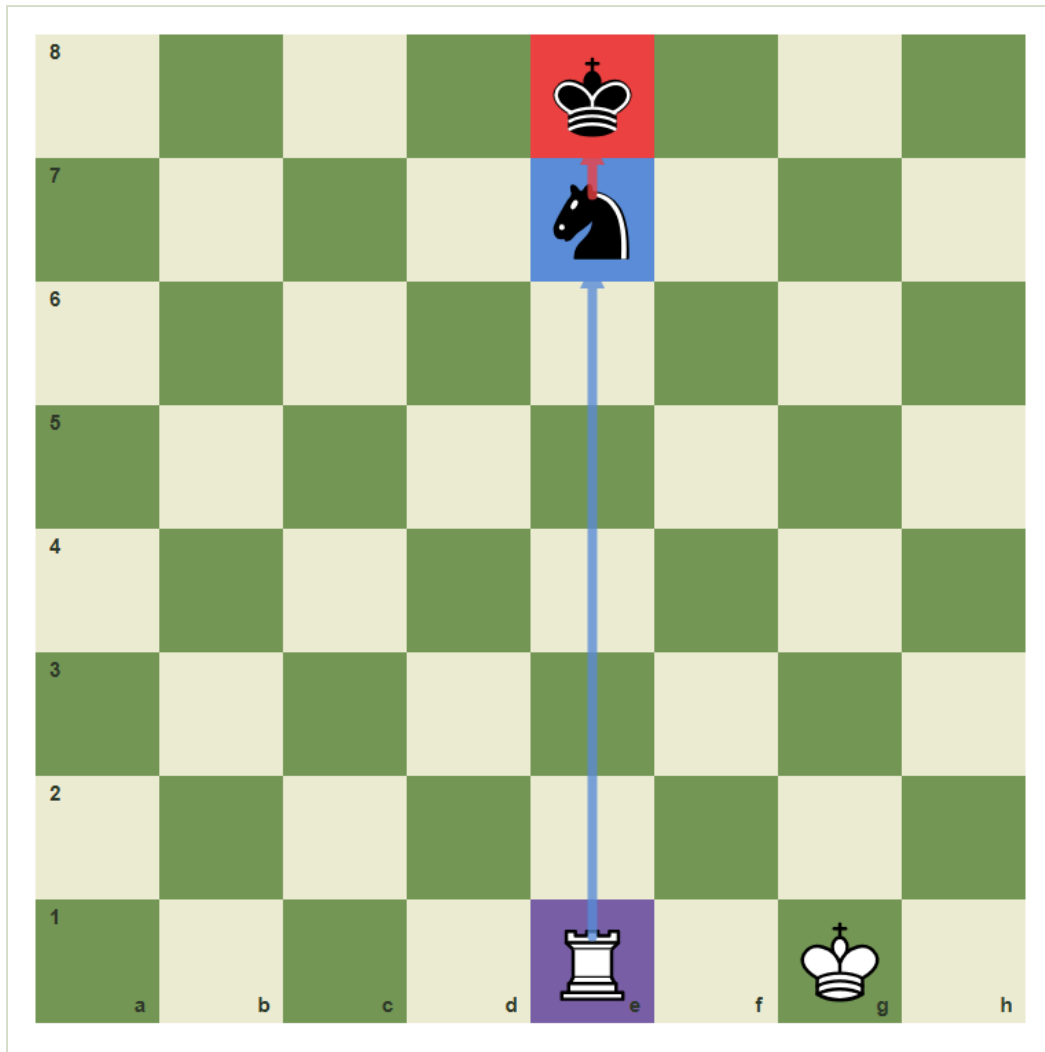
Training Diagram: review position



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

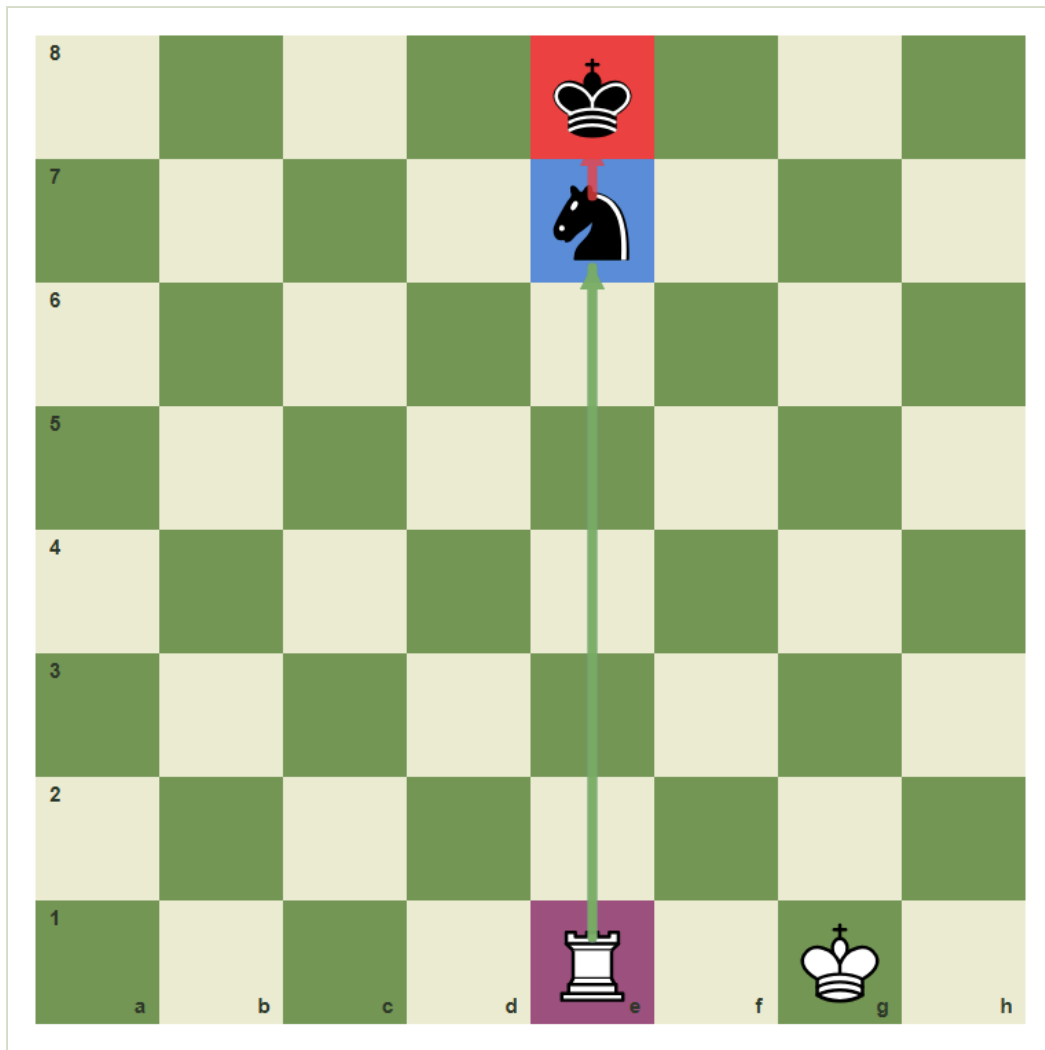
Play the highlighted move from **e1** to **e7**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Strategic Defense Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **strategic defense**?

- a. Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Strategic Defense Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **strategic defense**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Strategic Defense Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **strategic defense**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Model-Game Strategy Test

Advanced Strategy | 1800-2100 | gold

Model-Game Strategy Test converted into a repeatable Chess99 training habit.

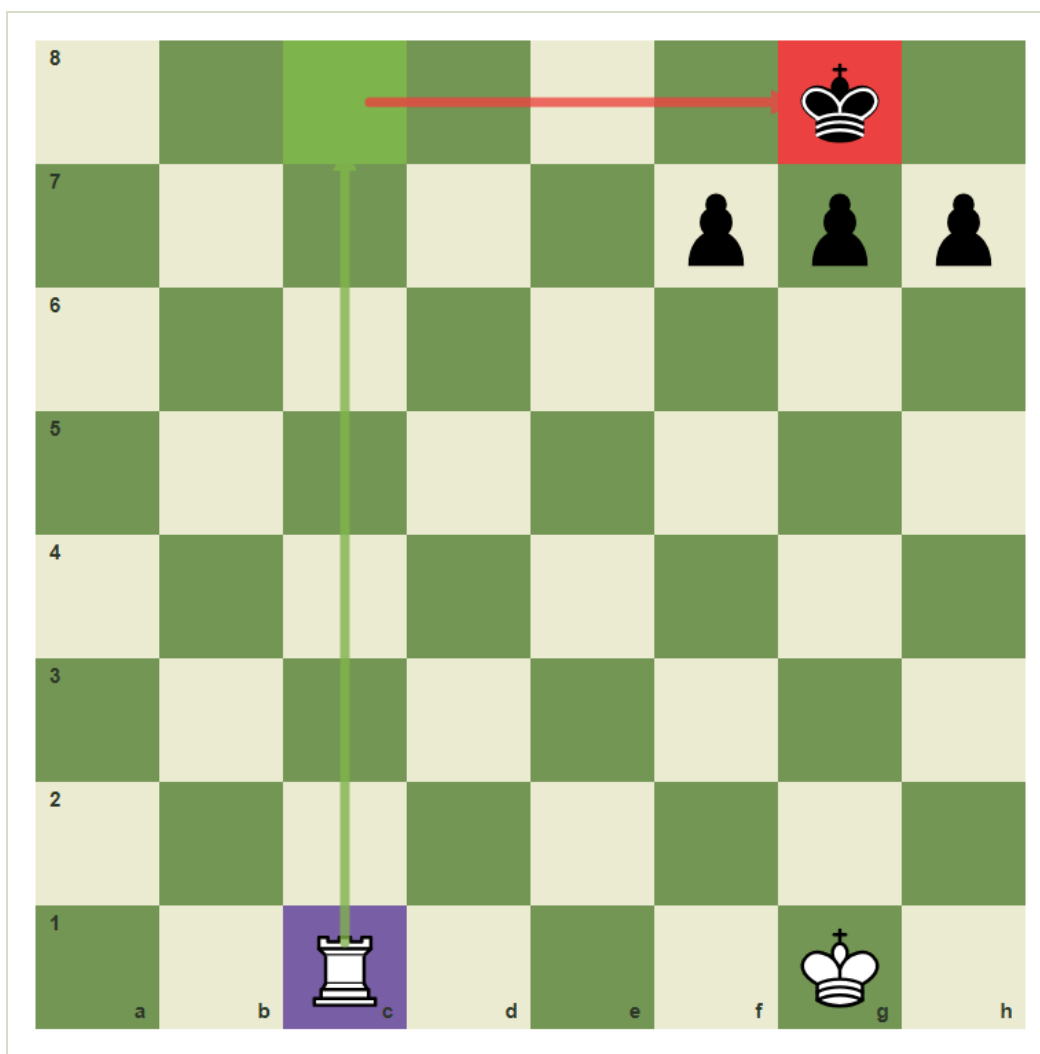
Learning objectives

- Recognize the visual signal for model-game strategy test.
- Choose a move or plan that fits model-game strategy test.
- Avoid the common beginner error connected with model-game strategy test.
- Pass a checkpoint without relying on guesswork.

Goal And Pattern

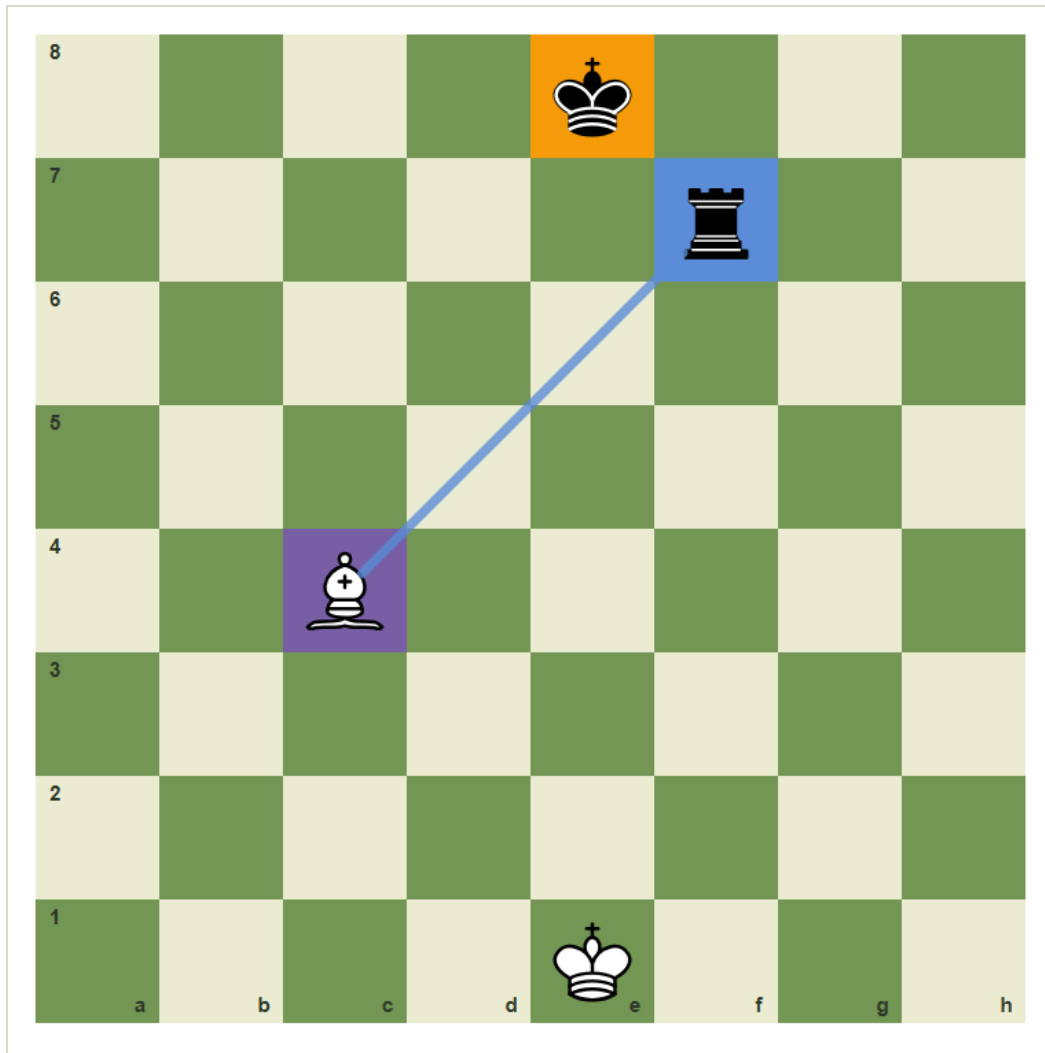
Model-Game Strategy Test is not a memory trick. It is a way to organize the position. First name the signal, then compare candidate moves, then choose the move that improves your position without creating a new weakness.

Training Diagram: main pattern



A rook reaches the back rank when the escape squares are boxed in. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: candidate move

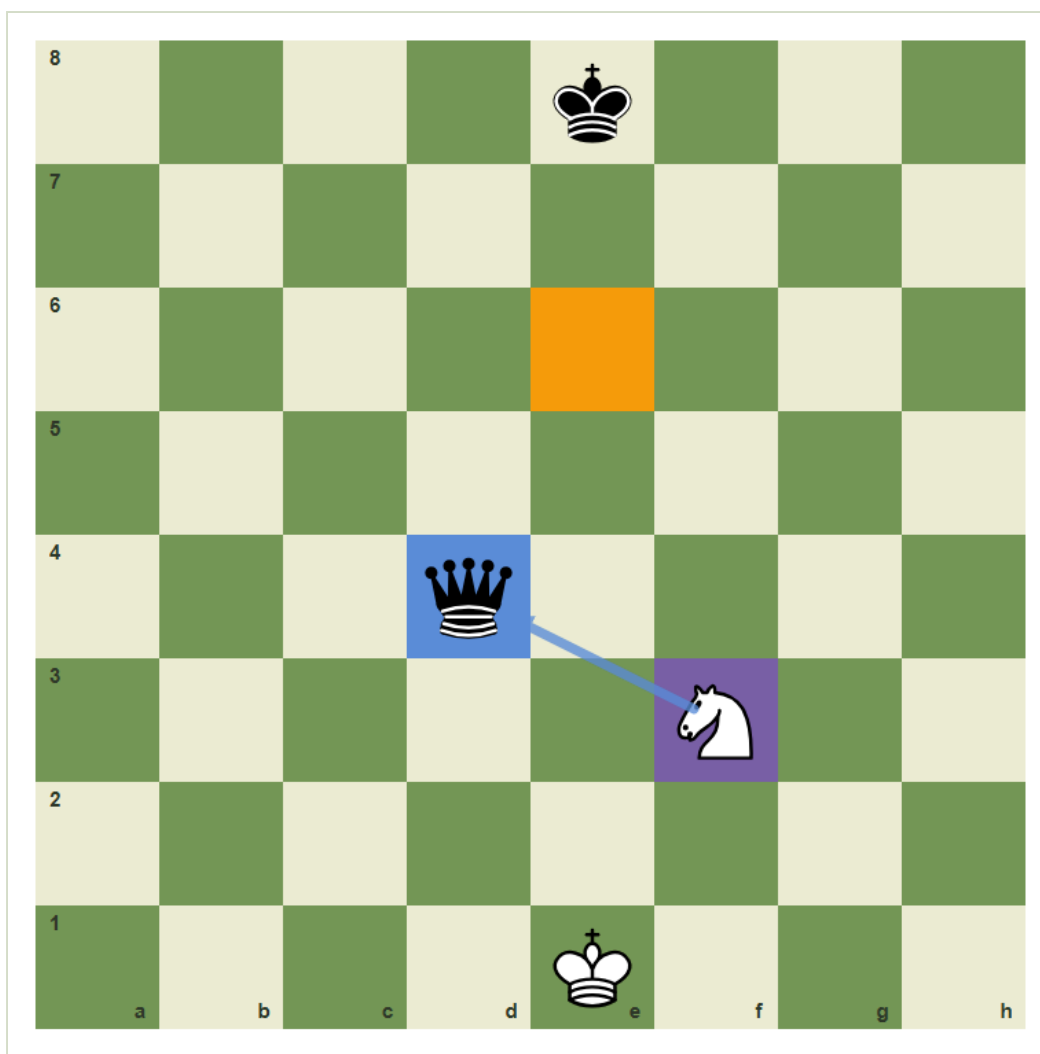


The line to the target is clear, so the capture wins higher-value material. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Analysis And Decision

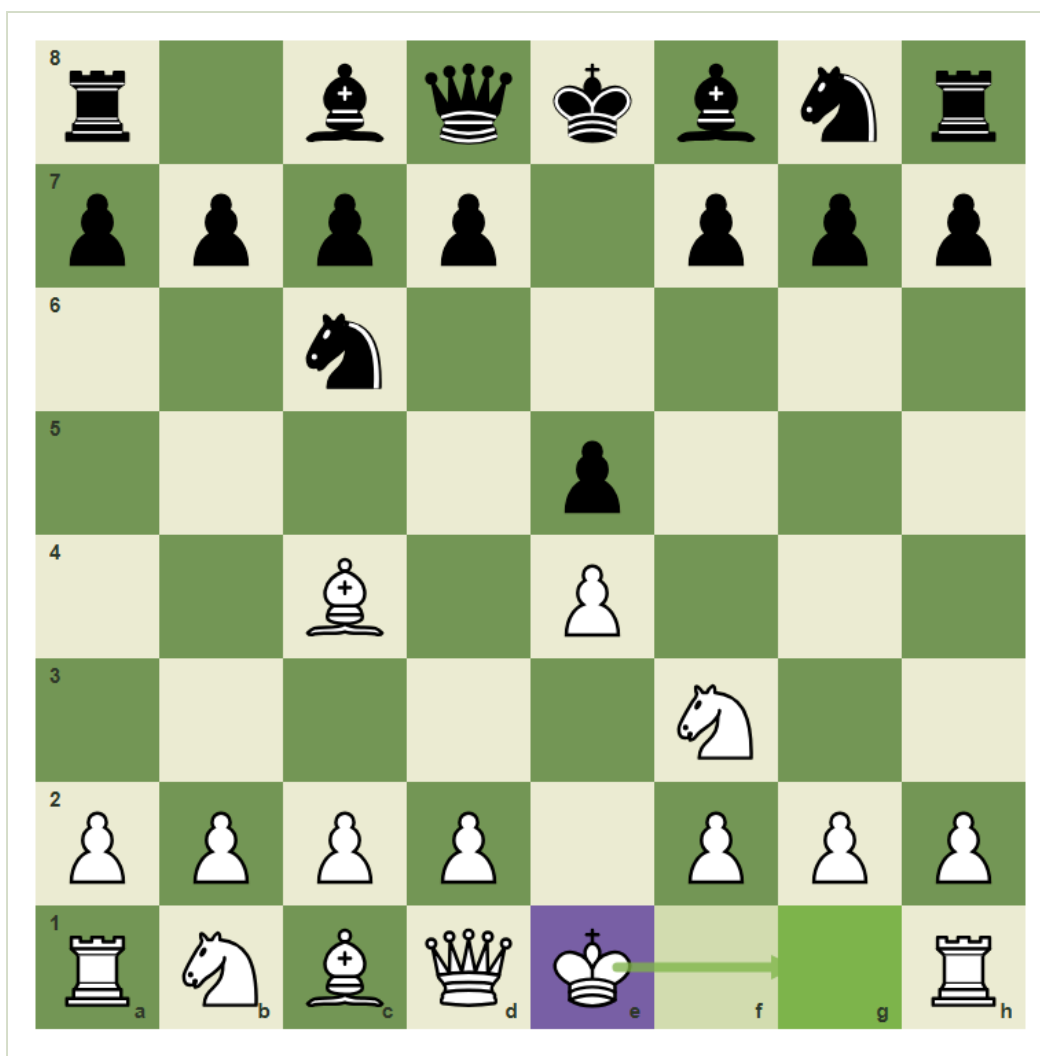
Use the diagram as a thinking board. Ask what is forcing, what is loose, and what changes after the move. Strong players do not only see a move; they see the reason the move works.

Training Diagram: comparison position



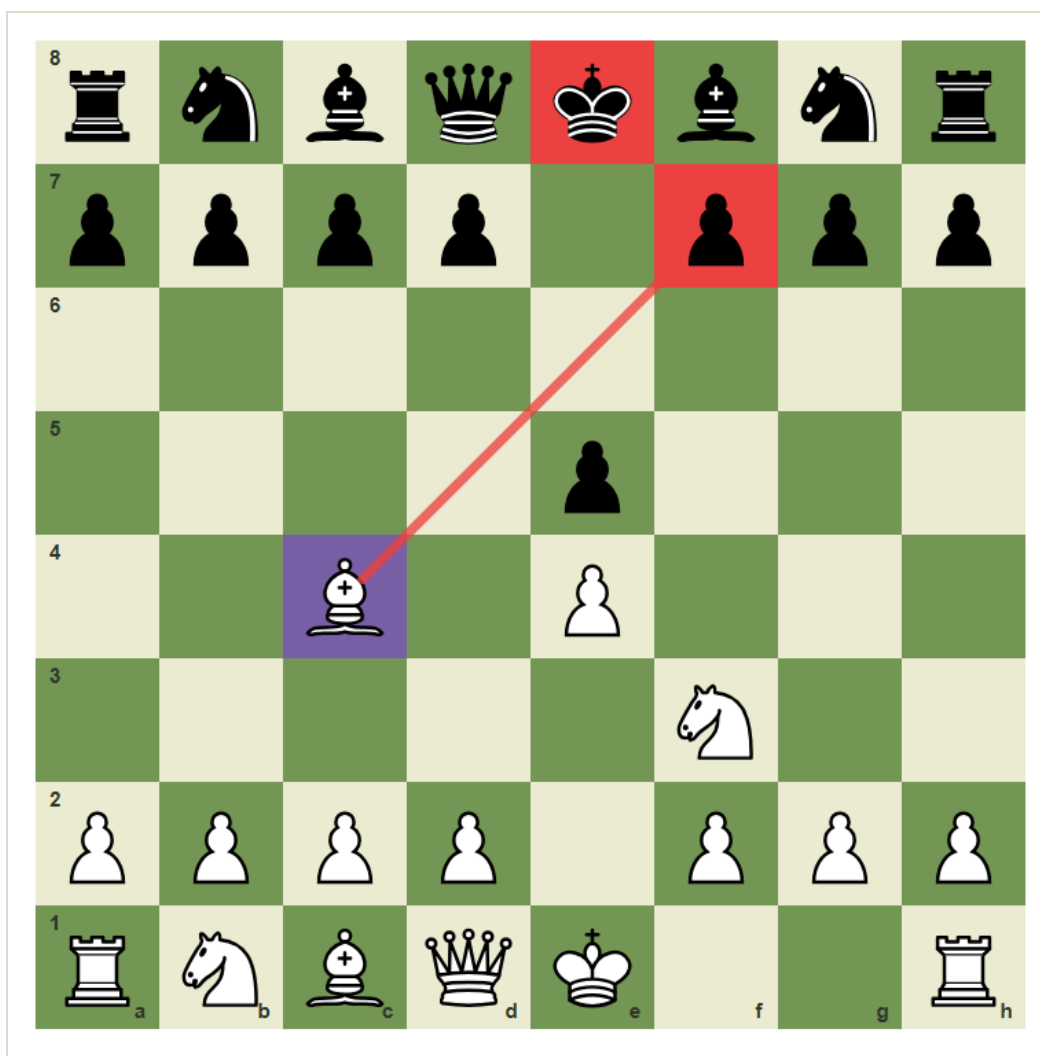
A high-value target changes the whole position when it is undefended. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Training Diagram: best practical choice



King safety often beats a tempting pawn grab or one-move threat. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

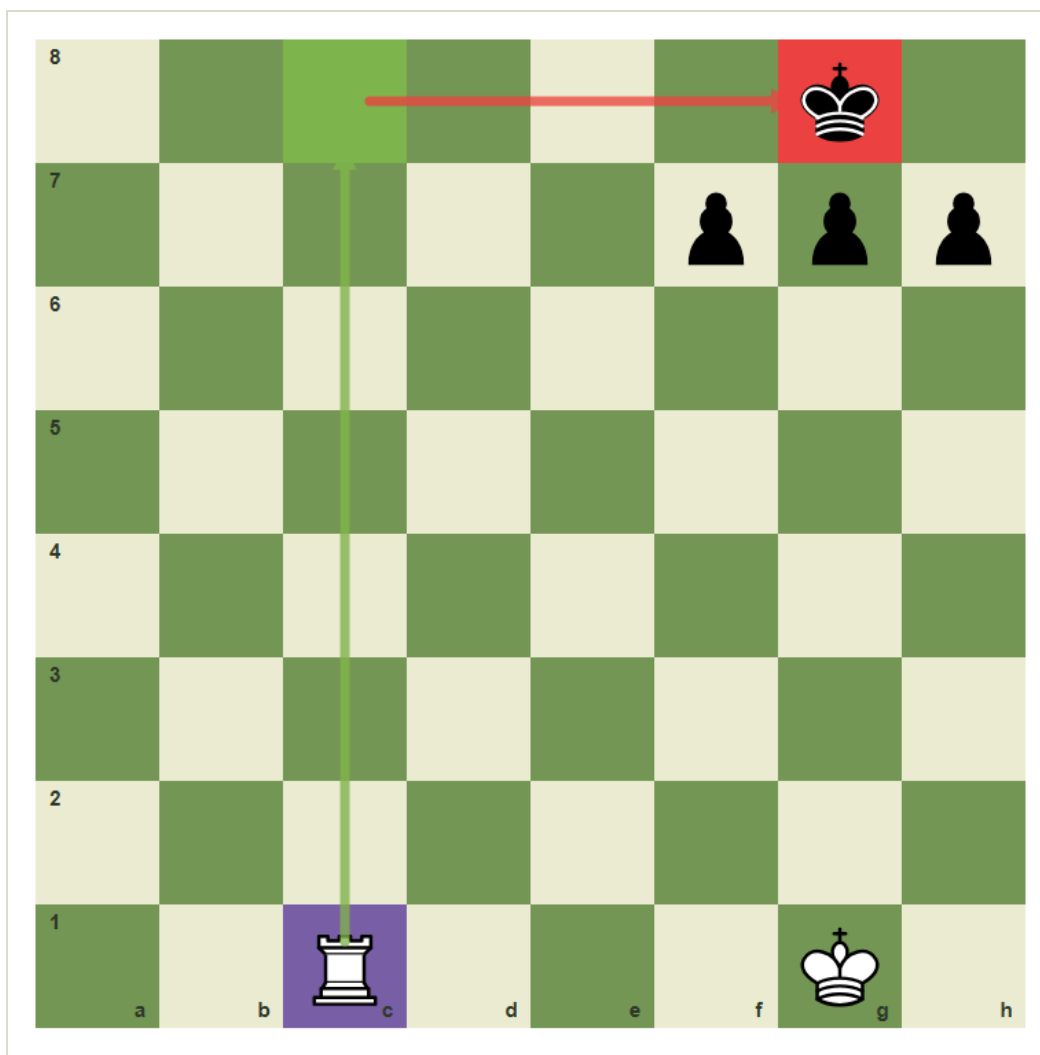
Training Diagram: review position



Checks are forcing moves and should be examined before quieter ideas. Study the highlighted relationship before reading the move.

Try It: Find The Training Move

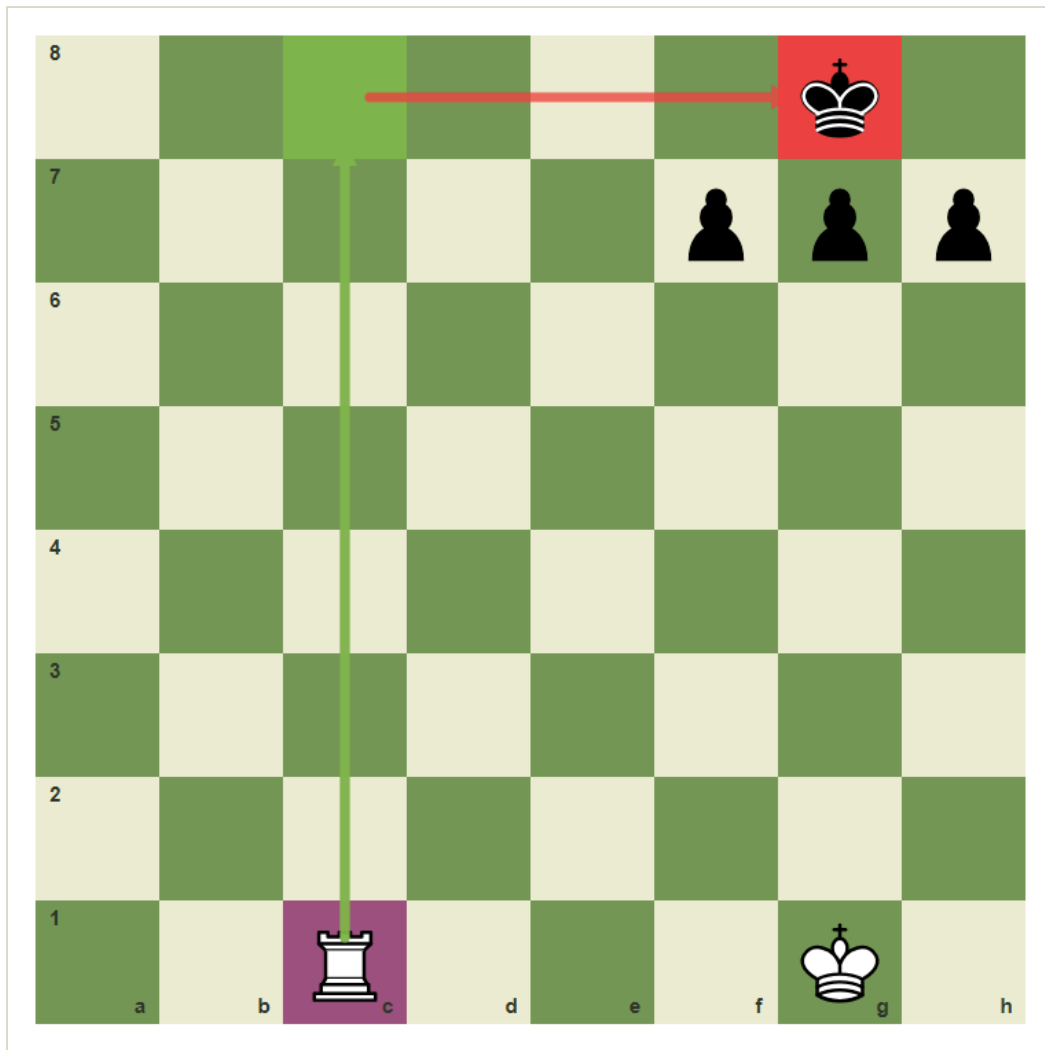
Play the highlighted move from **c1** to **c8**. Do it only after saying the idea in words.



The guided move turns the diagram idea into a playable habit.

Common Mistake: Missing The Diagram Signal

The common mistake is to move by habit and miss the chapter signal. The diagram marks the useful move and the important target so the error is visible before it happens.



The marked relationship is the reason the natural careless move fails.

Chapter Checkpoint

Model-Game Strategy Test Check 1

What should you do first in a position about **model-game strategy test**?

- Name the key signal before choosing a move.
- Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Model-Game Strategy Test Check 2

Which answer best matches the chapter habit for **model-game strategy test**?

- a. Compare candidate moves and reject the unsafe one.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.

Model-Game Strategy Test Check 3

What is the biggest danger if you ignore **model-game strategy test**?

- a. You may miss a tactic, plan, or defensive resource.
- b. Move instantly because the first idea is usually enough.
- c. Ignore the diagram and choose by piece value only.